





Date: 10.08.2026 Company Secretary and Compliance Officer



# Kanwar Yatra traffic chokes national Capital roads amid heavy rain

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Long lines of cars, groups of Kanwariyas on motorcycles and on foot, crowded markets and roadside Kanwar camps marked several parts of Delhi on Monday as the annual pilgrimage entered its penultimate day.

At several places, commuters found themselves moving slowly through stretches already busy with regular traffic, while groups of pilgrims made their way towards their destinations carrying Kanwars — decorated bamboo poles with containers of Ganga water suspended from them.

Residents reported long queues on Radhakrishnan Marg and Abai Marg and on the stretch between LSR College and Nehru Place.

Traffic was also slow near the Savitri flyover towards Chirag Delhi, while a gathering at a

Kanwar camp near Shri Shiv Hanuman Mandir in Sector 2, Rohini, added to congestion in the area. At some place, there was a chaos on the roads.

The roads around some of the camps had a different scene, with groups of devotees gathered under temporary shelters, saffron flags bearing images of Hindu deities fluttering above them and Kanwariyas stopping along the route before continuing their journey.

Several pilgrims were seen travelling on motorcycles or walking in groups, carrying their kanwars on their shoulders. Their movement, along with the gatherings around camps and increased pedestrian activity in markets, affected the flow of regular traffic at several locations.

In Greater Kailash, traffic near the Archana Complex red light was affected by ongoing road-divider construction, residents said. Near

the Main Uttam Nagar red light, commuters complained that e-rickshaws, rehri-patri vendors and flower shops had occupied portions of the road.

Residents mentioned the encroachments narrowed the available carriageway, with vehicles having limited space to pass and emergency vehicles also facing difficulty in moving through the stretch.

On the Delhi-Ghaziabad side, traffic was reported to be slow near the Delhi-Meerut Expressway around Patparganj amid heavy rain. A video shared by commuters showed a car travelling on the wrong side of the road, prompting concerns over the safety of other motorists.

The Delhi Traffic Police had earlier warned of congestion on several routes because of the movement of Kanwariyas, particularly around Kalindi Kunj junction, the Okhla Barrage road and the Noida-Kalindi Kunj road.

The advisory came as the final days of the pilgrimage brought



Kanwariya carries a Kanwar, during the annual Kanwar Yatra in New Delhi on Monday

PANKAJ KUMAR

remain affected till August 12 due to the movement of pilgrims and ongoing road repair work on the Okhla Barrage-Kalindi Kunj stretch.

The police had also announced the closure of GT Road between Apsara Border and Yamuna Bridge for general traffic on August 11 and 12 and advised commuters to use alternate routes, including NH-9 and NH-44.

Rain added another layer to Monday's traffic situation, with several parts of the city receiving showers and residents reporting slow movement on busy roads.

Mayur Vihar recorded the highest rainfall at 37 mm, followed by Mungeshpur at 21 mm, Pusa at 4 mm and Narayana at 3 mm till 4.15 pm, according to the India Meteorological Department.

Delhi recorded 230.5 mm of rainfall in the first 10 days of August till 8.30 am, followed by another 4 mm between 8.30 am

and 5.30 pm on Monday, taking the total rainfall to 234.5 mm and pushing it past the monthly average of 233.1 mm.

According to the IMD, Mayur Vihar recorded the highest rainfall at 37 mm, followed by Mungeshpur at 21 mm, Pusa at 4 mm and Narayana at 3 mm till 4.15 pm.

At Safdarjung, Delhi's base weather station, 4 mm of rain was recorded between 8.30 am and 5.30 pm. Lodhi Road and the Ridge recorded 4.8 mm and 6.8 mm of rainfall, respectively, during the period. Palam received trace rainfall, while no rain was recorded at Ayanagar.

The IMD has forecast light to moderate rain in Delhi till August 16 and warned of heavy to very heavy rainfall at isolated places.

The Kanwar Yatra, which began on July 30, will conclude on Tuesday on the occasion of Shivratri.

## 2,574-cr Wazirabad Water project gets nod after 12-year delay



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The much-delayed Wazirabad Water Supply Improvement Project is set to take off with the Government's nod for the ₹2,574-crore Asian Development Bank (ADB)-assisted scheme. It was conceptualized in 2013. With the Department of Economic Affairs's screening committee giving in-principle approval, the focus is on modernising the water network, improving efficiency and ensuring a more reliable supply for residents.

The project will cover the complete water supply chain—from the treatment plant and transmission network to distribution lines and household connections in the Wazirabad Water Treatment Plant command area.

The main focus will be reducing Non-Revenue Water (NRW) caused by leakages, physical losses and unauthorised consumption.

The project, conceptualised in 2013, remained stuck for several years before being revived. With the latest approval, it is now moving towards implementation with

a focus on modernising the water network, improving efficiency and ensuring a more reliable supply for residents. The project, funded with assistance from the Asian Development Bank (ADB), will cover the complete water supply chain—from the treatment plant and transmission network to distribution lines and household connections. Under the project, old, damaged and undersized pipelines will be replaced, while new transmission and distribution lines will be laid wherever required. Existing networks will be interconnected to improve pressure, distribution and reliability.

The Wazirabad Water Treatment Plant, underground reservoirs, pumping infrastructure and distribution network will be upgraded. House service connections will be improved and regularised, while areas without formal water connections will be brought into the planned network as infrastructure is expanded, wherever technically feasible.

A major technology component will be eight interconnected Command Centres covering Delhi's water supply

GOVT TO PREPARE FIRST-EVER 30-YEAR WATER MASTER PLAN

**New Delhi:** After unveiling its ambitious Drainage Master Plan 2025 last year, the BJP Government in Delhi is now preparing a 30 year Water Master Plan for the city. This is the first time that such a plan is being prepared for the Capital. A proposal for preparation for the Detailed Project Report (DPR), bid process management and supervision for NRW Reduction across six water supply zones, has been placed before the DJB. The work is proposed to be awarded to M/s Haskoning India Consulting Pvt. Ltd. at a cost of ₹88.63 crore.

The consultant will prepare a comprehensive, integrated 30-year Water Master Plan for Delhi, besides DPR preparation, bid process management and supervision/PMC services for six water supply zones.

"Delhi cannot plan its water infrastructure one project at a time. We need a clear roadmap for the next 30 years, backed by professional planning and strong execution. The Master Plan will provide that direction, while projects like Wazirabad will translate the vision into work on the ground," Singh said. (PNS)

system. The network will include Wazirabad and Chandrawal, along with Command Centres for the West, South-West, East, North-East, North-West and South Zones. The centres will be connected through a common digital platform, providing officials with a city-wide view of Delhi's water network.

Using SCADA and digital monitoring, officials will be able to track water flow, pressure, reservoir levels, pumping stations and other critical infrastructure. Network issues can be identified faster, allowing field teams to respond and coordinate more effectively.

The Wazirabad Command Area covers a large and densely populated part of Delhi, including Burari, Model Town, Sanjay Gandhi Transport Nagar, Jahangirpuri,

Punjabi Bagh, Shakur Basti, Peeragarhi, Avantika, Pitampura and adjoining residential and institutional areas.

Informing this, Delhi Water Minister Parvesh Sahib Singh said "The objective is simple—more of the water we produce should reach the people it is meant for. We are strengthening the network from the treatment plant to the household so that Delhi gets a system that is efficient, accountable and dependable".

"For the people of Delhi, water is a daily necessity. Our responsibility is to make sure that the infrastructure behind every tap is strong, modern and reliable. The Wazirabad project is a major step in that direction. We are not planning only for today; we are building a water system that can serve Delhi for decades", he added.

## CAG flags sharp fall in capital spending under AAP Government, infra projects hit

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) Government's tenure in Delhi saw a decline in capital expenditure thereby severely impacting key infrastructure projects like roads, bridges and transport in Delhi from 2021-22 to 2024-25, as the expenditure came down from ₹8,311 crores to ₹3,695 crores.

Flagging these figures in its latest report, the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) said capital expenditure over the period showed a declining trend rather than consistent growth, indicating reduction in the GNCTD's investment in long term assets and infrastructure. The CAG report's further pointed out

The report on the finances of Delhi Government for 2024-25 analysed overall financial health, expenditure trends, debt position, and compliance with fiscal responsibility during the period when the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) was in power in Delhi.

"Capital Expenditure has declined to ₹3,695 crore in year 2024-25 as compared to ₹6,855 crore in year 2023-24. The decline was due to less expenditure in the different heads such as from ₹1,936.14 crore in 2023-24 to ₹909.30 crore in 2024-25 under head MH 5054 — Capital outlay on Roads and Bridges; from ₹1,448 crore in 2023-24 to ₹390 crore in 2024-25 under head MH 5055- Capital outlay on Road Transport; from



₹637.43 crore in 2023-24 to ₹263.97 crore in 2024-25 under head MH 4202-Capital outlay on Education, Sports, Art & Culture-General Education," the report said.

It said the overall share of capital expenditure relative to the economy has been declining in the last few years, suggesting that the GNCTD has not consistently prioritized asset creation in line with its growth objectives. This pattern implies limited fiscal space for sustained investment in infrastructure and development programs, potentially affecting long-term economic growth and service delivery.

The economic growth and gross state domestic product (GSDP) of Delhi showed a "healthy trend" in 2024-25. The GSDP at ₹12.15 lakh crore registered a growth of 9.17 per cent over the previous financial year, the report by

the Comptroller and Auditor General (CAG) of India said.

It said Delhi contributed 3.67 per cent to the gross domestic product (GDP) of India in 2024-25. GDP refers to the total value of goods and services produced within a country, while GSDP measures the same at the state or Union territory level, and both reflect economic development and overall progress.

The annual growth of per capita GSDP (6.39 per cent) measured in terms of compound average growth rate (CAGR) during 2015-2025 remained lower than the annual growth in per capita GDP (8.14 per cent) during the same period, according to the report.

The contribution of Delhi's GSDP to the GDP showed an overall declining trend during the last 10 years, decreasing from 4 per cent in 2015-16 to 3.67 per cent in

2024-25, indicating that Delhi's growth did not keep pace with the overall growth of the national economy, the report said.

"This is evidenced from the fact that the per capita GSDP of the NCT of Delhi, which was 177.07 per cent more than the per capita GDP of the country in 2015-16, was 135.34 per cent greater at the end of 2024-25. This reflects the slightly slower economic growth of the Delhi Government compared to the rest of the country," the report said. It was observed that the revenue receipts of the Delhi Government grew by 9.57 per cent, driven by higher tax collections, most notably the goods and services tax (GST).

However, non-tax revenue growth was negative (-11.04 per cent) and grants from the Centre declined, the report said.

## JNU students hold Umar Khalid book talk amid disruption claims



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The JNU Students' Union on Monday went ahead with a scheduled discussion on a book authored by former student Umar Khalid despite the cancellation of the original venue booking, with hundreds of students attending the event at an alternate location, which they said was disrupted by the ABVP.

The discussion on Khalid's book began around 3 pm as scheduled. The event was organised to mark the International Day of the World's Indigenous Peoples, according to the students' union. The university had cancelled the booking of the School of Social Sciences-I auditorium, where the discussion was originally scheduled, saying "full facts" about the programme had not been disclosed.

The Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) had subsequently announced that it would hold the discussion outside the School of Social Sciences-II building, saying the cancellation would not prevent the event from taking place.

In a statement issued on Monday, the students' union

alleged that ABVP members attempted to disrupt the event, including by trying to snatch the microphone from a speaker and allegedly misbehaving with panellists. "Despite their attempts at disruptions, our panellists and the students stood their ground and continued the event," the JNUSU said.

The union also alleged that the administration's decision to withdraw permission for the venue was aimed at curtailing academic spaces and the culture of debate and dissent on campus.

The ABVP, however, rejected the allegations of attempting to incite violence or disrupt the event.

An ABVP member from JNU said the students could have chosen several books for a discussion to mark Adivasi Diwas, including works on tribal leader Birsa Munda, but "instead they chose to have a discussion on a book by Umar Khalid, charged with JNU's image". The ABVP member said the administration cancelled the original booking after the student organisation pointed out that complete details about the programme had not been provided.

## Delhi Assembly introduces three Bills; officials face ₹5,000 penalty for service delays

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Delhi Assembly on Monday saw the introduction of three bills. The first bill, "The Delhi Right of Citizens to Time-Bound and Ease of Delivery of Services Bill, 2026," was tabled by IT Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh. Delhi Minister Ashish Sood introduced two bills — Delhi Private Universities Bill, 2026 and the Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board Amendment Bill, 2026.

The Delhi (Right of Citizens to Time Bound and Ease of Delivery of Services) Bill, 2026 fixes officials' accountability for delaying service delivery without valid reasons or

improperly reject applications. A penalty of ₹250 per day, up to a maximum of ₹5,000, may be imposed on the official concerned. A similar penalty ranging from ₹250 to ₹5,000 will apply in cases of wrongful rejection of applications, with the amount being recoverable as a penalty from their salaries, according to the Bill copy.

The penalty mechanism applies in two situations: delay without valid reason and wrongful rejection of applications. In both cases, the penalty ranges from ₹250 per day to a maximum of ₹5,000. The official concerned will be given an opportunity to present their case before any action is



taken. The legislation will cover all Delhi Government departments including MCD, NDMC, Delhi Cantonment Board, Delhi Jal Board, DDA, and other notified local bodies and institutions.

The Delhi Private

Universities Bill, 2026, aims to establish a framework for setting up private universities in Delhi, reserving 25 percent of seats in each course for Delhi students and providing for multi-storey campuses suited to

the capital's limited land availability. A Delhi Private Universities Regulatory Authority will be established to ensure quality, transparency, and accountability.

Sood said the bill addresses a significant shortage of higher education seats in Delhi. Of the approximately 3.13 lakh students who sit for Class 12 examinations each year in Delhi, only around 1.51 lakh physical higher education seats are available in the city. Delhi University alone accounts for around 71,000 of these seats, while IITs and other institutions offer only 1,200 to 1,500 seats. An estimated 45 to 50 percent of seats in central universities in Delhi go to students from

other states, leaving a gap of approximately 1 lakh to 1.5 lakh seats annually for Delhi's Class 12 graduates. Many Delhi students are currently compelled to seek admission at private universities in the NCR because of the shortage within the city.

The Delhi Urban Shelter Improvement Board Amendment Bill, 2026, proposes cut off date from January 1, 2006 to January 2025. The existing law defines a jhuggi-jhopri basti, among other criteria, as a settlement having at least 50 households existing on January 1, 2006.

Additionally, it allows the involvement of the private sector or slum cooperatives in the redevelopment projects.

## DU warns students against roadside parking, cites emergency access issues

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Delhi University administration has advised students to park their vehicles only in designated areas and refrain from roadside parking, citing frequent traffic congestion and concerns over access for emergency vehicles.

In an advisory issued by the Proctor on Monday, the university said it had received numerous complaints from students, faculty members and staff regarding unauthorised parking around the campus.

Vehicles were frequently found parked on both sides of roads including Chhatra



Marg, GC Narang Marg, Sudhir Bose Marg, Guru Tegh Bahadur Road, Shreya Mishra Marg and University Road, as well as near Gwyer Hall Canteen, it said. The university said the parking caused severe traffic congestion and obstructed vehicle movement.

"Such unauthorised parking may also create serious difficulties in the event of an untoward incident on

the campus, as emergency vehicles, including ambulances and fire-tenders, may be unable to reach the site promptly," the advisory said.

Students have been strictly advised against parking on the aforementioned roads or at any other location where parking is prohibited or traffic obstructed.

The university warned that violations may invite appropriate action by the Delhi Traffic Police or the concerned police station under applicable rules.

The administration also appealed to all stakeholders to cooperate in maintaining smooth traffic movement and ensuring the campus safety and accessibility.

## Social welfare department to install CCTV after biometric machines found damaged with water

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Suspecting that some of the biometric machines installed at its offices to record attendance of staff were "deliberately damaged" by pouring water into them, Delhi Government's social welfare department has decided to install CCTV cameras for catching the culprits, officials said on Monday.

The issue was discussed at a recent meeting chaired by a deputy director (administration) of the department.

At the meeting, the charges of several district offices and welfare homes and institutions reported that the biometric attendance



devices installed on their premises were frequently malfunctioning.

The superintendent of the caretaking branch told the meeting that repeated complaints of malfunctioning of biometric devices were being received from various offices.

It was also reported that

during inspections carried out by the service engineers, water was found inside many biometric devices despite there being no water source or plumbing nearby.

"Such circumstances give rise to a reasonable apprehension that certain biometric devices may have been deliberately damaged," according to the minutes of the meeting.

In view of the "seriousness" of the issue, it has been decided that all biometric attendance devices installed in the district offices as well as welfare homes will be placed under CCTV surveillance to safeguard the equipment and ensure accountability, the document stated.



## IN FOCUS



A commuter covers himself with a plastic sheet in New Delhi PANKAJ KUMAR

## Punjab passes bill on capping school fee hike at 5 per cent



Punjab Education Minister Harjot Singh Bains

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Chandigarh

The Punjab Assembly on Monday unanimously passed a bill paving the way for capping fee hikes by private schools at 5 per cent per annum.

On the concluding day of the monsoon session of the Punjab Vidhan Sabha, Education Minister Harjot Singh Bains tabled the Punjab Regulation of Fee of Unaided Educational Institutions (Amendment) Bill, 2026 in the House.

According to the bill, no unaided educational institution shall enhance its fee by more than 5 per cent annually.

Winding up the discussion on the Bill, Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann said it will cover around 7,800 private schools in the state, directly benefiting around 32 lakh students. It will bring big relief, asserted Mann on capping fee hike at 5 per cent. Mann said the ceiling will cover not only the tuition fees but also all mandatory charges and funds collected by schools.

According to the bill, fee

includes all amounts charged, including tuition fee, development fee, annual charges, activity charges, smart class or technology charges, transportation charges (where not separately contracted), laboratory and library charges, examination charges, and any other funds.

As per the bill, educational institutions will be required to refund parents in cases where cumulative fee increases have exceeded 15 per cent over the last three years.

The Punjab Government will also conduct forensic audits of private schools to identify excess collections and ensure that the additional amount is refunded to parents, with violations attracting fines of ₹50,000 for the first offence, ₹1 lakh for the second and cancellation of affiliation for the third.

On the bill, Mann said it marks a decisive step by the Punjab Government to curb profiteering in the education sector and ensure that private schools function in the interest of students and parents rather than commercial gain.

## Girl's clothing her personal choice, says Delhi HC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Delhi High Court on Monday stated that a girl's choice of clothing is her personal decision and suggesting that her wearing jeans might 'corrupt young boys' reflects a deeply troubling and unacceptable mindset.

Justice Chandrasekharan Sudha, while convicting a man of sexually harassing a girl in 2013, observed that instead of controlling the clothes of girls, parents and society must teach their children to control their conduct, respect personal boundaries and treat every human with dignity.

The girl alleged that the accused, her neighbour, stalked her, made sexually coloured remarks and touched her inappropriately. Before the high court, the State challenged the acquittal of the accused by the trial court in 2014.

In the judgement, the court took exception to the girl's character assassination in the "line of cross-examination and argu-



ments" adopted by the counsel for the accused in the trial, noting that the questions put to her included her "western" dressing, religion of the people in the locality and their objections to her clothing.

"What a girl or woman chooses to wear is a matter of her personal choice. Neither her neighbours, nor society, nor the accused, nor counsel appearing in a court of law has any right to dictate her clothing. It is simply none of their concern. The suggestion that a woman wearing jeans may 'corrupt young boys' reflects a deeply trou-

bling and unacceptable mindset," said the court.

"The answer does not lie in controlling the clothes of girls and women. Parents and society must instead teach their children to control their conduct, respect personal boundaries and treat every human with dignity, whether at home or outside," it added.

Justice Sudha noted that the cross-examination in the present case was "wholly irrelevant" and "improper", and ought to have been disallowed at the very outset by the trial judge.

Asserting that a woman's choice of attire neither

diminishes her dignity nor serves as justification for unlawful conduct directed against her, the court held, "Questions based on a woman's clothing, character, lifestyle, religion or personal choices, unless strictly relevant to an issue arising in the case, must not be permitted."

The court emphasised that "even a woman of easy virtue" was entitled to protect her person and the only question in the present case was whether an offence was committed.

The religion of the residents of the locality, and the clothes worn by her have no connection with that issue, it said.

"PW4 (girl) may be wearing clothes not palatable or approved by the accused or the other residents. That is no ground to disbelieve or discard her testimony. The grounds on which the trial court disbelieved the case are immaterial, and they do not in any way affect the core prosecution case," the court stated.

## CM Shivakumar sets 2027 target for Yettinahole project

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Kolar (Karnataka)

The Congress Government has resolved to bring Yettinahole water to Kolar and Chikkaballapura by the end of 2027, Chief Minister DK Shivakumar said on Monday.

Speaking at the inauguration of various departmental development projects in Malur taluk of Kolar district, he said the Government had added land rights as its sixth guarantee and water security as its seventh guarantee, in addition to the five existing guarantee schemes (Shakti, Gruha Lakshmi, Gruha Jyothi, Yuva Nidhi, and Anna Bhagya).

He assured that the Government was committed to bringing Yettinahole water to Kolar and Chikkaballapura by the end of 2027.

"The JD(S) State President (HD Kumaraswamy) may joke that the Yettinahole project is not possible. Nothing worthwhile comes easily. This project is difficult, but should we not make an effort? We are committed to bringing water from the Western Ghats through Hassan to Kolar and Chikkaballapura," he said.

According to officials, the "Yettinahole Integrated



Drinking Water Project' envisages lifting 24.01 TMC of water available during the monsoon from Yettinahole, Kadumane Hole, Keri Hole and Hongada Halla in the Western Ghats in Sakleshpur taluk of Hassan district.

The project aims to mitigate the acute drinking water shortage in drought-prone areas, particularly in Chikkaballapura and Kolar districts, as well as other needy areas of Hassan, Chikkamagaluru, Tumakuru, Ramanagara and Bengaluru Rural districts.

He said efforts had already been made to bring water up to Tumakuru and that 104 lakes had been filled through the KC Valley project, while work was underway to fill another 65 lakes through the HN Valley project.

"We have decided to fill more than 700 lakes with

treated water. Our objective is to recharge groundwater, fill lakes and ensure that water reaches farmers," he said.

The CM said details of the projects launched by his Government would be announced on August 15.

"We have formulated several programmes to address the water shortage in Kolar and Chikkaballapura," he said.

The CM praised the farmers of Kolar district for their resilience.

"The people of Karnataka should remember the farmers of this district. Even when the groundwater level fell to 2,000 feet, they did not lose hope or resort to extreme steps. Instead, they produced milk, vegetables, silk and flowers and supplied them to Bengaluru. They demonstrated their self-respect and determination," he said.

## Congress opposes FCRA amendments in Shillong

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Shillong

The Meghalaya Congress on Monday took out a protest rally here demanding withdrawal of the proposed Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026. The Meghalaya Pradesh Congress Committee (MPCC) took out rally from Fire Brigade Ground in Laitumkhray to Don Bosco Square in the city.

The Congress alleged that the proposed FCRA amendment bill could threaten institutions receiving foreign funds and questioned the ruling NPP's position on the legislation. MPCC president Vincent H Pala, who led the protest along with other senior party leaders, alleged

that the proposed amendments could adversely affect schools, hospitals, churches, NGOs and charitable institutions dependent on foreign contributions.

Pala raised particular concern over Clause 16(a), alleging that institutions could face the risk of losing their properties if their FCRA registration was not renewed or was surrendered.

"If you cannot renew your FCRA, or if you surrender it, the Government can take over your property," Pala said.

He said several educational and social institutions in Meghalaya depend on foreign contributions and warned that non-renewal of their licences could affect students and beneficiaries.



## Agriculture now about drones, AI, biotechnology, says UP Governor

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Lucknow

Uttar Pradesh Governor Anandiben Patel, while highlighting the evolution of agriculture on Monday, said that women who earlier watched their families farm from the field boundaries are now operating drones to spray fertilisers and pesticides.

Addressing the 28th convocation of Acharya Narendra Deva University of Agriculture and Technology in Ayodhya, Patel said agriculture was no longer confined to fields and ploughs, but had expanded to include drones, data, artificial intelligence (AI), biotechnology and entrepreneurship.

Emphasising that scientific and technical knowledge acquired by students should now reach farms and villages, Patel urged students to ensure that their knowledge did not remain confined to laboratories and books but was visible in villages and fields.

"Agriculture today is not just the story of the plough and the field. It is also the story of agricultural drones, data, artificial intelligence, biotechnology and entrepreneurship," she said, according to an official statement.

"In the coming times, a university student could start an agricultural enter-



prise that connects thousands of farmers with markets; develop an app that provides farmers with information about their crops, weather and markets; or establish a startup that develops technology to produce more with less water," she said.

Urging students to ensure that they apply their knowledge in villages and fields, she said the combination of their knowledge and farmers' experience could become the basis of a new agricultural revolution.

A total of 774 students, including 584 men and 190 women, were awarded degrees at the convocation.

The governor also expressed concern over the

relatively low participation of women in agricultural education and urged the university to make special efforts to attract more female students.

Initiatives such as "Drone Didi", she said, were providing rural women with new identities and opportunities. Women who earlier watched their families farm from the field boundaries were now operating drones to spray fertilisers and pesticides, she said. ML Jat, secretary, Department of Agricultural Research and Education, and director general of the Indian Council of Agricultural Research, who was the chief guest, urged students to become job creators instead of merely seeking employment.

## Student anger reaches Jharkhand Assembly

Student leaders said their agitation was against alleged irregularities in recruitment examinations and the system, and was not directed against any police personnel or individual. They claimed that they were trying to carry forward the movement peacefully.

A large number of security personnel have now been deployed in and around the Assembly. The administration is continuously monitoring the situation and making efforts to maintain peace and public order in the area.

## LeT threat puts Kashmiri Pandits on edge

"We have not forgotten the targeted killings of Rahul Bhat and several other Kashmiri Pandits, school teachers, Deepak Chand, Supinder Kour and Rajni Bala in 2021-22," they said.

Another Kashmiri Pandit Government employee, posted in north Kashmir district of Baramulla, said that the situation was worrisome in the south Kashmir districts but migrant employees were reporting for duty in the central and north Kashmir districts. "We are all worried about our safety and security. The names of employees have been published in the threat letter," they said.

Dr Agnishekar, convenor of Panun Kashmir, an organisation of displaced Kashmiri Pandits, has urged the LG of Jammu and Kashmir to immediately direct the police and security agencies to undertake a comprehensive threat assessment of all persons named in the communication and their immediate families.

"Whether the perpetrators actually possess such information or are attempting psychological warfare must be established immediately. The authorities must investigate the source of the information, the digital trail behind the communication and whether any surveillance, profiling or reconnaissance of the targeted persons

has taken place," he said.

Sounding a word of caution, Dr Agnishekar said the communication represented a serious escalation because it went beyond generic threats and appeared to identify individuals as potential targets while claiming access to information about their families, locations and places of work.

"The publication of names and personal contact details, accompanied by explicit threats to pursue the individuals and their families, is a matter of grave concern. This is not something that can be dismissed as mere rhetoric. It has the unmistakable potential to intimidate the targeted individuals and terrorise the wider Kashmiri Pandit community," Dr. Agnishekar said. "The Kashmiri Pandit community has already witnessed what happens when threats are ignored or treated lightly. The administration must not wait for a threat to materialise into violence before taking preventive action," he asserted.

## India faces 70% urban bus deficit, finds new...

People rely entirely on informal minibus, auto-rickshaw and shared two-wheeler services in such cities.

The study pointed out that, Madhya Pradesh, West Bengal, Karnataka, Maharashtra and Uttar Pradesh, hold the largest absolute fleets, together accounting for more than half the national active fleet.

In contrast, India's cumulative national stage-carriage fleet reached 1,555,691 buses by FY2025-26 (with an active operational fleet of 10,82,769 vehicles), but the vast majority serve long-distance intercity and semi-urban routes.

The study said severe geographical disparities exist, as five states — Madhya Pradesh, West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Maharashtra and Karnataka — concentrate 55 per cent of the active national fleet. Compounding the shortage, 40,000 urban buses in service are overaged (past their 15-year statutory life), burning 20-30 per cent more fuel and incurring maintenance costs of

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₹15 to ₹20 per kilometre. Nationwide, an unprecedented 5.8 lakh buses across all categories will reach end-of-life between 2026 and 2030. Deep financial distress persists within STUs, where accumulated losses frequently surpass annual operating revenues due to inefficient cost-recovery structures.

"India must scale its average urban bus procurement rate 17-fold, rising sharply from 2,500 buses annually to an average of 41,500 per year across three strategic waves including the Catch-Up phase (FY2027-31) requiring 44,000 to 50,000 buses annually to clear backlogs; the Stabilisation phase (FY2032-41) stabilising at 9,000 to 36,000 buses annually to absorb population growth; and the Replacement phase (FY2042-46) peaking at 71,000 to 78,000 buses annually as the initial catch-up fleet hits its 15-year statutory retirement limit," it said.

Reaching a 100 per cent EV share in new procurements by FY2039-40 culminates in 6.04 lakh electric urban buses in service by 2047. Powering this zero-emission fleet requires 121 GWh of active battery capacity and an annual electricity demand of ~37,000 MU — a fully manageable 1.8 per cent of India's total 2024 power generation.

"The cost of transition is projected for three growth scenarios. The conservative scenario reaches 44 buses per lakh population by 2047, maintaining a 3.36-lakh bus fleet via 4.2 lakh procurements at a CapEx of ₹6.55 lakh crore. The accelerated scenario meets MoHUA benchmarks by 2030 and lifts provision to 60 buses per lakh by 2040, operating 4.58 lakh buses via 6.8 lakh procurements at ₹10.55 lakh crore. The recommended target scenario matches global standards of 88 buses per lakh by 2047, expanding the operational fleet to 6.71 lakh buses (90 per cent electric), and 9.1 lakh procurements, requiring a total CapEx of ₹14.20 lakh crore," it said.

The Prime Minister Narendra Modi's flagship scheme PM e-Bus Sewa (2023-27) has sanctioned 10,000 e-buses with a dedicated budget of ₹20,000 crore specifically targeting deployment in small and medium-sized cities. In another scheme called PM e-Drive, 14,028 e-buses

with a budget of ₹4,391 crore focused on large metropolitan cities has been sanctioned. According to the study, FAME-I added about 425 buses through pilot departments; FAME-II added about 5,135 deployed of the roughly 6,862 sanctioned to February 2025; and PM e-Bus Sewa had delivered about 5,000 of its 10,000-bus target by early 2026.

## Shah to reply to debate on student protests...

The Monsoon session, which started on July 20, has seen repeated adjournments and virtually no business except the debate on the anti-paper leaks bill — The Public Examination (Prevention of Unfair Means) Amendment Bill, 2026 — which was passed by Parliament. The opposition parties initially protested over the NEET paper leak and alleged theft of donations at the Ayodhya Ram temple. They later pressed for a discussion on police action against students protesting over the NEET paper leak and also demanded the presence of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and the home minister and their statements.

## India condemns Slovenia embassy vandalism

The ministry also urged law enforcement agencies in Slovenia and other countries to take firm action against what it described as hateful propaganda and disinformation being circulated by anti-India groups.

"We also call upon law enforcement authorities elsewhere to take note of the hateful propaganda and disinformation being spread by such groups," the MEA said.

The embassy premises were reportedly defaced with slogans including "Khalistan Zindabad". The incident also involved the defacement of the Indian flag and parts of the embassy building.

India's diplomatic missions have faced similar

incidents in the past in several Western countries, including the United Kingdom, the United States and Canada. Indian authorities have previously linked some such incidents to pro-Khalistan activists.

There was no immediate public response from Slovenian authorities to the incident. India's latest statement comes amid continued concerns over the security of its diplomatic and consular establishments abroad and the spread of anti-India propaganda.

The MEA has called for appropriate action against those responsible and reiterated that diplomatic premises must be protected in accordance with international obligations.

## BKI terror plot foiled

Early investigations show he collected the grenade from a Dead Letter Box (DLB) near Adampur in Jalandhar, following instructions from handlers abroad.

A DLB is a secret method used by terror groups and organised networks to transfer weapons, money, or instructions without meeting face-to-face, helping them avoid detection.

Police have registered FIR No. 124, dated 9 August 2026, at Sadar Nawanshahr Police Station in SBS Nagar under sections 113(1) and 113(3) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and sections 4 and 5 of the Explosive Substances Act.

Police are now trying to find out more about the network, including foreign handlers, local support, and all connections involved in the plot. This operation is part of Punjab Police's ongoing efforts against cross-border terror groups in 2026. By the end of July, Punjab Police had already broken up 10 similar groups and arrested 137 people. They seized 49 hand grenades, 12 RDX-based IEDs, 3,756 kg of RDX, seven automatic rifles, 76 pistols and revolvers, nine detonators, one RPG with a launcher, and several communication devices. Authorities also intercepted 183 drones and stopped several attempts to use cameras to send video across the border.





# RICS Summit: No decision yet on Bangladesh PM's India visit

ASHOKE RAJ  
■ New Delhi

Foreign Minister Dr Khalilur Rahman on Monday said the Government has not yet decided whether Prime Minister Tarique Rahman will travel to New Delhi next month to attend the outreach session of the 18th BRICS Summit.

He also urged the media to distinguish between two separate invitations extended by India — one for a bilateral visit by the prime minister and another for his participation in the BRICS outreach session in his capacity as chair of the Bay of Bengal Initiative for Multi-Sectoral Technical and Economic Cooperation (BIMSTEC).

"First of all, I am not an astrologer. So, I cannot predict on which exact day it will happen," the foreign minister told reporters at the Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

"Secondly, the BIMSTEC invitation was not extended to the prime minister personally. It was addressed to the chairperson of BIMSTEC," he said.

Dr Khalilur was briefing reporters after Indian High Commissioner to Bangladesh Dinesh Trivedi paid a courtesy call on Prime Minister Tarique Rahman at the Secretariat.



Bangladesh Foreign Minister Khalilur Rahman

The foreign minister said Bangladesh had received two invitations from India. One was extended by Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi for a bilateral visit, while the other was extended to the BIMSTEC chairperson to attend the outreach session of the BRICS Summit.

During his meeting with the prime minister, the Indian high commissioner conveyed greetings from Prime Minister Narendra Modi and expressed India's intention to work with the Government and people of Bangladesh in a positive, constructive and forward-looking manner.

The two sides exchanged views on matters of mutual interest and discussed ways to further strengthen bilateral relations through a people-centric approach.

The high commissioner

also paid a courtesy call on Home Minister Salahuddin Ahmed. Their discussions focused on bilateral relations and areas of common interest, including security cooperation.

Trivedi conveyed India's willingness to strengthen people-centric cooperation across various areas, based on mutual interest, mutual benefit and mutual sensitivities.

India on August 4 confirmed that it had invited Prime Minister Tarique Rahman to attend the BRICS Summit in New Delhi in his capacity as the current chair of BIMSTEC. The invitation is separate from a bilateral invitation extended to him earlier this year.

"You would be aware that a formal invitation to Bangladesh Prime Minister

Tarique Rahman to visit India was extended when he assumed office in February 2026," Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) Spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said during a media briefing in New Delhi.

Regarding the BRICS Summit, Jaiswal said India had separately invited the Bangladesh prime minister, in his capacity as the current chair of BIMSTEC, to attend the outreach session of the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi.

"The invitation has been extended as per the standard practice being followed in BRICS for the outreach sessions. Other heads of regional groups have also been invited in a similar manner," he said.

India will host the 18th BRICS Summit in New Delhi on September 12-13. The summit is expected to focus on global cooperation, trade and sustainable development.

BIMSTEC comprises seven countries in the Bay of Bengal region: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Nepal, Sri Lanka and Thailand.

Bangladesh assumed the chairmanship of BIMSTEC in April last year for a two-year term, reaffirming its commitment to advancing regional cooperation and development.

## Rahul Gandhi condemns police action on Jharkhand students

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Monday condemned the use of force against students protesting in Jharkhand and called on the State Government to continue to hear the protesters out and resolve their issues immediately.

The Congress is part of the Hemant Soren Government in Jharkhand.



Gandhi's remarks came after police in Ranchi used water cannons, lobbed tear gas shells, and lathi-charged job aspirants as they breached barricades and attempted to reach the state assembly, protesting the alleged recruitment exam irregularities.

"My message to protesting students in Jharkhand is clear. We condemn any violence against peacefully protesting students," he said during a press conference.

"It does not matter where

it is happening. We condemn it, we are against it, we do not recommend it, and we do not support it. We are very clear," the leader of opposition in the Lok Sabha said.

"As long as protests are peaceful, we are against any attack on it with violence," he added.

Earlier, in a post on social media, he said the use of force against students protesting in

Jharkhand is wrong.

"Students have a right to peaceful protest, and only dialogue can yield solutions. The Jharkhand Government must continue to hear these students out and resolve their issues immediately," he said.

Several protesters claimed they were injured in the police action, which took place when they reached the final barricade near Jagannathpur Temple on the road to the Jharkhand Assembly, which is in session.

## States Focus



### DELAY IN J&K STATEHOOD UNDERMINING DEMOCRACY: NC

The prolonged delay in restoring Statehood to Jammu and Kashmir was not only affecting the pace of development but also undermining the democratic aspirations of its people, a senior National Conference leader said on Monday. National Conference Provincial President Jammu, Rattan Lal Gupta, in a statement, urged the Centre to immediately introduce the Statehood Restoration Bill in Parliament and fulfil its assurance given to the people of the Union Territory.

"Home Minister Amit Shah should immediately introduce the Statehood Restoration Bill in Parliament and fulfil the assurance given to the people of Jammu and Kashmir. This will strengthen democracy, restore public confidence and reaffirm the Centre's commitment to the federal spirit of the Constitution," Gupta said. (PTI)



### NTA TO RELEASE UGC-NET JUNE 2026 ANSWER KEY THIS WEEK

The National Testing Agency (NTA) on Monday said it will publish the provisional answer key for the UGC-NET June 2026 examination on its official website this week.

The NTA will also release answer keys for CSIR-NET and ICAR AIEEA (PG) and AICE (PhD) 2026 examinations. "The provisional answer keys for the UGC-NET June 2026 examination will be published on the official website this week, along with the provisional answer keys for the CSIR-NET and ICAR AIEEA (PG) & AICE (PhD) 2026 examinations," the NTA said in a public notice. The NTA said candidates will be able to view the provisional answer keys and raise challenges within the notified window. Detailed instructions will be provided at the time of publication, it said. The NTA advised candidates to regularly check its official website and rely only on official communications from the agency. (PTI)

## DMK and Congress spar over delimitation amid Centre's push



Dayanidhi Maran

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The DMK and the Congress sparred publicly over delimitation on Monday, trading charges of "petty politics" and political opportunism, at a time when the Centre is making renewed efforts to build support for a contentious legislation on redrawing Lok Sabha constituencies by reaching out to opposition parties and NDA constituents.

The spat comes days after a meeting of Tamil Nadu MPs convened by ruling TVK founder and Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay to oppose delimitation, which the Congress attended but the DMK boycotted.

DMK MP and its Lok Sabha Deputy Leader Dayanidhi Maran questioned on X why the Congress is putting up a "No Delimitation" front only in Tamil Nadu while remaining silent in the four States where it is in power.

"Why is the Congress staging a No Delimitation drama only in Tamil Nadu?" Maran said, asking whether the party would question Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy, who has

advocated a hybrid model for the exercise in the past. Maran also questioned the Congress's participation in the TVK-convened MPs' meeting, calling it a political spectacle.

"A party that cannot articulate a clear and consistent position on delimitation has no moral authority to preach to Tamil Nadu. What the Congress is indulging in here is nothing more than petty politics," the DMK leader said. "The people of Tamil Nadu will not be taken in by the theatrics of a reels-driven party that functions as the Congress party's proxy Government," he added.

Congress's Lok Sabha MP from Telangana's Bhongir, Kiran Kumar Chamala, considered close to Reddy, hit back at Maran, accusing him of "distorting facts" and asserting that his party's position against population-based delimitation has not changed.

Chamala said Reddy had attended a conference of southern chief ministers and political leaders convened by DMK leader MK Stalin as a chief minister and "categorically opposed population-based delimitation".

## CM Adhikari leads *Har Ghar Tiranga Yatra* in Kolkata

SAUGAR SENGUPTA  
■ Kolkata

Whorls of tri-colour on Monday overflowed and covered parts of central Kolkata, with a sea of humanity joining Bengal Chief Minister Suwendu Adhikari in the first-ever official Har Ghar Tiranga Yatra organised in the State.

Several thousand people joined the rally — raising slogans of Jai Hind and Vande Mataram — that started at the junction of Eden Gardens and Akashvani Bhavan off Calcutta High Court and stamped down the iconic Red Road before culminating at the Victoria Memorial.

Even as the Har Ghar Tiranga campaign took place officially for the first time in Bengal months after the BJP



roared to power, the Chief Minister walked down the central business district flanked by a galaxy of his cabinet colleagues and senior bureaucrats, including the Chief Secretary and Director General of Police, all joining the rendi-

## NCERT's deemed university status to promote research, innovation: Govt

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The deemed university status granted to NCERT will strengthen it to promote educational research and innovation and collaborate with national and international agencies, the Lok Sabha was informed on Monday.

In a written reply, Minister of State for Education Sukanta Majumdar said the status would further reinforce NCERT's role as a think tank and a national resource institution in providing technical support to the Central Government as well as State Governments.

The application of the National Council of Educational Research and Training (NCERT), New Delhi, for grant of Institution Deemed to be University status was examined by the University Grants Commission (UGC) through



its expert committee as per the provisions of the UGC (Institutions Deemed to be Universities) Regulations, 2023, Majumdar said.

The minister said the committee, after an overall assessment, recommended granting NCERT the status of an Institution Deemed to be University.

"Considering the advice of UGC, the Ministry of Education, vide notification

dated March 30, 2026, declared NCERT, New Delhi, as an Institution Deemed to be University under Section 3 of the UGC Act, 1956," Majumdar said.

"The said declaration was subject to the condition that it shall take appropriate steps to commence research programmes as well as doctoral and innovative academic programmes," he added.

## Received ₹1.89 cr through e-auction of PM mementos in 2025, says Govt

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Union Government received ₹1.89 crore through the 2025 edition of the e-auction of mementoes and gifts presented to Prime Minister Narendra Modi, according to data shared by Tourism Minister Gajendra Singh Shekhawat.

He shared the data in his written response to a query in Lok Sabha on Monday.

He was asked for details of the amount which the Government received from the e-auctions and the dates on which they took place during the last five years.

The amount received by the Government through the e-auction of mementoes and gifts for the seventh edition (2025) stood at ₹1.89 crore, while the corresponding figure for the sixth edition was ₹2.24 crore, according to the data.



In its sixth edition in 2024, over 600 mementoes and gifts were put on e-auction.

Shekhawat, on the eve of the start of the 2024 edition, had told mediapersons at the National Gallery of Modern Art (NGMA) here that the collection mirrored India's rich tapestry of culture, spirituality, history and politics.

The minister had then said that the sixth edition was part of a series of successful auctions of the prime minister's mementos, first

launched in January 2019.

These auctions had garnered more than ₹50 crore in the first five editions, the culture ministry had then said.

In a query in the Lok Sabha, Shekhawat was also asked about the number of times such auctions were organised before 2014.

To which he replied, "Before 2019, no auction of mementoes and gifts was organised by the National Gallery of Modern Arts (NGMA)."

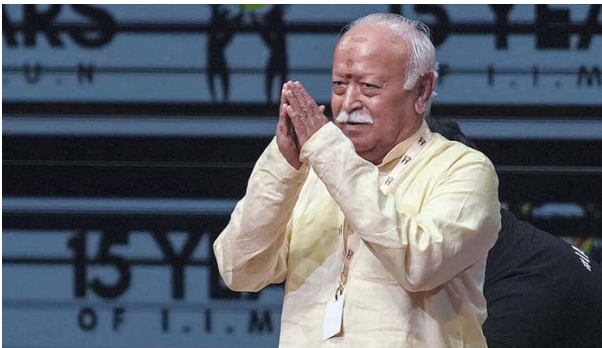
## RSS meet to focus on Gen Z, coordination with affiliates

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Senior functionaries of the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) and its 32 affiliates, including the BJP, will assemble in Andhra Pradesh's Visakhapatnam district next week for an annual coordination meeting, which will discuss issues related to Gen Z among other contemporary topics.

The three-day meeting will begin on August 19 at Gudiolova, Visakhapatnam. RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat and general secretary Dattatreya Hosabale will preside over the meeting, which will conclude on August 21.

"During the meeting, all the 32 organisations will share



RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat

information about their respective activities and present their observations and suggestions on various important subjects," RSS national media and publicity department head Sunil Ambekar said in a statement. He said the meeting will

discuss matters such as enhancing mutual coordination and cooperation, as well as public welfare and policy-related issues.

"The meeting is also expected to discuss issues such as population imbalance, 'Nasha Mukti' (de-

addiction), creating awareness among the youth, implementation of 'Panch Parivartan', the Bharatiya concept of development, and other related matters," the senior RSS functionary said.

Sources said the meeting will also discuss "issues related to Gen Z".

The meeting will be attended by the top office-bearers of all the 32 RSS affiliates, including their presidents and national organising secretaries.

"Sarsangchalak Dr Mohan Bhagwat, Sarkaryawah Dattatreya Hosabale and all Sahsarkaryawahs and Akhil Bharatiya Karyavibhag Pramukhs will be present at the meeting," the RSS said in the statement.

## Youth power, *Vande Mataram* theme for I-Day

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Youth power and their contributions to national development, as well as 150 years of 'Vande Mataram', will be the theme of this year's Independence Day celebrations on August 15, the defence ministry said on Monday.

At the same time, Defence Secretary RK Singh said the plan to celebrate the success and contribution of youth during the celebrations at the Red Fort "predates" the students' protest at the Jantar Mantar.

"The celebrations this year will also commemorate Yuva Shakti, acknowledging the contribution of young India in building a



Viksit Bharat by 2047.

"Youths are a critical part of our journey towards a developed Bharat because they will both be contributing to it and will hopefully be gaining from it. That is the only reason," he said at a media briefing.

"The plan to celebrate the success and contribution of youth at the Independence Day celebrations predates any other event," he said.

"I can assure you that this planning predates the Jantar Mantar agitation," he added. Singh said that as 2026

marks 150 years of 'Vande Mataram', the national song will be sung from the ramparts of the Red Fort for the first time as a tribute to its enduring legacy.

It will be sung at the start of the Independence Day celebrations. Prime Minister Narendra Modi will unfurl the national flag and the national anthem will be sung.

To a question, the defence secretary said Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi has been invited to the event, and the seating arrangements for the invitees will be strictly followed as per the Table of Precedence (ToP).

Singh said that as per ToP, Gandhi's seat will be after the Cabinet ministers.





## States Focus



### NAVY CHIEF SWAMINATHAN BEGINS 4-DAY VISIT TO MAURITIUS

Navy Chief Admiral Krishna Swaminathan began a four-day visit to Mauritius on Monday to solidify bilateral maritime engagement with the strategically located Indian Ocean nation.

Admiral Krishnan will hold talks with top leadership of the Mauritian Government on matters of “mutual interest” such as maritime security, defence cooperation, capacity building and military collaboration, according to the Indian Navy.

“The visit is part of India’s continued engagement to strengthen bilateral maritime cooperation and deepen defence ties with Mauritius, an extremely valued partner in the Indian Ocean Region,” it said. (PTI)

Former Rajasthan chief minister Ashok Gehlot on Monday urged the Centre to address shortcomings in the ‘Viksit Bharat-Guarantee for Rozgar Evam Aajeevika Mission Grameen’ (VB-G RAM G) scheme, alleging that it has failed in its very first month and could worsen rural unemployment. In a statement, Gehlot claimed that the scheme, which replaced the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) from July 1, has performed poorly. “The VB-G RAM G scheme has proved to be a complete failure in its very first month of implementation,” he said. Citing a media report, the senior Congress leader said only 7.67 crore person-days of employment were generated under the scheme in July 2026. (PTI)



### VB-G RAM G COULD WORSEN RURAL UNEMPLOYMENT: GEHLOT

## India expands e-visa entry points

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH  
■ New Delhi

The Government of India has announced 11 more International Ports where e-visa holders can enter the country. These include nine land ports and two airports, bringing the total number of entry points to 88. There are now 37 airports, 38 sea-ports, and 13 land ports, making India’s electronic visa system more accessible and convenient.

The new airports added are Bhopal and Tirupati. The land ports now included are Agartala, Darranga, Gede, Ghojadanga, Haridaspur, Jaigaon, Dawki, Moreh, and Attari (Road). With these additions, travellers arriving by air, sea, or land have more options to use the e-visa system.

This update is part of ongoing efforts led by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Union Home Minister Amit Shah. In recent years, the Government has aimed to make the visa process more open, simple, and efficient. This aims to make travel



easier for foreign visitors and to improve technology for better security. Introducing the e-visa was a major step. It started in 2014 for people from 43 countries and now covers citizens from 172 countries.

India processes about 95 per cent of e-visa applications in less than 72 hours, showing the system’s efficiency. There are 17 types of e-visas for different needs, including tourism, mountaineering, business (B-1 to B-6), medical (M-1 to M-4), student (S-1 and S-2), transit, miscellaneous (X-1), and group visas for cruise passen-

gers. The expansion of entry points is expected to make the e-visa even more useful and attractive. By allowing arrivals at more land borders and regional airports, the government is making it easier to reach destinations beyond the main gateways.

This update is especially helpful for travellers from neighbouring countries and those visiting different regions of India, from the Northeast to the central and southern states. By improving the visa system, India shows it is committed to being more open and welcoming. More entry points,

faster processing, and a variety of visa types help boost tourism, medical visits, education, and business. Using digital systems also improves security.

With the total of designated International Ports now standing at 88, this update is another step in modernising India’s entry process. Foreign visitors with e-visas now have more choices for where to arrive, making travel planning easier. As the program expands, India continues to welcome travellers from around the world while keeping border security a priority.

## Jharkhand CID arrests ex-JPSC chairperson

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Ranchi

Jharkhand CID on Monday arrested former JPSC chairperson L Kiangte in connection with alleged irregularities in the recruitment examinations, a top official of the State probe agency said.

The 1988-batch IAS officer, who was appointed as Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) chairperson in February last year after he retired as the state’s chief secretary, tendered his resignation on July 22.

“We have arrested former JPSC chairperson L Kiangte in connection with irregularities in recruitment examinations,” Additional Director General (CID), Manoj



Former JPSC chairperson L Kiangte

Kaushik, said. Kiangte had been questioned four times since July 28.

The arrest comes a day after all three JPSC members resigned amid massive protests by aspirants over alleged irregularities in recruitment exams

conducted by the agency. With Kiangte’s arrest, the number of people arrested by CID in this case has risen to 20.

He had resigned as JPSC chairperson a day before the CID searched multiple locations, including his official residence, in connection with the alleged irregularities.

Khangte, however, had said he “voluntarily chose to resign” to ensure an impartial investigation into the matter.

On Sunday, all three JPSC members — Ajeeta Bhattacharya, Anima Hansda and Jamal Ahmad — resigned. The development came after the CID summoned the three members for questioning.

According to officials, Ajeeta Bhattacharya, who is the wife of JMM leader Supriyo Bhattacharya, is scheduled to be questioned on August 10, Ahmad on August 12, and Hansda on August 14.

## Left unions, farmers’ bodies hold rallies demanding MSPs for farmers

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Kolkata

Left trade unions and farmers’ organisations on Monday held civil disobedience rallies at several district headquarters across West Bengal, pressing for minimum support price (MSP) for agricultural produce and 200 days of work under the rural job guarantee scheme, among other demands.

Members of CITU, AITUC, AIKS and other Left-affiliated trade unions and farmers’ organisations took out rallies to district magistrates’ offices in Bankura, Bardhaman and other districts.

The protesters demanded implementation of MSP for various agricultural produce across the country.

They also sought the restoration of the MGNREGA in place of the G RAM G job guarantee scheme and demanded 200 days of work for every person annually.



The G RAM G scheme, which replaced the MGNREGA, provides for 125 days of employment to each person every year.

The trade unions and agricultural workers’ organisations also demanded a halt to evictions of hawkers and slum dwellers and sought a proper rehabilitation policy for those affected.

## Meghalaya’s tribal district council okays amendments to bar non-tribals from taking part in elections

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Tura (Meghalaya)

The Garo Hills Autonomous District Council in western Meghalaya on Monday approved amendments to its election rules that will bar non-tribals from voting or contesting council elections, while paving the way for a separate electoral roll for the Sixth Schedule body, officials said.

The amendments to Rules 128 and 129 were approved by the council to establish a separate electoral roll specifically for GHADC elections, replacing the practice of using the electoral roll prepared for Assembly elections.

The GHADC, established in 1952 under the Sixth Schedule of the Constitution, had for decades conducted its elections using the electoral roll prepared for Assembly polls, allowing members of different communities to participate in the council’s electoral process.

The amendments followed violent incidents in the Garo Hills region earlier this year after the authorities issued a notification seeking to bar non-tribals from con-



testing the GHADC elections, in a departure from the practice that continued for over seven decades.

The Meghalaya High Court later cancelled the notification, while the state Government postponed the elections, scheduled for April 10, in view of the violence that claimed two lives.

Under the amended rules, only persons belonging to Scheduled Tribes recognised by the Meghalaya Government and fulfilling other prescribed conditions will be eligible to be included

in the GHADC electoral roll.

“The amendment marks a significant step in protecting the rights and interests of the tribal people of Garo Hills. With a separate electoral roll, non-tribals will no longer be able to participate in GHADC elections either as voters or candidates,” said Chief Executive Member of the council, M Dhormonath Ch Sangma.

The move fulfils a long-standing demand in Garo Hills for a separate electoral roll for the autonomous council, with supporters

arguing that the electoral process of a Sixth Schedule institution should provide greater protection to the interests of tribal communities and enable them to exercise greater control over their own affairs.

The amendment also follows a change approved by the council in March this year, which introduced Scheduled Tribe status as an eligibility criterion for contesting GHADC elections.

The latest amendment, therefore, represents a major departure from the electoral practice followed since the creation of the GHADC and is expected to reshape the composition of its electorate.

The move also comes in line with the commitment made by Meghalaya Chief Minister Conrad K Sangma to address the issue of a separate electoral roll for the GHADC.

The amendment was passed in the council’s House, although Rimpu Marak, the member of the district council (MDC) from Tura, was absent when it was taken up and approved.

Tura is the headquarters of West Garo Hills district.

## Indian institutions on QS global rankings rise from 11 to 52 since NIRF launch: Govt

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The number of Indian institutions finding place in the QS World University Rankings has increased from 11 in QS WUR 2015 to 52 in QS WUR 2027 since the launch of the National Institutional Ranking Framework (NIRF), the Lok Sabha was informed on Monday.

In a written reply, Minister of State for Education Sukanta Majumdar said the NIRF was launched in 2015 by the Centre for the annual ranking of institutions and universities of higher education in the country — India Rankings — to promote a healthy competition among educational institutes and universities.

The methodology of these rankings is based on five broad parameters — teaching, learning and resources, research and professional practices, graduation outcomes, outreach and inclusivity, and peer perception.

The number of applications received under NIRF increased from 6,272 in 2021 to 14,163 in 2025. The number of unique institutions partic-



ipating in NIRF increased from 4,030 to 7,692 during 2021-2025, the minister said.

“Since, the launch of NIRF, there has been increase in the number of institutions appearing in the QS World University Rankings, it has increased from 11 institutions in QS WUR 2015 to 52 in QS WUR 2027,” Majumdar said.

“To improve quality of education, several initiatives have been institutionalised in Centrally Funded Institutions,” he said.

Majumdar added that the Centre also provides financial support to state Governments under Rashtriya Uchchatar Shiksha

## Mamata facing people’s wrath for theft: Suvendu

SAUGAR SENGUPTA  
■ Kolkata

Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Monday lashed out at his predecessor Mamata Banerjee for not only running a “corrupt” Government but also for failing to perform her “Raj Dharma” even as he visited the house of a TMC leader at Halisahar who reportedly died in police custody a few days ago.

“You should learn a lesson or two from my today’s visit... that you never did as a Chief Minister... you never visited the houses of the BJP workers who died in political violence... but I as the Chief Minister have come here,” Adhikari said in an apparent reference to his predecessors before announcing a compensatory job for the wife of the deceased person. “I have offered a job to her,” he said.

Earlier on Sunday, Mamata Banerjee’s motorcade was attacked with mud and slips when she visited the



house of the victim, leading her to slam the Chief Minister for “nurturing an army of lumpens.” She alleged on Sunday, “the Chief Minister is behind all these ... he has lumpenised the entire State ... outsiders are coming and doing this ... they attacked my car with stones.”

Adhikari hit back on Monday, saying there was no BJP worker involved in the attack, saying it was the public wrath that she was facing for the corrupt regime she ran for all the theft that she committed. “You (Banerjee) committed theft throughout your rule... for which you are facing the popular wrath... no BJP worker was involved in the incident,” he said.

## Sukhbir Badal challenges Kejriwal to open debate on Punjab paper leaks



Shiromani Akali Dal president Sukhbir Singh Badal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Bathinda

Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) president Sukhbir Singh Badal on Monday challenged AAP national convenor Arvind Kejriwal to an open debate on the alleged paper leaks and recruitment scams in Punjab, saying he would “expose” him and Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann with facts and figures.

Addressing a dharna at Government Rajindra College here as part of the ‘Bhavikh Bachao Morcha’ being led by the Students Organisation of India (SOI), the student wing of the SAD, Badal asked Kejriwal to explain why not a single head had rolled despite “repeated examination leaks” that, he claimed, had impacted more than 10 lakh students across the State.

The protest is demanding the immediate resignation

of Punjab Education Minister Harjot Bains and Health Minister Balbir Singh and a CBI probe into what the SAD described as “ten paper leak cases in Punjab”.

The Opposition has been targeting the AAP Government over alleged examination paper leaks following the detection of a cheating racket in the recent pharmacy officer recruitment examination.

Chief Minister Mann, however, has maintained that not a single incident of paper leak has taken place in Punjab during the more than four years of his Government’s tenure.

Challenging Kejriwal to hold an open debate with him at any university of his choice in Punjab, Badal said, “I will lay bare before the people of Punjab as to how you leaked the papers. How outsiders were given jobs with facts and figures and how Punjabi youth were ignored.”



# Filmmaker Shakeel Noorani held after aspiring actor alleges rape

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Mumbai

Mumbai Police have arrested Bollywood filmmaker Shakeel Noorani after a 33-year-old aspiring actor accused him of raping and threatening her, officials said on Monday.

The 73-year-old accused was traced to his farmhouse in Mahabaleshwar hill station, located more than 200 km from Mumbai, on Saturday after he went into hiding following the registration of a First Information Report (FIR) against him, they said.

Noorani is known for directing films like "Joru Ka Ghulam" (2000), starring



Govinda, and "Bade Dilwala" (1999), which featured Suniel Shetty. In her complaint, the woman alleged that Noorani sexually assaulted her over the last four years and also poisoned her, leading to a miscarriage.

She claimed the accused had called her to his residence in the Malvani area here on the pretext of dis-

cussing the script of an upcoming film project, where he allegedly spiked her drink and sexually assaulted her.

When she regained consciousness, Noorani showed her an intimate video on his mobile phone and allegedly threatened to circulate it if she approached the police or informed her family.

The accused subsequently used the purported video to allegedly threaten her and sexually assault her on multiple occasions. He also gave her contraceptive pills following the assault and poisoned her, causing a miscarriage, a police official said quoting the woman's complaint lodged 40 days ago.

# Assam re-launches red lentil, sugar scheme

TONY DAS ■ Guwahati

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma on Monday re-launched the State's subsidised *masoor dal* and sugar distribution scheme for National Food Security Act (NFSA) beneficiaries at Raha in Nagaon district. The initiative is set to benefit over 2.48 crore individuals across nearly 70 lakh families in the State.

Under the revived welfare initiative, masoor dal will be made available at ₹70 per kg, while sugar will be provided at ₹30 per kg through fair price shops. The scheme, which had been temporarily suspended for two months owing to the Vote on Account budget, was formally restart-



ed at a modest function held at a fair price shop in Kamarjan village under the Raha assembly constituency.

Speaking on the occasion, the Chief Minister emphasised that the supply of essential commodities at subsidised rates alongside free rice under the 'Anna Sewa Saptah' will

play a vital role in ensuring nutritional security for poor households.

Sarma stated that the distribution programme had been kept modest due to the prevailing severe flood situation in Upper Assam. Assuring that welfare initiatives were regaining momen-

tum as flood conditions gradually improved, he noted that key public schemes like Orunodoi, Chief Minister's Nijut Moina, and Nijut Babu were also systematically restarted following the passage of the state budget in July. Highlighting upcoming welfare steps, the Chief Minister announced that salt would also be provided at subsidised rates within a few days once technical constraints are resolved.

He further revealed that the State Government is actively taking steps to fulfil its election promise of providing mustard oil at subsidised prices, besides initiating measures to cover eligible families previously left out of the Orunodoi scheme.

The coverage under the distribution scheme includes 15,83,080 beneficiaries across 3,85,299 families in Nagaon district alone, while 2.36 lakh individuals belonging to 61,614 families in the Raha constituency will benefit from the programme. Expressing his gratitude to cooperative societies and fair price shops for executing the supply chain, Dr Sarma also promised significant developmental projects for the Raha constituency over the next five years.

The re-launch event was attended by Agriculture Minister Pijush Hazarika, Food, Public Distribution and Consumer Affairs Minister Kaushik Rai, along with MLAs Sashikanta Das, Rupak Sarma, and Jitu Goswami.

# NCP (SP) rules out support to NDA

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Mumbai

The Sharad Pawar-led NCP (SP) on Monday dismissed speculation about future support for the BJP-led NDA, and affirmed that its stance on delimitation will depend on the final draft bill presented in Parliament.

Talking to reporters, NCP (SP) spokesperson Mahesh Tapase said a delegation led by party MP and working president Supriya Sule met Prime Minister Narendra Modi in Delhi to discuss issues related to Maharashtra, and insisted the visit wasn't political.

He said the meeting, which lasted 20 minutes, was scheduled after confirmation from the Prime Minister's Office on Friday and was not related to the delimitation issue.

"There is no proposal or discussion on delimitation in Parliament today. First, the bill should come. Once the bill comes, it will be discussed with the



Mahesh Tapase, NCP (SP) spokesperson

INDIA alliance. There will be a detailed discussion within the alliance," Tapase said.

He clarified that the NCP (SP) was firmly with the Opposition bloc and had not entered into any political understanding with the BJP or the NDA in 2014, 2019 or 2024, and questioned why it would do so now.

Tapase's remarks came amid speculation about a rapprochement between the two NCP factions and the Sharad Pawar-led party extending support to the NDA.

He said that the party had built its own organisation after the NCP split and was working to strengthen its cadre under the leadership of Supriya Sule, Rohit Pawar, Jayant Patil and Shashikant Shinde. Speaking about the proposed delimitation exercise, Tapase said the Government had not yet made up its mind whether to introduce the legislation during the ongoing monsoon session.

"No draft bill has been sent to any MP for reading or discussion. I don't think the delimitation bill will come in the next two-three days," he said. He further stated that women's quota should be delinked from delimitation, and said the legislation passed in 2023 should be implemented immediately.



EMBASSY

Embassy Developments Limited

(Formerly known as Equinox India Developments Limited)

CIN:L45101HR2006PLC095409

Statement of Unaudited Financial Results (Standalone and Consolidated) for the quarter ended 30 June 2026

The Board of Directors of the Company, at the meeting held on August 10, 2026, approved the unaudited financial results of the company for the quarter ended June 30, 2026 ("Financial Results").

The Financials along with the Limited Review Report, have been posted on the company's website (<https://embassyindia.com>) and on the website of BSE (<https://www.bseindia.com>) and NSE (<https://www.nseindia.com>) and can be assessed by scanning the QR Code.



For and on behalf of the Board of Directors

Place : Bengaluru

Date : August 10, 2026



Aditya Virwani

Managing Director

Note : The above intimation is in accordance with the Regulation 33 read with Regulation 47 (1) of the SEBI (Listing Obligation and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015.

|                                                    |                                                                                                                                             | Equinox India Infraestate Limited<br>(formerly Indiabulls Infraestate Limited)<br>(CIN: U70102DL2007PLC157384) |               |                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------------|
| Extract of Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026                                                            |                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                |               |                     |
| ( ₹ in million)                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                |               |                     |
| Sl. No.                                                                                                                              | Particulars                                                                                                                                 | Quarter ended                                                                                                  | Quarter ended | Previous year ended |
|                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                             | 30 June 2026                                                                                                   | 30 June 2025  | 31 March 2026       |
|                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                             | (Unaudited)                                                                                                    | (Unaudited)   | (Audited)           |
| 1                                                                                                                                    | Total Income from Operations                                                                                                                | 90.63                                                                                                          | 327.55        | 779.15              |
| 2                                                                                                                                    | Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)                                                     | (150.88)                                                                                                       | (97.84)       | (560.93)            |
| 3                                                                                                                                    | Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)                                                | (150.88)                                                                                                       | (97.84)       | (807.99)            |
| 4                                                                                                                                    | Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period after Tax, (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)                                                | (150.88)                                                                                                       | (97.84)       | (807.55)            |
| 5                                                                                                                                    | Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/ (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)] | (150.88)                                                                                                       | (97.84)       | (827.95)            |
| 6                                                                                                                                    | Paid up Equity Share Capital                                                                                                                | 2.27                                                                                                           | 2.27          | 2.27                |
| 7                                                                                                                                    | Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)                                                                                                    | 8,744.52                                                                                                       | 9,480.89      | 8,890.24            |
| 8                                                                                                                                    | Securities Premium Account                                                                                                                  | 16,123.91                                                                                                      | 16,123.91     | 16,123.91           |
| 9                                                                                                                                    | Net Worth                                                                                                                                   | 8,746.80                                                                                                       | 9,483.16      | 8,892.51            |
| 10                                                                                                                                   | Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt                                                                                                     | 16,885.60                                                                                                      | 13,973.87     | 10,955.48           |
| 11                                                                                                                                   | Outstanding Redeemable Preference Share                                                                                                     | -                                                                                                              | -             | -                   |
| 12                                                                                                                                   | Debt Equity Ratio*                                                                                                                          | 1.93                                                                                                           | 1.47          | 1.26                |
| 13                                                                                                                                   | Earnings per Share(EPS) (Face value Per Share ₹10 each)(for continuing and discontinued operations)-                                        |                                                                                                                |               |                     |
|                                                                                                                                      | - Basic (Amount in ₹ )                                                                                                                      | (663.40)                                                                                                       | (430.18)      | (3,550.61)          |
|                                                                                                                                      | - Diluted (Amount in ₹ )                                                                                                                    | (663.40)                                                                                                       | (430.18)      | (3,550.61)          |
| 14                                                                                                                                   | Capital Redemption Reserve                                                                                                                  | -                                                                                                              | -             | -                   |
| 15                                                                                                                                   | Debenture Redemption Reserve                                                                                                                | -                                                                                                              | -             | -                   |
| 16                                                                                                                                   | Debt Service Coverage Ratio*                                                                                                                | -                                                                                                              | -             | -                   |
| 17                                                                                                                                   | Interest Service Coverage Ratio**                                                                                                           | -                                                                                                              | -             | -                   |
| 18                                                                                                                                   | Current ratio (In times)                                                                                                                    | 1.80                                                                                                           | 1.23          | 2.15                |
| 19                                                                                                                                   | Total debts to total assets (In times)                                                                                                      | 0.59                                                                                                           | 0.56          | 0.50                |
| 20                                                                                                                                   | Long term debt to working capital (In times)                                                                                                | 0.71                                                                                                           | -             | 0.68                |
| 21                                                                                                                                   | Bad debt to account receivable ratio (In %)                                                                                                 | -                                                                                                              | -             | -                   |
| 22                                                                                                                                   | Current liability ratio (In times)                                                                                                          | 0.63                                                                                                           | 1.00          | 0.56                |
| 23                                                                                                                                   | Debtor turnover ratio (In times)                                                                                                            | 1.74                                                                                                           | 3.40          | 7.15                |
| 24                                                                                                                                   | Inventory turnover ratio (In times)***                                                                                                      | -                                                                                                              | 0.03          | 0.06                |
| 25                                                                                                                                   | Operating margin (In %)                                                                                                                     | (37.33)                                                                                                        | (9.31)        | (28.46)             |
| 26                                                                                                                                   | Net profit margin (In %)                                                                                                                    | (166.48)                                                                                                       | (29.87)       | (123.19)            |
| * Ratio can not be calculated due to negative earning available for debt service.                                                    |                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                |               |                     |
| ** Ratio can not be calculated due to negative earning available for interest service coverage                                       |                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                |               |                     |
| *** Ratio can not be calculated as no cost of goods sold corresponding to inventory has been recognised during the reporting period. |                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                |               |                     |

| EMBASSY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                           | Lucina Land Development Limited<br>(CIN: U70109DL2006PLC151260)                                |                             |                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Extract of Unaudited Financial Results for the quarter ended 30 June 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                |                             |                                        |
| Sl. No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Particulars                                                                                                                                               | Quarter ended                                                                                  | Corresponding quarter ended | ( ₹ in million)<br>Previous year ended |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                           | 30 June 2026                                                                                   | 30 June 2025                | 31 March 2026                          |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                           | (Unaudited)                                                                                    | (Unaudited)                 | (Audited)                              |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Total Income from Operations                                                                                                                              | 4.88                                                                                           | 11.43                       | 27.67                                  |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)                                                                   | (114.97)                                                                                       | (74.91)                     | (557.73)                               |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)                                                              | (114.97)                                                                                       | (74.91)                     | (560.02)                               |
| 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Net Profit/ (Loss) for the period after Tax, (after Exceptional and/ or Extraordinary items)                                                              | (114.97)                                                                                       | (74.91)                     | (570.70)                               |
| 5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising Profit/ (Loss) for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)]               | (114.97)                                                                                       | (74.91)                     | (576.44)                               |
| 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Paid up Equity Share Capital                                                                                                                              | 0.50                                                                                           | 0.50                        | 0.50                                   |
| 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)                                                                                                                  | (11,410.61)                                                                                    | (10,874.55)                 | (11,316.43)                            |
| 8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Securities Premium Account                                                                                                                                | -                                                                                              | -                           | -                                      |
| 9                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Net Worth                                                                                                                                                 | (11,133.66)                                                                                    | (10,597.60)                 | (11,039.58)                            |
| 10                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt                                                                                                                   | 16,725.89                                                                                      | 12,850.25                   | 15,116.93                              |
| 11                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Outstanding Redeemable Preference Share                                                                                                                   | -                                                                                              | -                           | -                                      |
| 12                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Debt Equity Ratio*                                                                                                                                        | -                                                                                              | -                           | -                                      |
| 13                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Earnings per Share(EPS)(Face value Per Share ₹10 each)(for continuing and discontinued operations)-<br>- Basic (Amount in ₹ )<br>- Diluted (Amount in ₹ ) | (2,299.20)<br>(2,299.20)                                                                       | (1,498.25)<br>(1,498.25)    | (11,411.12)<br>(11,411.12)             |
| 14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Capital Redemption Reserve*                                                                                                                               | -                                                                                              | -                           | -                                      |
| 15                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Debenture Redemption Reserve                                                                                                                              | -                                                                                              | -                           | -                                      |
| 16                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Debt Service Coverage Ratio**                                                                                                                             | -                                                                                              | -                           | -                                      |
| 17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Interest Service Coverage Ratio                                                                                                                           | (0.43)                                                                                         | (2.02)                      | (1.56)                                 |
| 18                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Current ratio (In times)                                                                                                                                  | 0.82                                                                                           | 0.55                        | 0.72                                   |
| 19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Total debts to total assets                                                                                                                               | 1.03                                                                                           | 1.11                        | 1.03                                   |
| 20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Long term debt to working capital (In times)#                                                                                                             | -                                                                                              | -                           | -                                      |
| 21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Bad debt to account receivable ratio (In %)                                                                                                               | 0.00                                                                                           | -                           | 0.00                                   |
| 22                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Current liability ratio (In times)                                                                                                                        | 0.72                                                                                           | 0.95                        | 0.78                                   |
| 23                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Debtor turnover ratio (In times)                                                                                                                          | 0.10                                                                                           | 0.20                        | 0.57                                   |
| 24                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Inventory turnover ratio (In times)***                                                                                                                    | 0.00                                                                                           | 0.00                        | 0.00                                   |
| 25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Operating margin (In %)                                                                                                                                   | -                                                                                              | 88.42                       | 3.87                                   |
| 26                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Net profit margin (In %)                                                                                                                                  | (287.73)                                                                                       | (579.72)                    | (389.55)                               |
| * Ratio can not be calculated due to negative average shareholders funds.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                |                             |                                        |
| ** Ratio can not be calculated due to negative earning available for debt service.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                |                             |                                        |
| # Ratio can not be calculated due to negative working capital.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                |                             |                                        |
| *** ₹ 0.00 means less than ₹ 0.01 Million                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                |                             |                                        |
| Notes :                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                |                             |                                        |
| 1. The above results have been reviewed and approved by the Board of Directors ('the Board') at its meeting held on 10 August 2026.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                |                             |                                        |
| 2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly / Annual Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 52(8), read with 52(4) of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/ Annual Financial Results are available on the Company's website ( <a href="https://embassyindia.com/tcl/">https://embassyindia.com/tcl/</a> ) and on the website of BSE ( <a href="https://www.bseindia.com">https://www.bseindia.com</a> ) and NSE ( <a href="https://www.nseindia.com">https://www.nseindia.com</a> ). |                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                |                             |                                        |
| Registered Office: Office no 202, 2nd Floor,A-18 Rama House, Middle Circle,<br>Connaught Place , New Delhi- 110 001.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                           |           |                             |                                        |
| Place : New Delhi<br>Date : 10 August 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                           | For and on behalf of the Board of Directors<br><br>Meyyappan Ramanathan<br>Whole-time director |                             |                                        |

| EMBASSY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                              | Tapir Constructions Limited<br>(CIN: U70200DL2014PLC267441)                           |                                             |                                      |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| EXTRACT OF UNAUDITED FINANCIAL RESULTS<br>FOR THE QUARTER ENDED 30 JUNE 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
| (₹ in Millions)                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
| Sl. No.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Particulars                                                                                                                                  | Quarter ended<br>30 June 2026                                                         | Corresponding quarter ended<br>30 June 2025 | Previous year ended<br>31 March 2026 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                              | (Unaudited)                                                                           | (Unaudited)                                 | (Audited)                            |
| 1                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Total Income from Operations                                                                                                                 | 71.82                                                                                 | 2,852.73                                    | 4,765.24                             |
| 2                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Net (Loss) / Profit for the period (before Tax, Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                      | (113.31)                                                                              | 109.65                                      | (115.22)                             |
| 3                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Net (Loss) / Profit for the period before Tax (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                 | (113.31)                                                                              | 109.65                                      | (115.86)                             |
| 4                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Net (Loss) / Profit for the period after Tax, (after Exceptional and/or Extraordinary items)                                                 | (113.31)                                                                              | 109.65                                      | (115.90)                             |
| 5                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Total Comprehensive Income for the period [Comprising (Loss) / Profit for the period (after tax) and Other Comprehensive Income (after tax)] | (113.31)                                                                              | 109.65                                      | (123.54)                             |
| 6                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Paid up Equity Share Capital                                                                                                                 | 0.50                                                                                  | 0.50                                        | 0.50                                 |
| 7                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Reserves (excluding Revaluation Reserve)                                                                                                     | (2,464.61)                                                                            | (2,158.89)                                  | (2,351.94)                           |
| 8                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Securities Premium Account                                                                                                                   | -                                                                                     | -                                           | -                                    |
| 9                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Net Worth                                                                                                                                    | (2,464.11)                                                                            | (2,158.39)                                  | (2,351.44)                           |
| 10                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Paid up Debt Capital / Outstanding Debt*                                                                                                     | 4,559.22                                                                              | 2,441.72                                    | 4,545.51                             |
| 11                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Outstanding redemption preference share                                                                                                      | -                                                                                     | -                                           | -                                    |
| 12                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Debt Equity Ratio*                                                                                                                           | -                                                                                     | -                                           | -                                    |
| 13                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Earnings per Share (EPS) (Face value Per Share ₹ 10 each)                                                                                    |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | - Basic (Amount in ₹ )                                                                                                                       | (2,266.34)                                                                            | 2,193.39                                    | (2,317.25)                           |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | - Diluted (Amount in ₹ )                                                                                                                     | (2,266.34)                                                                            | 2,193.39                                    | (2,317.25)                           |
| 14                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Capital Redemption Reserve                                                                                                                   | -                                                                                     | -                                           | -                                    |
| 15                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Debenture Redemption Reserve                                                                                                                 | -                                                                                     | -                                           | -                                    |
| 16                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Debt Service Coverage Ratio**                                                                                                                | -                                                                                     | 1.17                                        | -                                    |
| 17                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Interest Service Coverage Ratio                                                                                                              | (0.63)                                                                                | 1.17                                        | (0.29)                               |
| 18                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Current ratio (In times)                                                                                                                     | 0.94                                                                                  | 1.06                                        | 0.98                                 |
| 19                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Total debts to total assets                                                                                                                  | 1.35                                                                                  | 1.04                                        | 1.43                                 |
| 20                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Long term debt to working capital (In times)#                                                                                                | -                                                                                     | 10.04                                       | -                                    |
| 21                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Bad debt to account receivable ratio (In %)                                                                                                  | -                                                                                     | -                                           | -                                    |
| 22                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Current liability ratio (In times)                                                                                                           | 0.58                                                                                  | 0.61                                        | 0.57                                 |
| 23                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Debtor turnover ratio (In times)                                                                                                             | 95.82                                                                                 | -                                           | 10,795.89                            |
| 24                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Inventory turnover ratio (In times)                                                                                                          | 0.02                                                                                  | 0.56                                        | 1.05                                 |
| 25                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Operating margin (In %)                                                                                                                      | 6.97                                                                                  | 6.05                                        | 4.37                                 |
| 26                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Net profit margin (In %)                                                                                                                     | (153.52)                                                                              | 3.84                                        | (2.42)                               |
| ^ Paid up debt capital/ Outstanding debt is presented net of unamortised transaction costs.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
| * Ratio can not be calculated due to negative average shareholders funds.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
| ** Ratio can not be calculated due to negative earning available for debt service.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
| # Ratio can not be calculated due to negative working capital.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
| Notes:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
| 1. The above results have been reviewed and approved by the Board of Directors ('the Board') at its meeting held on 10 August 2026.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
| 2. The above is an extract of the detailed format of Quarterly / Annual Financial Results filed with the Stock Exchanges under Regulation 52(8), read with 52(4) of the SEBI (Listing and Other Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2015. The full format of the Quarterly/ Annual Financial Results are available on the Company's website ( <a href="https://embassyindia.com/tcl/">https://embassyindia.com/tcl/</a> ) and on the website of BSE ( <a href="https://www.bseindia.com">https://www.bseindia.com</a> ) and NSE ( <a href="https://www.nseindia.com">https://www.nseindia.com</a> ). |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
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| Office No. 202, 2nd Floor, A-18, Rama House, Middle Circle,<br>Connaught Place, New Delhi- 110 001.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                              |  |                                             |                                      |
| Place : New Delhi                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
| Date : 10 August 2026                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                       |                                             |                                      |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                              | Abhishek Rajnath Surve<br>Whole-time director                                         |                                             |                                      |





Editor's  
TAKE

## The FCRA Bill needs scrutiny, not speed

While the Govt is justified in preventing the misuse of foreign contributions, the Opposition's concerns cannot be summarily dismissed

When Parliament takes up the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Amendment Bill, 2026 on August 12, it will bring to a head one of the most contentious bills in recent times. Introduced in the Lok Sabha on March 25, it has produced a rare alignment of opposition parties, church bodies, a Northeastern Chief Minister and members of the US Congress, all asking the government to pause.

At its core, the Bill empowers a new "Designated Authority" to take over, manage and eventually dispose of the assets of any organisation whose FCRA registration is cancelled, surrendered or allowed to lapse. Schools, hospitals and welfare centres built over decades with legitimate foreign money could pass into government hands if a licence is simply not renewed, even where no wrongdoing is established. It also bars foreign funds from financing undefined "proselytisation", though the government says judicial appeal against the Authority's orders remains open.

India's FCRA portal shows barely 14,449 active certificates today, against over 22,000 cancelled and 15,000-plus lapsed. Christian organisations hold about 12 percent of licences but receive roughly 60 percent of regulated foreign funds - disproportionately exposed.

Mizoram Chief Minister Lalduhoma travelled to Delhi with the Mizoram Kohhran Hruaitu Committee and the Council of Churches in Mizoram, which has called an August 11 protest, to hand Shah a memorandum demanding referral to a Joint Parliamentary Committee. The Catholic Bishops' Conference of India held a national prayer day before the session began; the All India Christian Council has accused the government of engineering a legal takeover of Christian institutions. Congress MP Shashi Tharoor calls the Bill a recasting of civil society as a security threat; Rahul Gandhi's charge that only the RSS would escape scrutiny has been denied as fabricated; and Congress, the Trinamool Congress and NCP (Sharad Pawar) have all demanded withdrawal or committee review.

The government's underlying concern is not baseless. Genuine misuse of foreign funds is a documented problem, and the FATF's 2024 review of India did flag real gaps in non-profit oversight. Shah has already conceded ground, assuring the Mizoram delegation the law will not apply retrospectively. But that addresses only timing, not the deeper objection: open-ended, discretionary control over accumulated assets is disproportionate even for a straightforward, good-faith non-renewal. The way forward lies close to what the FATF itself recommended: targeted, risk-based scrutiny, not blanket vesting powers. The government should accept the JPC referral it has so far resisted, define "proselytisation" precisely instead of leaving it to local discretion, and build in a time-bound, genuinely judicial review before any asset is touched - distinguishing organisations that violated the law from those that simply wind down. Anything less will keep confirming the fear driving these protests: that this Bill regulates money but confiscates trust.

# Hasina's return and India-Bangladesh ties

Beyond the immediate political confrontation, Hasina's return could affect Bangladesh-India ties and cooperation on issues ranging from security and trade to the Rohingya crisis and climate change. The episode could prove a critical test of Bangladesh's political stability and India's delicate balancing act with its eastern neighbour



KALYANI SHANKAR

Former Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina, currently in exile in New Delhi, announced her intention to return to Dhaka in December 2026, despite facing a death sentence in absentia. This planned return has sparked diplomatic outrage from Prime Minister Tarique Rahman. It has also reignited national political tensions and complicated the bilateral relationship between Bangladesh and India.

Hasina, who has sought political asylum in India since 2025 following the abrupt overthrow of her government, has made a public declaration regarding her intention to return to Bangladesh by the end of this year. This announcement comes even though she has been sentenced to death by an International Crimes Tribunal due to her alleged involvement in serious human rights violations during her time in office. In her statement, she expressed determination, saying, "I may be jailed, but I will return to Bangladesh by December." Her return is expected to stir significant political tension and public interest as she prepares to face the consequences of her legal battles in her home country.

"I'm not worried about my own future. I'm worried about the future of Bangladesh. My return isn't about power. It's about putting Bangladesh back on the right track." "People of Bangladesh have suffered a lot, and that's why I decided to return," she said.

She may face challenges such as climate change and security threats. Her ability to manage regional stability will influence regional peace and security.

In 2025, Sheikh Hasina, the long-serving Prime Minister of Bangladesh, sought asylum in India due to political turmoil and accusations of authoritarian governance in Bangladesh.

As news of Sheikh Hasina's proposed return to Bangladesh emerges, understanding its regional and national implications is crucial for grasping the future of South Asian politics.

The potential impacts of her return on Bangladesh and South Asian relations are vital for regional stability and India's strategic interests.

Sheikh Hasina has been a key figure in Bangladeshi politics, leading the Awami League party, which her father founded. Her time in office has been characterised by significant economic growth. Ousted former Prime Minister Sheikh Hasina announced from exile in New Delhi that she plans to



PRIME MINISTER SHEIKH HASINA ANNOUNCED FROM EXILE IN NEW DELHI THAT SHE PLANS TO RETURN TO DHAKA IN DECEMBER 2026, DESPITE FACING A DEATH SENTENCE IN ABSENTIA. HER PLANNED RETURN HAS TRIGGERED DIPLOMATIC OUTRAGE FROM BANGLADESH'S GOVERNMENT UNDER PRIME MINISTER TARIQUE RAHMAN

The writer is a popular columnist

return to Dhaka in December 2026, despite facing a death sentence in absentia. Her planned return has triggered diplomatic outrage from Bangladesh's government under Prime Minister Tarique Rahman, reignited national political tensions, and complicated bilateral ties with India. It has also raised concerns about human rights abuses and the suppression of political dissent. After her departure in 2025, a power vacuum emerged, leading to increased instability and allowing the opposition and various factions to gain strength.

The potential return of Hasina may invigorate the Awami League, restoring party cohesion and rallying the support of loyal constituents who have remained steadfast during her absence. Her leadership could help unify party members in confronting opposing political forces and reinstate the party's prominence within the political landscape.

Hasina's return may offer a chance for political reconciliation, helping to unify opposing factions and promote stability in Bangladesh. Hasina's administration is anticipated to focus on restoring institutional trust and resolving governance challenges. This may encompass reforms aimed at enhancing human rights conditions, ensuring the integrity of electoral processes, and promoting economic transparency. Nevertheless, the efficacy of these initiatives will depend on her capacity to navigate the prevailing political divisions.

The opposition parties, particularly the Bangladesh Nationalist Party (BNP), may

regard Hasina's return as a significant threat to the democratic process. This perception could incite increased protests and resistance, thereby complicating her capacity to lead effectively without resorting to repressive measures.

Hasina's return to power has the potential to enhance bilateral relations with India, particularly considering her historically pro-India stance. Increased cooperation on matters such as trade, immigration, and regional security may reinforce diplomatic ties and provide mutual benefits for both nations.

Hasina's political actions could strengthen alliances in the region against growing influences from China and other countries. A stable Bangladesh under Hasina could help balance Chinese investments in the area, especially in neighbouring countries.

Bangladesh faces significant impacts from climate change. Hasina can spearhead initiatives to enhance collaboration with neighbouring countries on climate resilience strategies.

The policies implemented by Prime Minister Hasina concerning the Rohingya refugee crisis are of significant importance. A collaborative framework involving India and Myanmar may facilitate constructive solutions and influence how regional governments address migration and humanitarian challenges.

Sheikh Hasina's proposed return is a pivotal moment that could influence regional cooperation on climate change, migration, and security, shaping South Asia's future.

## PIC TALK



'Kanwariyas' during the second Monday of the holy month of Shravan, as they take part in the 'Kanwar Yatra', in Agartala, Tripura. PHOTO: PTI



SAKSHI SETHI

## 2ND OPINION

Every age worry about the young. Parents have always attempted to safeguard them from failure, disappointment and misery. But somewhere along the way, protection has evolved to resemble protracted supervision. Increasingly, maturity itself is being negotiated through parental intervention. Across colleges and businesses, stories are appearing of parents attending interviews, negotiating pay, contacting employers about workplace concerns or wading into situations that their adult children are expected to resolve themselves. Such incidents are typically dismissed as entertaining anecdotes. They are not. They suggest towards a larger cultural shift in how society sees independence. The phenomena is not born out of faulty parenting. It is born out of dread.

Parents now-a-days have reared children in an

atmosphere of unrelenting competitiveness.

Every examination, college entrance, internship and career opportunity looks to hold life-defining repercussions. When the stakes feel impossibly high, many parents think that stepping in is an act of love rather than meddling. They believe experience can shelter their children from mistakes they themselves once made. Yet life has never rewarded those who were shielded from every adversity. It rewards individuals who progressively learn to face uncertainty. Resilience is not inherited. It is created through uncomfortable talks, rejected applications, demanding supervisors, failed interviews and difficult decisions.

These experiences are rarely pleasant, but they are vital. Every challenge that a parent solves on behalf of an adult discreetly deprives that young person of an opportunity to acquire confidence.

As an educator, I have experienced another consequence even before kids enter the workforce. Increasingly, teachers are expected to negotiate directly with anxious parents over matters that students themselves could easily address. Forgotten homework, classroom disagreements, project deadlines or routine feedback often become parental concerns instead of opportunities for children to communicate, reflect and take responsibility. Gradually, young people begin to believe that every obstacle requires an intermediary.

Even modern technology tools have unintentional-

ly reinforced this dependence. Smartphones and applications track every action, movement, decision and every setback instantly. A disappointing meeting or minor workplace disagreement no longer remains a private learning experience, in fact, it instantly becomes a family discussion, inviting advice, intervention and sometimes direct involvement.

Ironically, employers today consistently rank adaptability, initiative and problem-solving among the qualities they value most. None of these qualities emerge from a life where every difficult conversation has already been conducted by someone else. This does not mean parents should suddenly become distant observers. Guidance remains invaluable. Listening without immediately solving, advising without taking over and encouraging without controlling may be among the hardest forms of parenting. They also happen to be the most empowering.

Perhaps the ultimate measure of parenting is not how successfully we protect our children, but how confidently they learn to navigate life without us. A parent's greatest gift is the courage or bravery to let their children face the path by themselves, knowing they may stumble, recover and ultimately discover that they were capable all along.

The writer is an educator and a councillor

## DIGITAL EXPERIENCE



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## WOMEN'S RESERVATION MUST NOT WAIT FOR FUTURE DELIMITATION

This refers to the editorial "Women's quota, held hostage to delimitation" (August 10, 2026). The continued delay in implementing women's reservation is disappointing, particularly after Parliament's broad agreement on the principle. Greater representation should not remain dependent on a prolonged debate over delimitation. Women have waited for meaningful participation in legislatures for decades, and further postponement risks weakening public confidence in the reform.

A practical approach would be to separate the two issues. The 33 per cent reservation can be operationalised within the existing constituency structure, with rotation of reserved seats as provided by law. Delimitation, involving wider questions of

population, federal representation and regional balance, should proceed independently through a transparent and consultative process. States must have adequate opportunity to present their concerns before any redistribution of seats is finalised.

The government and Opposition should consider an OBC sub-quota within women's reservation to address representation concerns without delaying the measure. Political consensus matters only when it produces results. Implementing the reservation now, while separately negotiating fair delimitation, would honour Parliament's commitment and give women a meaningful place in legislative decision-making.

ABHARNA BARATHI | CHENNAI

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## LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

### Turbulence: An unwelcome flight risk

Whether the Phuket-New Delhi Air India flight drop was related to clear-air turbulence or otherwise, it goes without saying that unexpected turbulence is an unwelcome event for an anxious flier. Though turbulence is generally uncomfortable rather than dangerous, severe turbulence can seriously injure a flier.

In modern-day long-distance air travel, turbulence is an unavoidable possibility, especially on specific routes. Experts have said that climate change across the globe has made air travel bumpier, and this trend may further increase because climate patterns are constantly changing. Clear-air turbulence, which is invisible and can be more difficult to anticipate, is likely to occur more frequently on some routes, especially over the North Atlantic, one of the busiest and most preferred air routes, and can catch even experienced pilots off guard.

Wind shear, which involves a change in wind speed and/or direction over a short distance, particularly in jet streams, can contribute to turbulence. A better turbulence forecasting system and detection mechanism should be developed by aviation experts. Also, the important protection measure — strapping into one's seat during most of the flight — must be emphasised enough.

### Kerala's floods demand action on desiltation

Kerala, known as "Earth's Eden" or "God's Own Country", is prone to floods and landslides. The state receives an average annual rainfall exceeding 3,000 mm, more than double the national average. In 1924, rainfall of 3,368 mm triggered the catastrophic 'Great Flood of 99'. In 2018, between August 1 and 19, the state received 164 per cent more rain than the annual average. Rivers were in spate and dams crossed danger levels. In early August 2026, cloudburst-like downpours caused floods and landslides.

Kerala Chief Minister VD Satheesan announced ambitious plans for the desiltation of dams and rivers. According to the Institute of Land and Disaster Management, major rivers contain about 27 lakh tonnes of silt, sand and debris from the 2018 and 2019 floods. A time-bound plan to remove these deposits is essential. Gregory Morris, author of the Reservoir Sedimentation Handbook, noted that sediment removal can cost more than dam construction. Desilting dams will require Central Government assistance. Yet, the gap between declared programmes and execution remains unexplained. A flood report said the Doppler Weather Radar acquired after the 2024 Wayanad landslides is still awaiting commissioning.

### JPSC exam row needs a credible resolution

The decision to cancel three examinations of the Jharkhand Public Service Commission (JPSC) after protests by aspirants is a serious matter that deserves careful attention. Competitive examinations are a crucial gateway to government employment, and candidates devote considerable time, money and effort to preparing for them. Any disruption causes avoidable hardship and uncertainty.

The incident highlights the importance of ensuring greater transparency and efficiency in the functioning of recruitment agencies. Examination schedules and procedures should be finalised only after adequate preparation, while concerns raised by candidates must be examined impartially. If there have been administrative lapses, the authorities should identify them and take corrective measures instead of allowing doubts to persist.

The government should improve communication with aspirants by providing timely updates on cancellations, fresh dates and safeguards. A proper grievance-redressal mechanism can help resolve disputes and prevent prolonged protests. The immediate priority should be to reschedule the cancelled examinations and conduct them fairly and transparently. The credibility of the JPSC depends on candidates' confidence in its procedures.



# Beyond the ballot: Does democracy require informed citizenship?

As misinformation and policy complexity grow, India must explore ways to strengthen civic awareness while preserving the constitutional promise of universal suffrage



MOHIT KUMAR PRASAD

India's democracy is founded upon one of the boldest experiments in political equality ever undertaken. At the moment of Independence, despite widespread poverty and low literacy levels, the framers of the Constitution chose to place their faith in the judgment of ordinary citizens. Universal adult franchise transformed voting from a privilege into a right and ensured that every citizen, irrespective of caste, religion, gender, wealth, or educational attainment, possessed an equal voice in shaping the nation's future.

Yet, as democracies across the world grapple with misinformation, political polarisation, and increasingly complex policy questions, a difficult question occasionally resurfaces: should democratic participation require at least a basic level of civic awareness?

## The argument for informed voting

The proposition is neither novel nor entirely without intellectual support. The nineteenth-century philosopher John Stuart Mill, while being a strong supporter of representative government, was concerned that democratic decisions could be influenced by ignorance rather than informed judgment. In his seminal work, "Considerations on Representative Government" (1861), Mill proposed the idea of "plural voting", under which every citizen would retain the right to vote, but individuals possessing higher levels of education or demonstrated competence would be entitled to additional votes. Mill believed that this arrangement would preserve universal suffrage while ensuring that knowledge and expertise received greater weight in public decision-making. Although the proposal was never adopted and would be considered inconsistent with contemporary notions of political equality, it remains one of the earliest attempts to reconcile democratic participation with informed governance.

More recently, political philosopher Jason Brennan, in his influential work, "Against Democracy" (2016), has questioned whether widespread political ignorance undermines democratic outcomes. Economist Bryan Caplan has similarly argued in "Myth of Rational Voter" (2007) that voters are often influenced by misconceptions, emotional appeals, and cognitive biases rather than evidence and informed analysis. Their central concern is not hostility to democracy, but the possibility that uninformed electoral choices may affect the quality of governance and public policy.

These concerns acquire particular relevance in the digital age. Electoral campaigns today unfold in an environment saturated with information, misinformation, and competing narratives. Social media platforms have significantly enhanced access to information but have simultaneously accelerated the spread of rumours, half-truths, and deliberate falsehoods. Complex issues relating to artificial intelligence, climate change, economic regulation, data protection, national security, and international trade increasingly influence electoral choices. It is therefore legitimate to ask whether democracy can flourish without a reasonably informed citizenry.

## Constitutional concerns and democratic Equality

At the same time, any proposal linking voting rights to educational qualifications or knowledge assessments immediately encounters serious constitutional objections. The right to vote in India is not merely an administrative entitlement; it is an essential feature of representative democracy and equal citizenship. Conditioning the exercise of that right upon a test of knowledge risks creating distinctions among citizens that are fundamentally inconsistent with democratic equality.

The Indian constitutional experience points in a different direction. The framers consciously rejected literacy and property qualifications despite knowing that a large portion of the population lacked formal education. Their decision reflected a profound belief that political equality must precede social and educational advancement, not follow it. Democracy, in their vision, was not a reward for education but a means of empowerment.

## Lessons from the American experience

History offers a powerful warning. Literacy tests were employed in several Southern states of the United States from the late nineteenth century until the enactment of



the Voting Rights Act of 1965. Following the end of Reconstruction in 1877, states such as Mississippi, Alabama, Louisiana, Georgia, South Carolina, and Virginia introduced literacy tests, poll taxes, and similar devices as part of what became known as the Jim Crow system. The Mississippi Constitution of 1890 is often regarded as a watershed moment in institutionalising such measures. Although ostensibly designed to ensure an informed electorate, these tests were frequently administered in a discriminatory manner and were used to disenfranchise African Americans and poor voters. Their use was effectively prohibited by the Voting Rights Act, 1965, which sought to eliminate racial barriers to voting. What appeared reasonable in theory became exclusionary in practice. The lesson is clear: any mechanism that permits the State to determine who is sufficiently informed to vote carries the potential for misuse.

## The Indian way forward

This does not mean, however, that concerns regarding voter awareness should be ignored. The real challenge lies in improving the quality of democratic participation without restricting democratic rights. Instead of debating voter qualification tests, India may benefit from a national effort aimed at strengthening civic literacy. Public awareness programmes conducted by the Election Commission, schools, universities, civil society organisations, and media institutions can play an important role in familiarising citizens with constitutional values, governmental institutions, electoral processes, and the critical evaluation of information.

A democracy as large and diverse as India cannot depend solely upon periodic elections. It must also cultivate a culture of informed citizenship. Civic literacy should be viewed not as a prerequisite for participation but as a democratic responsibility that strengthens participation itself. The objective should be to create citizens who are better equipped to assess competing political claims and hold public institutions accountable.

## Proceeding with caution

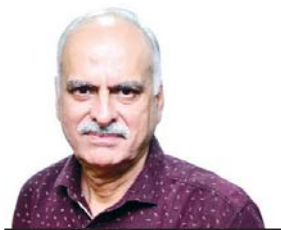
If any discussion regarding civic assessments is ever contemplated, it must proceed with extreme caution. Any such proposal would have to begin with the recognition that voting is a constitutional manifestation of political equality and not a privilege to be earned through educational achievement. Consequently, civic assessments should never operate as barriers to voting, nor should they create classes of citizens possessing unequal political rights. Any framework that seeks to promote informed participation must be designed and supervised by independent constitutional authorities, made accessible in all recognised languages, and subjected to rigorous judicial scrutiny to prevent abuse. Above all, the principle of universal adult suffrage must remain inviolable. The purpose of any reform should be educational rather than exclusionary; otherwise, the cure may prove more damaging than the disease.

## Building democracy through civic awareness

Ultimately, the debate raises a larger question: is the answer to voter ignorance fewer voters or better-informed voters? India's constitutional tradition strongly favours the latter. The remedy for misinformation is not disenfranchisement but education; not exclusion but empowerment. A democracy's strength lies not only in the number of citizens who vote, but also in the quality of public understanding that informs those choices. The case for civic literacy is compelling. The case for restricting the franchise is not. India's challenge in the coming decades will be to cultivate an informed electorate while preserving the equal political voice that remains the defining achievement of the Republic. In that endeavour, democracy and civic education must be viewed not as competing ideals, but as indispensable partners. An informed citizenry is not a substitute for democracy; it is one of its strongest safeguards.

The writer is a Senior Judge, District and Sessions Court, Agra

# J&K: Unending wait for statehood



ANIL ANAND

would have better suited the grand-standing style of the current ruling dispensation, wherein dates and symbols play a great role. The solemn assurance, "Statehood would be restored to Jammu and Kashmir at an appropriate time", is lurking in the air. Time and again, questions regarding the definition of "appropriate time", asked on the floors of the two Houses of Parliament and outside, have been deflected by the powers that be by hiding under the cover of "security". The ambiguity of "appropriate time-scale" has upped the index of dissatisfaction rather than satisfying curiosity, particularly among the people of Jammu and Kashmir, who are the direct beneficiaries/sufferers - depending on the prism used to view.

The solemnity of the assurance is getting diluted every day, with the Government not even ready to discuss it. There would have been no problem at all had this assurance not been given, with an intent to stick to the UT model. Then there would have been no need to restore and hold Assembly elections to provide a lame-duck democratic system two years back. The resultant dual power centre has created more confusion than solving any problem. On a more serious note, it has seriously damaged the sanctity of an elected government, with the power centres pulling in different directions and causing serious harm to the public cause, particularly on the development scale. The dictum of "statehood at an appropriate time" would have gained some credibility had there been a continuity effect rather than reiteration of the same nature time and again, which has convinced none barring the ruling dispensation circles and their staunch supporters. One dimension of continuity would have been through bringing transparency in the actions of the Union Government relating to Jammu and Kashmir, with proper explanation, barring those related to security, to the people of the country.

On the face of it, there is a marked improvement in the security situation in the UT. Since the Centre's basic premise behind the August 5, 2019, Constitutional changes in J&K was the then-prevailing "grave" security situation, if this goal has been achieved to a satisfactory level, the rethink on the statehood issue on the seventh anniversary would have been a fitting tribute to the Narendra Modi government's own benefit.

Occasional violence, including two incidents of targeted killings of innocent citizens and police personnel on the eve of the seventh anniversary of the dilution of Article 370, raises serious questions. It also raises doubts about the timing and intent of the perpetrators and the Government's narrative of total normalcy. Five years back, the Government committed before Parliament to restoring statehood without a definite time-frame, and repeated the assurance before the Supreme Court three years later. Meanwhile, with restoration of statehood remaining a mere charade, delimitation of Lok Sabha and Assembly constituencies has been allowed to proceed in an arbitrary manner, seemingly to achieve a particular political goal.

This has not benefitted anyone, including fulfilling the dream of the BJP of either forming a government in the UT on its own or winning a Lok Sabha seat in Kashmir Valley. But it has certainly harmed the cause of Jammu and Kashmir in its entirety a great deal. The fact of the matter is that right from August 5, 2019, the Article 370 issues were planned with a politico-electoral design. The prime motive seemed to be to pave the poll route for future battles of the ballot and not per se the betterment of J&K and its people. The net result is a terrible shortfall on economic and development scales, leaving aside political empowerment.

Flourishing tourism cannot be the only barometer to measure normalcy post August 5, 2019. It has many other dimensions which are deliberately being ignored. The prime factor should be the people's (of J&K) comfort and satisfaction, which has got a thorough beating. Although August 5, 2026, has gone by, there still exists a window of opportunity for the Union Government, provided by the ongoing Monsoon Session of Parliament. In addition to dealing with issues related to examination paper leaks and the Gen Z protests, and the resultant police action in Delhi, an initiative should come from the topmost level in the government. They should take the Opposition into confidence to pave the way for initiating the process in Parliament for restoration of statehood. No harm if a special session of Parliament is convened for this purpose, which will also give the Narendra Modi government a new high.

Such a move will certainly not come in the category of "scaling down", as is being made out in the case of Education Minister Dharmendra Pradhan's resignation. In fact, the Government will fulfil its own solemn commitment by doing so. The Union Government should not hesitate to act on this front, judging by the absence of any enthusiasm among people in both Jammu and Kashmir regions on the seventh anniversary day. Barring reactions of political parties on their stated lines, there was no public euphoria, which is also an indicator of disenchantment over unfulfilled promises related to economic upliftment, regional discrimination — particularly in relation to BJP's stronghold Jammu region - political empowerment through protection of land and job rights (on the lines of Himachal Pradesh and some other states).

The seventh anniversary also entails upon the powers that be to start serious introspection, without sitting on false prestige, regarding the real gains of the process initiated on August 5, 2019. No doubt, security and peace should be the top priority of the Government, but other issues related to regional discrimination, political empowerment and protection of basic rights cannot be overlooked and delayed any further. And even more important is to keep in mind the sentiments and feelings of people of Jammu and Kashmir. In the last seven years, this section has been totally bypassed. "How soon is soon?" The Government must reply to this question by former Home Minister P Chidambaram on the delay in restoring J-K statehood.

The writer is a political analyst



# Assam's flood reckoning: Time for a national strategy



SABIR NISHAT

have raised uncomfortable questions that go beyond extreme rainfall and overflowing rivers. Entire settlements have been obliterated, thousands displaced, livestock lost and livelihoods built over generations wiped out within hours. While relief and rehabilitation remain the immediate priority, the disaster must also become a moment of introspection. Was this catastrophe solely the result of nature's fury, or did years of ecological neglect and governance failures magnify its impact?

Among the worst-affected was Nepali Gorkhuti village near the Assam-Nagaland border, which was virtually erased from the map.

## Need for an independent probe

Allegations have surfaced that years of illegal mining and quarrying in upstream hill catchments, particularly along the Assam-Nagaland border, may have destabilised fragile slopes and increased the volume of sediment flowing into rivers. Environmental organisations and local residents

have questioned whether indiscriminate extraction of minerals weakened the natural landscape and intensified the floods.

These allegations must be examined objectively. Neither speculation nor political rhetoric can substitute scientific evidence. The Assam Government, in coordination with the Centre, should institute an independent inquiry involving hydrologists, geologists, environmental scientists, disaster management experts and remote-sensing specialists. If environmental violations are found to have aggravated the floods, accountability must be fixed and regulatory mechanisms strengthened.

## Floods know no political boundaries

The latest tragedy has once again demonstrated that flood management cannot be confined within state boundaries. Several rivers that inundate Upper Assam originate in the hills of Nagaland and Arunachal Pradesh before joining the Brahmaputra. Activities in these upstream catchments — whether mining, deforestation, road construction or unplanned development - have a direct bearing on downstream flooding.

This calls for institutional cooperation rather than piecemeal responses. Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland and Meghalaya need a permanent mechanism for integrated watershed management, real-time sharing of hydrological data, environmental monitoring and coordinated disaster preparedness. Such an arrangement should be facilitated by the Union Government through a river basin approach rather than isolated state-



level interventions. The Brahmaputra itself is an international river. Originating in Tibet as the Yarlung Tsangpo before flowing through India into Bangladesh, it underlines the importance of transboundary cooperation.

## Climate change has altered the equation

This changing climate reality demands a shift in policy. Planning based on historical flood patterns is no longer sufficient. Infrastructure, embankments and disaster management strategies must be designed to withstand more frequent and intense extreme weather events. For decades, Assam has demanded that its recurring floods be recognised as a national problem rather than a regional concern. The latest disaster strengthens that case. The Brahmaputra is among the world's largest and most dynamic river systems, carrying enormous quantities of water and sediment through one of the youngest and most fragile mountain systems on Earth. Every year, governments spend thousands of crores on relief, rehabilitation and

repairing damaged infrastructure, while the underlying causes remain inadequately addressed. A dedicated National Brahmaputra Basin Mission could transform the way floods are managed in the region.

## Beyond embankments

For decades, embankments have been the principal defence against floods in Assam. They have undoubtedly protected many towns, villages and agricultural areas. Yet repeated breaches during major floods demonstrate their limitations. Embankments cannot provide a permanent solution to a river as dynamic and sediment-laden as the Brahmaputra. Many river experts now advocate moving beyond the traditional approach of trying to 'control' the river. Countries such as the Netherlands have successfully adopted integrated flood management by restoring wetlands, protecting floodplains and allowing rivers more room to expand during high flows instead of depending exclusively on embankments.

Assam too needs a similar paradigm shift. Strengthening vulnerable embankments should continue, but this must be complemented by catchment area treatment, afforestation, wetland restoration, floodplain zoning, resilient infrastructure, scientific desiltation where feasible and modern forecasting systems.

Technology can also become a force multiplier. Satellite imagery, drone surveys, artificial intelligence-based flood forecasting and community-based early warning systems can significantly improve preparedness and reduce casualties.

Flood management requires strong institutions as much as engineering solutions. There is a compelling case for establishing a statutory Brahmaputra River Basin Authority comprising experts in hydrology, ecology, climate science, disaster management and public policy. Such an institution should coordinate research, monitor environmental compliance and formulate basin-wide strategies. Annual third-party safety audits of embankments before every monsoon, scientific mapping of erosion-prone areas, stricter enforcement against illegal mining and greater community participation in disaster preparedness should become integral components of flood governance.

## Turning tragedy into transformation

Assam's latest flood disaster must become a turning point rather than another chapter in the state's long history of recurring calamities. Reconstruction must be accompanied by scientific investigation, institutional reforms and long-term ecological planning.

Science-based policymaking, ecological stewardship, stronger institutions and sustained national investment can substantially reduce the scale of destruction. The recurring floods of Assam are no longer merely a State issue; they are a challenge of national importance. Recognising this reality - and acting upon it with urgency — may be the only way to ensure that tragedies like the one witnessed this year do not become the new normal.

The writer is the Deputy Director, Assam Information Centre, New Delhi



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### Order Order

## HC tells police to provide Majumder case details



The Calcutta High Court on Monday directed the Chandannagar police commissionerate to inform former Trinamool Congress MLA Asit Majumder whether any criminal cases were pending against him.

His lawyer, Kalyan Banerjee, expressed apprehension before the court that the former Chunchura MLA may have been arraigned in other cases after being granted bail by a magistrate following his arrest on July 21 on land grabbing charges.

Justice Saugata Bhattacharyya directed the commissioner of Chandannagar Police Commissionerate to provide Majumder, within one week, a list of criminal prosecutions, if any, pending against him.

The CBI had, in a report filed in accordance with the court's earlier direction, clarified that no criminal case was pending with it against Majumder.

The former MLA's lawyer stated before Justice Bhattacharyya that Majumder was arrested on July 21 and granted bail by a magistrate court in Hooghly district that day itself. He was arrested based on a police complaint by a neighbour that the former MLA had grabbed her property.

Majumder did not contest the assembly polls this year after the TMC denied him a ticket. (PTI)

## Ex-WFI chief case: Court calls it politically motivated



Two of the five complainant wrestlers stated that they were "forced/pressured" to level allegations of sexual harassment against former WFI chief Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh, a Delhi court has said in its judgement, noting their testimonies show the case seems to be politically motivated, "false and fabricated, made collectively" in deep conspiracy.

According to the copy of the judgement acquitting Singh, seen by PTI, the court also questioned how the complainants mentioned the "wrong country and year" of the alleged first such incident, saying "the contradiction is fatal to the prosecution case" as "it is not difficult but rather abnormal conduct to not remember the place where the incident of sexual harassment had occurred".

As the complainant wrestlers feared loss of their careers, they said they did not make any allegations against the accused in a timely manner, but "it is not understandable" as to how they maintained "cordial relations" with Singh for years and "he was invited to family functions and wedding ceremonies by the victims", said Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate Ashwini Panwar in his 239-page judgement.

On August 3, the court acquitted former BJP MP and ex-chief of Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) in the sexual harassment case filed by six women wrestlers, including World Championships medallist Vinesh Phogat, on grounds of lack of evidence. Besides Singh, the court also acquitted former WFI assistant secretary Vinod Tomar in the case.

The judgement, which has not been uploaded on the court's website so far, also referred to "tailor-made formal complaints drafted in a fancy manner" with "excessive decoration," filed on April 21, 2023, before the police.

The order said the "victims" mentioned the wrong country and year of the alleged first incident of sexual harassment.

"The contradiction is fatal to the prosecution case. It also affects the credibility of the witness and does not inspire the confidence of this court. (PTI)

## J&K court sentences ex-militant to life imprisonment for murder inside mosque

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ Srinagar

A court here has sentenced an ex-militant to life imprisonment for the 2020 murder of a former terror outfit chief inside a mosque, observing that violence in a place of worship cannot be tolerated.

Pronouncing the judgement on August 6, Principal Sessions Judge, Srinagar, Haq Nawaz Zargar said such acts strike at values of harmony and communal peace, and deserve strong judicial condemnation.

The court sentenced Ghulam Mohi-ud-Din Dar (60) to life imprisonment for the murder of Abdul Gani Dar alias "Abdullah Gazali" (78), former



chief of the erstwhile Tehreek-ul-Mujahideen outfit.

Gazali was found brutally murdered inside the Jamiat-e-Ahli Hadith mosque in the Gawkadal area on February 13, 2020. Dar, hailing from the Dalgate area of Srinagar, was arrested for the murder days later. Gazali, a resident of Beerwah in Budgam district,



## SC permits TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee to travel abroad

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ New Delhi

In a relief to Trinamool Congress MP Abhishek Banerjee, the Supreme Court on Monday permitted him to travel abroad for three weeks for eye treatment, brushing aside the West Bengal Government's apprehension that he may not come back due to 16 pending cases against him.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana observed that every individual has a right to choose medical treatment and asked Banerjee to share his itinerary of the visit, including the place of stay, with the probe agency.

It was hearing the Diamond Harbour MP's plea challenging the Calcutta High Court's August 5 order denying him permission to travel abroad for the treatment.

Additional Solicitor General SV Raju, appearing for the West Bengal Government, told the bench that there were 16 cases against Banerjee. "We apprehend that he may not come back," he said. The bench observed, "Every indi-



vidual has a right to go abroad. Every individual has a right to choose his medical treatment".

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, appearing for Banerjee, opposed Raju's submissions and said the TMC leader was an MP and his family is in India.

He said most of these cases were registered against Banerjee after the change of Government in West Bengal.

The law officer said they don't have any objection to Banerjee getting medical treatment abroad, but it has to be ascertained after medical assessment whether he will need to go abroad or not. He said if

Banerjee was not willing to undergo medical assessment, then adverse inference must be drawn against him.

The bench observed that seeking treatment for illness or condition sometimes is a part of the right to privacy.

After hearing the submissions, the apex court allowed Banerjee's appeal and permitted him to go abroad for three weeks.

The high court had on August 5 dismissed Banerjee's plea seeking permission to travel abroad, noting that he was unwilling to appear before the medical board at the state-run SSKM Hospital the next day for an assessment of his

medical condition. The high court noted that had Banerjee appeared before the medical board, based on the opinion furnished by the medical experts, the issue could have been examined by the court in order to find out whether he needed to go abroad for treatment or not.

On August 3, the apex court had asked the high court to take up within a week Banerjee's plea seeking permission to travel abroad for eye treatment. The top court was then told by Banerjee's counsel that the plea sought modification of the high court order to allow the MP to travel for medical treatment.

The high court had earlier extended till October 6 Banerjee's interim protection from coercive action in a case related to alleged comments against leaders and workers of a rival party at a public meeting on April 27 in the run-up to the second phase of the West Bengal Assembly polls.

Granting relief, the high court had directed Banerjee to cooperate with the probe and not travel abroad without the court's permission as previously ordered.

## SC adjourns Shiv Sena-UBT plea on merger of six MPs



**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday adjourned by two weeks the hearing on a plea filed by the Shiv Sena (UBT) challenging the Speaker's approval to the merger of its six MPs with the Shiv Sena led by Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde.

A bench of Justices P S Narasimha and Alok Aradhe noted that the office of the Lok Sabha Speaker and others were yet to be served the notice issued on the plea filed by Shiv Sena (UBT) leader Arvind Ganpat Sawant.

During the hearing, senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for the petitioner, submitted that the court has to consider for interim relief.

"There are serious consequences. The speaker can only decide a matter in defence on an application for disqualification. He doesn't have any plenary powers," Sibal said.

The top court said it will hear the matter after two weeks.

Ahead of the Monsoon Session, Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla on July 18 approved the merger of six Shiv Sena (UBT) MPs with the Shiv Sena led by Shinde.

Official sources had said with the merger of the six MPs, the strength of the Shiv Sena has gone up to 13.

A total of nine MPs had got elected on Shiv Sena (UBT) tickets, of which six have joined the Shiv Sena headed by Shinde.

## SC seeks Govt reply speedy trial in drug-trafficking cases

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday sought responses from the Centre and others on a plea seeking directions to strengthen the fight against drug trafficking, including a time-bound probe and trial of narcotics cases, confiscation of properties of traffickers and creation of a uniform investigation protocol.

Observing that the problem is "very serious", a bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana said coordinated efforts by expert agencies were required to deal with the menace. Advocate Ashwini Kumar Upadhyay, who has filed the petition, told the bench that a similar issue is already pending before the apex court. "The problem is very serious," the bench observed, adding that some kind of a solution has to be there by the expert agencies.

Upadhyay said some of the countries, including Singapore, have taken several effective



steps to deal with the problem of drug trafficking.

The plea, filed through advocate Ashwani Kumar Dubey, has sought directions to the Centre and states to prescribe mandatory timelines for the submission of forensic reports in cases under the Narcotic Drugs and Psychotropic Substances (NDPS) Act and frame standard operating procedures (SOPs) for search, seizure and sampling of narcotic substances.

It also sought a direction to the Centre to frame SOP for time-bound investigation and speedy trial in such cases.

"Keeping in view the menace of drug mafia network

operating in India, the court may be pleased to issue a writ, order or direction to, a) direct the Centre and state Governments to prescribe a mandatory timeline for submission of FSL (forensic science laboratory) reports in all NDPS cases; b) direct the Centre and states to formulate a SOP for search, seizure and sampling in small and intermediate quantity cases," the plea said.

It also sought the constitution of special courts for speedy trial of the NDPS cases and implementation of mandatory digital recording and videography of search, seizure and sampling proceedings.

## Ram temple donation row: Supreme Court to hear pleas on August 17

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday said it would hear on August 17 a batch of petitions seeking a court-monitored SIT probe into the alleged embezzlement of donations at the Ram temple in Ayodhya.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana was apprised by a lawyer that Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, who has been appearing for the Uttar Pradesh Government, has gone to the United Nations for a function. The bench deferred the hearing to August 17.

Earlier in the day, the top court agreed to consider the request by the counsel for the Uttar Pradesh Government for deferring the hearing on these pleas.

On July 27, the top court took note of setting up of a four-member SIT headed by IGP Kiran S to probe alleged embezzlement



of donations at the Ram temple.

It had asked the Uttar Pradesh Government to also include a forensic auditor in the probe team. Observing that "remedial actions will have to be taken", the bench had said steps will be taken to "ensure transparency".

The bench had also directed the Special Investigation Team (SIT) to submit a status report in two weeks.

On July 20, the bench had asked the Uttar Pradesh Government to apprise it about the possibility of setting up an SIT to probe the alleged embezzlement of donations.

It had asked the solicitor general to take instructions on whether the SIT, which had examined the entire issue before the registration of the FIR, could be entrusted with the responsibility to probe the case instead of the local police.

"Just a word of caution. Please don't politicise the issue. The courts are not a place for politics. It is a simple case of commission of crime. We are (here) just to ensure a proper investigation," the CJJ had said.

Investigation is going on and eight persons have been arrested, the law officer had said, adding he cannot divulge much.

## SC asks panel to verify Manipur rehabilitation claims

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday asked an apex court-appointed committee to verify claims that around 24,000 families affected by the 2023 Manipur ethnic violence are yet to receive benefits under Government rehabilitation and welfare schemes.

The top court also asked the Manipur and Assam Governments and others to consider setting up two special trial courts to exclusively hear CBI and NIA cases, respectively, arising from the violence.

A bench comprising Chief

Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana took note of the submissions of lawyers, including senior advocate Colin Gonsalves, that many affected tribals are yet to get the benefits of rehabilitation and welfare schemes.

The bench was hearing the issue of rehabilitation of the people who lost their dwelling units, houses and sources of livelihood during the violence.

It took note of the steps taken by the Government for rehabilitation of the affected families. It noted that funds have been disbursed to more than 4,000 beneficiaries out of



around 7,000 identified beneficiaries for the reconstruction of their houses.

The Government scheme provides ₹5 lakh for a kutchha house and ₹7 lakh for a semi-pucca or pucca house, the court noted.

More than 12,000 houses have so far been approved under the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana-Gramin (PMAY-G) for families affected by the violence, the bench said, while noting the submissions of senior advocate Vibha Dutt Makhija, appearing for the Justice Gita Mittal Committee.

The bench also noted that temporary shelters have been constructed and ₹51.95 crore released for 885 identified beneficiaries for permanent houses. In addition, ₹one lakh per household has been provided to families whose houses were completely damaged, it said.

However, it was submitted on behalf of some affected families that around 24,000 families were yet to receive the benefits, as could be verified at the ground level, it said.

The bench said it was informed that details of these families had been furnished to the three-member committee. "If that is so, we request the committee to verify and confirm the particulars of the alleged affected families and forward a note regarding implementation of the Government welfare schemes duly noticed by this Court in its order dated May 27, 2026," the CJJ said.

The court also directed that an application concerning properties of affected families be referred to the committee headed by Justice Mittal.

The committee will verify the particulars and status of the properties and submit a report to the court. On the issue of damages to the places of worship, the bench noted that a list of 276 properties had been furnished and the claims in respect of these properties required verification.

A separate list of 20 churches where encroachment has allegedly taken place was also furnished before the court, Gonsalves said.

## SC to hear Cauvery case on August 13

**PIONEER NEWS SERVICE**  
■ New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Monday agreed to hear on August 13 a plea of the Tamil Nadu Government seeking directions to the Karnataka Government for immediate release of the share of Cauvery water to it.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana took note of submissions made by the counsel representing the state Government that in a rain-deficient year Tamil Nadu was not getting its due share of Cauvery water.

"We will list it for hearing on Thursday," the CJJ said.

The Joseph Vijay led-state Government on August three

approached the Supreme Court seeking directions to the Karnataka Government for immediate release of the share of Cauvery water. The State Government, in its plea, claimed that the quantum allocated to it by the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee (CWRC) as well as that released by its neighbour Karnataka was far less.

A CWRC meeting held on July 28 directed Karnataka to release 3,500 cusecs for 15 days starting July 29, an order which was upheld by the CWMA later. However, the quantum of water released at Biligundlu ranged between 158 and 550 cusecs from July 29 to August 2, the state Government said.

A press release issued by the Tamil Nadu Government said that as of August 3, the com-



bined total storage in the reservoirs in Karnataka — KRS, Kabini, Harangi and Hemavathy — stood at 77,537 TMC and Karnataka would face no difficulty in releasing Tamil Nadu's due share proportionately.

Following rains in the catchment areas in the KRS and Kabini dams in Karnataka recently, the proportionate water to be realised at

Biligundlu should be 26.954 TMC, it said. "Accordingly, the Cauvery Water Management Authority order allocating 4,536 TMC is very less," the release added. Karnataka has "failed" to share with Tamil Nadu its due share of water and the quantum was 26.954 TMC, the press release said.

Earlier, the DMK, the main opposition party in Tamil Nadu, had also moved the top court seeking directions to the Karnataka Government for the immediate release of the due share of Cauvery water to the state.

The party has submitted that Karnataka must strictly follow the apex court's final 2018 verdict and comply with the directions issued by the Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA).



# India risks becoming a seller of lemons

## Akerlof won a Nobel for showing why markets collapse when buyers cannot judge quality. Software is becoming one — and India is on the wrong side of it



NISHANT SAHDEV

I keep returning to an old paper about used cars. George Akerlof wrote it in 1970 and had it turned down by three journals before it found a home. The argument annoyed people because it was so plain. You are buying a second-hand car. The seller knows whether it is sound. You don't, and finding out is expensive, so you offer an average price. But the owner of a genuinely good car will not sell at that price, so he keeps it. Only the bad cars are left, quality drops, buyers offer less, and the market spirals down until it barely functions. Akerlof called the bad cars lemons and eventually won a Nobel for noticing. I have been thinking about that paper all year, because the software industry is walking straight into it and I have not seen anyone say so.

Producing an answer and checking an answer are separate operations, and they do not scale together. In my own field it is far easier to generate a plausible model than to establish that it is right. The same holds for code. A system can now write you a working prototype in under a minute. Knowing whether it will hold up in production, at scale, against an attacker, in the fourth year, still takes what it always took.

*Sekar Vembu* has been on the sharp end of this for twenty-four years. He co-founded AdventNet, the company that became Zoho, with his brothers in 1996, and set up Vembu Technologies in Chennai in 2002. It sells backup and disaster recovery software into over a hundred countries.

**I asked him which assumption about the software industry will prove wrong over the next ten years.**

"The belief that AI will autonomously build software from detailed specifications with little human verification is mistaken. Software evolves iteratively as new use cases emerge. AI will assist, but domain expertise, judgement, and responsibility will always require humans in the loop." That is a statement about cost. If verification cannot leave the loop, it stays expensive

while production becomes nearly free. Cheap to make, dear to check. That is Akerlof's condition, restated for an industry that thinks it is having a boom.

Ask a founder what has changed and you get the symptom before the diagnosis.

**I asked what would be easier and what harder if he started Vembu today.**

"Access to talent and, because of AI, acquiring domain knowledge and building software will all be easier. Harder will be meeting higher customer expectations, standing out in a crowded market, and keeping young employees committed over the long term."

Most would read that as a founder complaining about marketing. Read it again as a description of a market. Making things gets cheaper, supply floods in, and buyers can no longer tell what is any good. That last item about long-term commitment is not a separate grievance either. I will come back to it.

What follows runs against nearly everything said about disruption. In a market where quality cannot be checked, incumbents get stronger. Buyers who cannot evaluate fall back on what they can observe — how long you have lasted and who else trusts you. Age becomes an asset. Dullness becomes an asset. A twenty-four-year-old company carries information a brilliant six-month-old product cannot manufacture at any price, because what it carries is duration, and duration is not for sale.

**Then the question of where advantage goes. If AI makes software dramatically cheaper, where do SaaS companies find their edge?**

"As software becomes cheaper to build, horizontal SaaS will face increasing pressure. The real advantage will come from deep vertical expertise and solving specialised industry problems. Without those domain-specific nuances, customers may simply build solutions in-house."

Everyone in Indian technology has heard "go vertical" by now. Nobody has explained why it works, and the reason matters more than the advice. Real depth works because you cannot fake it cheaply. When production costs collapse, the only signal worth anything is one that resists cheap production, and the small, ugly, specific cases inside a domain are exactly that. You cannot infer them from a specification. You have to have sat inside the problem for years and been wrong a few times. Depth is not a way



to win customers. It is a way to be checkable. Which brings me to why this should worry India in particular.

Our industry was built on an arrangement. The client specified, we produced, the client verified. That was the deal, and it made us rich. Our advantage sat entirely on the production side of the ledger — the side whose price just collapsed. In a lemon market, being the cheap supplier is not neutral. It is a warning sign. When a buyer cannot tell good from bad and abundance is everywhere, low cost stops signalling efficiency and starts signalling risk. That, I suspect, is the anxiety underneath the conversations in Bengaluru, and it will not be fixed by putting the letters AI into a services pitch.

**Asked what narrative investors and chief executives are getting wrong, Vembu does not hedge.**

"The idea that AI can replace human judge-

ment is fundamentally flawed. Human oversight will remain indispensable for complex work, especially in building complex and sophisticated software." Notice what he has done. He has moved the value off the thing that is now cheap — building software — and onto the thing that is not: being trustworthy at the moment something fails.

Now the policy point, and I know it is unfashionable. India's deep-tech effort is organised almost entirely around production — more startups, more funds, more models, more summits. But production is the input whose price is falling. The scarce thing is verified quality, and only one process manufactures it: the same people working on the same problem long enough that the record becomes the proof. We have no instrument for that.

**Asked whether the startup ecosystem has over-optimised for fundraising, Vembu described the pressure precisely.**

"The culture of raising large amounts of capital, scaling quickly, and chasing exits creates peer pressure, even for founders who want to build for the long term. Complex software needs patience and continuous improvement. Given today's geopolitical and economic uncertainty, the ecosystem may naturally shift toward longer-term thinking."

**His own most irrational-looking decision points the same way.**

"Remaining fully bootstrapped and independent seemed irrational when venture funding became the norm. In hindsight, it enabled long-term thinking and allowed the company to grow at its own pace rather than an investor's timeline. External capital has its place, but only when truly necessary."

If the only Indian companies building at the depth of this market rewards are those that opted out of the machinery designed to fund them, the machinery is aimed at the wrong thing. We fund the founding and applaud the exit. Nothing rewards a firm for being twenty years old and still fixing the same problem — peculiar in a country that talks about self-reliance and then measures itself every three months.

**His advice to a twenty-five-year-old founder building globally without venture capital follows from this, and deserves repeating because it is unglamorous enough that nobody will.**

"Generate enough revenue to fund product development through services, part-time work, or any practical means. Build steadily, ignore peer pressure, and don't measure success by the pace of others." That is not modesty. In a market that pays for duration, it is the strategy. It also explains the stray item about keeping young people committed.

**I asked what question journalists should ask more often. He did not name a technology.**

"They should ask about the second-line leadership — the people who quietly take responsibility, simplify complexity, and improve products every day. That culture of long-term commitment is what truly sustains a company."

That is the operational form of the whole argument. Duration is the scarce asset, and duration is made of people who stay.

Akerlof's paper ends with a point people forget. Lemon markets are not repaired by better products. They are repaired by institutions that make quality legible — warranties, brands, certification, reputation. All slow. None purchasable.

India spent thirty years learning to produce. The next thirty will turn on whether we can learn to be believed.

The author is a physicist at the University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill and a columnist on AI, infrastructure and global systems

## Gen Z: India's first AI generation

### Gen Z holds the key to transforming India's demographic dividend into a lasting AI dividend



RAJESH SETH

'Gen Z' has emerged as one of the most talked — about terms in India in recent past. The spotlight on this generation reflects a growing recognition that its aspirations, choices and capabilities will profoundly influence the country's future. Yet an even bigger story is unfolding beyond the headlines. Gen Z is India's first generation to step into higher education and the workplace in the age of AI.

For the Baby Boomers, the defining technology was television. Generation X witnessed the rise of the personal computer. Millennials transformed the smartphone into an indispensable companion. Gen Z grew up in the age of social media, with platforms such as Instagram becoming integral to communication, creativity and self-expression. It is now the first generation to begin its professional journey alongside AI. Unlike earlier technological revolutions that unfolded over decades, AI is evolving at a remarkable speed.

#### India's AI dividend

India is uniquely placed in this transformation. With one of the world's youngest populations, the country possesses an extraordinary demographic advantage. Yet demographics alone do not guarantee prosperity. India's demographic dividend will remain a statistic unless it is transformed into an economic, and an AI, dividend. That transformation will depend on whether its Gen Z are equipped to thrive in a n AI-driven world.

India's digital public infrastructure, expanding startup ecosystem and growing adoption of AI across sectors provide fertile ground for innovation. If educational institutions, industry and policymakers work in concert, the country has an opportunity not merely to participate in the global AI revolution, but to help shape it.

AI is already changing the nature of work. Routine tasks such as drafting documents, analysing large volumes of data, scheduling activities and generating basic content are increasingly being automated. Consequently, employers are beginning to value qualities that machines cannot easily replicate, like critical thinking, creativity, ethical judgement, learning agility and emotional intelligence. AI is not simply changing jobs; it is changing the skills that make people employable. The future belongs to those who can outthink AI.

#### AI as a thinking partner

This presents both an opportunity and a challenge for India's Gen Z. Unlike



earlier generations, today's students have unprecedented access to powerful AI tools that can explain concepts, summarize information, generate ideas and accelerate learning. However, frequent use of AI should not be mistaken for AI literacy. Knowing how to use an AI application is very different from knowing how to frame effective prompts, verify responses, recognise inaccuracies and apply AI thoughtfully. True AI literacy also means understanding AI's limitations, recognising bias, safeguarding privacy and knowing when human judgement must prevail. AI should become a thinking partner, not a thinking substitute.

Across classrooms and campuses, one sees students increasingly turning to AI for explanations, summaries and assignments. This need not be viewed with alarm. Every transformative technology has altered the way people learn and work. The real question is not whether students should use AI, but whether they continue to ask probing questions, challenge assumptions and develop independent judgement. Technology should amplify human intelligence, not diminish it.

#### AI — A powerful force multiplier

India's thriving startup ecosystem offers another reason for optimism. AI is lowering barriers to innovation and entrepreneurship. A young graduate today can build digital products, analyse markets, create educational content or

launch specialised services with resources that would have been unimaginable a decade ago. AI enables individuals and small teams to achieve outcomes once possible only for large organisations. Used wisely, it can become a powerful force multiplier for innovation, productivity and inclusive growth.

#### The five Cs framework

Gen Z's success in the AI era will depend less on mastering every new tool than on cultivating five enduring capabilities which I call **the Five Cs: Curiosity** to ask better questions, **Critical Thinking** to evaluate AI-generated answers, **Creativity** to produce original ideas, **Collaboration** to work effectively with both people and AI, and **Conscience** to ensure that technology is used ethically and responsibly. These capabilities will become even more valuable as AI becomes more capable.

The future will not be determined by AI alone. It will be shaped by the choices people make while using it. Throughout history, nations have progressed not merely because they acquired powerful technologies, but because they nurtured citizens capable of applying them wisely. India's Gen Z has the rare privilege of becoming the country's first AI generation. If it embraces continuous learning, combines technological fluency with human wisdom, and uses AI to create rather than merely consume, it can transform India's demographic strength into a lasting AI dividend. That may well prove to be one of the defining advantages of the nation in the decades ahead.

The author is an alumnus of IIM Ahmedabad and Professor of Practice at IILM University, Gurugram with an interest in AI, Technology and Strategy

## Param pragra: India's parivartan

### 'Fast forward frugal swadeshi enabled AI-powered super computing technology'



DR T SENTHIL SIVA SUBRAMANIAN

AI-Powered Super Computing Technology-Param Pragra is the 21st Century new super power era for our nation's new-age history of growth. Government of India in collaboration with Indian Institute of Technology, IIT Delhi's fast forward this initiative has placed our nation in the global map as super power computing nation. India has stepped in to the 6th supercomputing Industrial revolution. It has rewritten the computing chapter revolution of our nation which will open huge avenues and opportunities especially for young talents who are most capable to solve real-time research problems. AI powered enabling technologies such as cyber security, block chain and most importantly the quantum computing will get a great push and boost in several sectors of data science supercomputing science and engineering. This will be a big game changer for our nation's supercomputing ecosystem.

Param Pragra acts as a complete holistic technology, and also the first step for young minds whose computing knowledge has started from class 3rd in the form of inducting computational thinking as a subject to meet the objectives of National Education Policy 2020. The present decade has enabled ease of access to resources and technology for young minds who can tinker with computing technologies.

*Hon'ble Prime Minister of India Shri Narendra Modi Mission Mantra is "Challenges are converted into Chances". | Simulations are transformed into Solutions"*

India has traversed and transformed from conventional computing to supercomputing and achieved a huge milestone in opening the Param Pragra at Indian Institute of Technology, IIT Delhi. This big initiative is a collaborative effort of Ministry of Science and Technology, Government of India and Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology, Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC), Pune under the National Super Computing Mission (NSM). It is the stack of success for our nation. This supercomputing facility also reflects the starting of new computing technological yatra of our nation from scratch to success by developing supercomputing public infrastructures across the nation like Centre for Development of Advanced Computing (C-DAC) Bengaluru, S.N. Bose National Centre for Basic Science,



Kolkata [Paramrudra] which will push our country's both security and also social impact as well.

SN Bose National Centre for Basic Science provides computing resources at the cost of 1.6 paisa Per CPU Core Per minute and 70 paisa Per GPU card per minute. Students and faculty members can avail these facilities through online mode and perform high end complex research across several domains.

Param Pragra is indigenously developed and architect by scientists/researchers in India that adds to the supercomputing series of Swadeshi technologies — PARAM Siddhi, PARAM Pravega, and the PARAM Rudra systems. Param Pragra is one of the distinguished pillars of India's technological strength and adds strength to Digital India Mission. It gives access to the global countries and thereby establish a shared research and technological ecosystem for our nation. This will reinforce international and inter collaborations with industry, universities and startups, research laboratories. It will enhance the industrial and institutional research across PAN India.

Parap Pragra will boost Sarvam AI, Bhashini and BharatGen as well. And also, it reflects silent development, speed and scalability of technologies that are deployed across different applications in India.

#### Param Pragra — Projected potential applications

Param Pragra AI power super computing will solve complex computing problems and challenges in defence security, space explorations, maritime, nuclear forensic, energy security, disaster management, smart farming, healthcare which includes genomic domain and fintech sectors as well. With Param Pragra AI power supercomputing, India's big genome data base will foster frugal innovations

especially in health care sector. India has made a strong foothold in strengthening forensic sector. It could also be extended to AI powered crime scene investigations in forensic domain as well.

Parap Pragra will enhance institutional and industrial research as well. Param Pragra utilise high powered GPUs and AI chips so this will boost India's home-grown industrial infrastructures and manufacturing capability of GPUs and AI enabled semiconductor chips which in turn will facilitate India's National Semiconductor Mission as well. These systems will enhance the manufacturing capability of our nation and also in future will facilitate the Indian MSMEs and startups as well.

Param Pragra brings Parivartan to India's economy through new and next generation revolution technologies like Artificial intelligence thereby train large language models (LLM), high

powered neural networks, process massive data both video and audio. It will also penetrate deep into

the global market and thereby facilitate the integrated supply chain ecosystems and foreign trade as well. This will enhance the keen interest of international players to access super computing markets in India and across the globe.

#### Viksit super computing

India remembers the Prime Mantra of Prime Minister of India Shri Narendra Modi: Self Reliance, Technological Self-Reliance, Industrial Self-Reliance. Param Pragra is the first and forward step for the Viksit supercomputing Self-reliance technology. Param Pragra will give a big boost and added a strong foundation for the research and development especially the research supported by Anusandhan National Research Foundation [ANRF], Prime Minister research Fellowship.

Young talents from different sector will be able to tinker various supercomputing simulations using the Param Pragra both at micro and macro level. Param Pragra has made a paradigm shift in India's computing power sector. Young minds from various branches of STEM can explore various experiments and dwell into the deep technologies. Param Pragra spreads its wings across the India's space and show case clear visibility of technological power of our nation.

**India's Fore Front technologies always follow the Principles and Path of "Siddhi Se Sankalp"**

The author is an Assistant Professor, School of Cybersecurity and Digital Forensics, Uttar Pradesh State Institute of Forensic Science, Lucknow



# Iran will not reopen Hormuz without US concessions

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Dubai

Iran on Monday said it will not reopen the Strait of Hormuz until the United States met its conditions. "It is up to the US side to stop and make amends for its illegal and destructive actions," Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesperson Esmail Baghaei said, noting the American blockade of Iranian ports.

Iran wants the US to lift the blockade, pay compensation for months of war damage, lift economic sanctions and release Iran's frozen assets.

The closure of the Strait of Hormuz—a waterway that normally carries roughly one-fifth of the world's traded oil supplies - has become the war's most lasting consequence. The impasse has kept energy prices as a major focus of US politics ahead of November's midterm elections. Iran is holding sep-



arate talks with Oman over transit through the strait, including potentially a temporary shipping corridor. But it has said any actual reopening is contingent on talks with the US.

## Israel declares closed military zone in Taybeh

Israel's military said Monday it had declared a Christian-majority town in the occupied West Bank a closed military zone to keep out Israeli settlers and other non-residents.

The new tactic is designed to keep Israelis out of Taybeh, which is surrounded by settlements to its east and west and has been subject to arson, vandalism and settlers coming onto private and village property.

The order does not apply to Palestinian residents or journalists, who the army said would be allowed unless soldiers determine their presence poses a threat.

The army said its troops would detain suspects and disperse gatherings to keep the peace.

# Trivedi meets PM Tarique as Bangladesh pushes India on Sheikh Hasina extradition

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

Former Bangladesh prime minister Sheikh Hasina's recent press conference from New Delhi has sparked fresh diplomatic tensions between Bangladesh and India, with Dhaka once again pressing New Delhi to expedite her extradition during Indian High Commissioner Dinesh Trivedi's first meeting with Prime Minister Tarique Rahman on Monday.

The meeting, which lasted around half an hour, covered a range of bilateral issues, including Hasina's extradition and the return of suspects wanted in the murder of student leader Shahid Osman Hadi, according to Bangladesh's Prime



Minister's Office.

"Bangladesh hopes that India will expedite the process of extraditing Sheikh Hasina," the PMO said in a statement, adding that Rahman stressed the need to create a "suitable environment" to further strengthen bilateral relations.Hasina, who fled to India after being ousted in August 2024 following violent student-led

protests, virtually addressed the press on August 5 from New Delhi. She said she remained determined to return to Bangladesh in December to put the country back on the "right track" and restore democracy, despite the possibility of imprisonment or a death sentence.

The comments triggered an angry reaction in Dhaka. Bangladesh said the media interaction had hurt public sentiment and could undermine efforts to improve ties with India. The Government has described Hasina as an "absconding, convicted genocider."

India's Ministry of External Affairs, however, said on August 7 that it had no role in the media event and did

not endorse statements made there concerning the Bangladesh Government.

During Monday's meeting, Rahman also raised the issue of three suspects accused in the December 2025 murder of Osman Hadi.

The suspects were arrested in India in March and remain in judicial custody in West Bengal. India has agreed to extradite them to Bangladesh following due legal process.

Trivedi, who assumed office more than six weeks ago, also met Home Affairs Minister Salahuddin Ahmed on Monday and Foreign Affairs Minister Khalilur Rahman on Sunday. Security cooperation and bilateral relations were among the issues discussed.

# Earthquake with 7.4 magnitude hits Colombia killing at least 69

MANUEL RUEDA/ASTRID SUAREZ ■ Bogota

At least 69 people were killed and dozens of buildings collapsed in cities across western Colombia on Monday after a powerful 7.4-magnitude earthquake struck the South American nation, trapping residents under debris, leaving more injured and forcing people to evacuate their homes as far as the Capital of Bogota.

The epicentre was in San Jose Del Palmar, a community of about 4,800 people in the Choco region, about 250 miles (400 kilometres) west of Bogota, the US Geological Survey and Colombia's counterpart reported. The USGS said it struck at a depth of 66 miles (107 kilometres). The quake was also felt in neighbouring Ecuador.

Local officials confirmed that at least 18 people had been killed in the city of Pereira and two in the city of Manizales.

The quake left cities across the western part of the country ravaged, and residents picking through the pieces of the rubble amid concerns by authorities of aftershocks. Jorge Moncayo, a 64-year-old taxi driver in Colombia's third-biggest city, Cali, said he saw plumes of dust shoot up across the city from his home in the mountains as buildings collapsed after the earthquake. Residents in the city and rescue workers were already searching the rubble of collapsed buildings Monday morning.

"My entire house shook," he said. "I've never lived through such a powerful earthquake." In Manizales, a city nestled in the coffee-producing mountains of Colombia, one of the towers of the neo-Gothic cathedral collapsed and fell on the nave. Jorge Eduardo Rojas, the mayor of Manizales, said two people had died in the city "because of the quake" and asked residents to stay



Residents and rescue workers search through the rubble of a collapsed building after an earthquake struck Cali, Colombia

outside in case of aftershocks.

Choco Gov. Nubia Cordoba said on social media that "there are injuries and serious damage to buildings" in the regional capital of Quibdo, a city of about 130,000 people. She didn't provide further details.

Footage shared by local media outlets showed homes and small buildings collapsing in the cities of Pereira, Cali and Quibdo.

In Cali, a city of 2 million people, Mayor Alejandro Eder said that residents were trapped in at least 19 buildings that had collapsed.Small earthquakes, known as "temblores," are common in central and western Colombia, but those above 6.0 magnitude are rare. In 1999, a 6.2 magnitude quake near the city of Armenia killed more than 1,100 people.

Colombia's newly inaugurated President Abelardo de la Escriella said Monday that he had personally taken charge of the government's response to the emergency in San Jose del Palmar following the earthquake that struck the country.

"You are not alone. The state is present and taking action," he said. (AP)

# Ukrainian drone attack on Russian kills 13

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Kyiv

A Ukrainian drone attack on Monday on the Russian city of Nizhnekamsk killed 13 people, including a child, and wounded 48 others, authorities in the Tatarstan region said.

Officials didn't say what the drones targeted, but the city is an important oil refining hub, home to two refineries and a petrochemical plant. Ukraine has targeted Russian oil facilities with long-range drones almost daily in recent months. The barrage has caused fuel shortages in Russia, eaten into Russian refining capacity, and unsettled the Russian public.

Minnikhanov. No further details were immediately available. Ukrainian officials made no immediate comment. Nizhnekamsk is roughly 1,200 kilometers (750 miles) east of the Ukrainian border and has a population of about 240,000. Ukraine's domestically developed long-range drones have flown increasing distances deep inside Russia, with some now reaching Siberia, around 2,000 kilometers from the border.

"We do deliver entirely justified responses, and every Russian strike will be met with our response. Russia's war will be felt more and more at their own home – in Russia," Zelenskyy said late Sunday on social media.

"The only reason this is still continuing is Russia's unwillingness to end this war." Russia has also regularly battered Ukraine from the air using missiles, powerful glide bombs and drones, hitting civilian areas and causing thousands of civilian casualties, according to the United Nations.



Firefighters put out a fire following a Russian air attack in Kramatorsk, Ukraine

# Chinese envoy to Nepal calls on PM Shah, discusses bilateral ties



SHIRISH B PRADHAN ■ Kathmandu

China's Ambassador to Nepal Zhang Maoming on Monday called on Prime Minister Balendra Shah and discussed issues related to bilateral ties, mutual interests, development partnership and cooperation.

Ambassador Zhang paid a courtesy call on Prime Minister Shah at Singhadurbar, according to the Prime Minister's Office.

"Matters relating to further strengthening Nepal-China relations, promoting cooperation in various fields and advancing development partnership were discussed on the occasion," it said in a statement.

On the occasion, Prime Minister Shah stressed the need to further deepen historical ties with China and work together in areas of common interest, the statement said. Zhang expressed his best wishes to the Prime Minister and pledged to further strengthen the mutual relations and cooperation between the two countries. (PTI)

| AXIS BANK LTD.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|------------------------|-----------------------|--------------|------------|--|
| PUBLIC NOTICE FOR - AUCTION OF PLEDGED ASSETS BEING GOLD ORNAMENTS                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| The Borrowers, in specific and the public in general are here buy notified that public auction of the gold ornaments pledge in the below accounts is proposed to be conducted by the Axis Bank at the below mentioned Branch.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| That the below mentioned Borrowers has availed the credit facility from the <b>Axis Bank Limited</b> against the pledge of gold ornaments ("Gold Loan Facility") in favour of the Bank towards the security. The Demand notices were issued to the Borrowers/Guarantors calling up the Borrowers/Guarantors to pay their outstanding amount towards the Gold loan facility availed. As the Borrowers/Guarantors have failed to repay the outstanding loan amount, the bank is constrained to invoke the pledge and proposed to conduct an auction sale of pledged gold ornaments more particularly described in schedule of property hereunder on <b>11.09.2026 at 11:00 AM</b> on " <b>As In Where Is</b> ", " <b>As Is What Is</b> ", " <b>Whatever There Is</b> " and " <b>No Recourse Basis</b> ". Auction will be held at |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| DETAILS OF BORROWERS AND OUTSTANDING AMOUNT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| Customer Name                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Loan A/c No.   | Amount Outstanding (₹) | Date of Recall Notice | Gross Weight | Net Weight |  |
| B.O.: ASHOK VIHAR, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| AMIT KUMAR SAHNI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | XXXXXXXXXX6933 | ₹ 26,73,064.46         | 29-06-2026            | 484.500      | 455.300    |  |
| JITENDER SINGH                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | XXXXXXXXXX8001 | ₹ 2,23,593.27          | 13-07-2026            | 50.800       | 47.200     |  |
| PRANAV VERMA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | XXXXXXXXXX1324 | ₹ 19,24,418.66         | 13-07-2026            | 252.500      | 232.500    |  |
| VIKRAM MALHOTRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | XXXXXXXXXX0349 | ₹ 7,78,714.29          | 20-07-2026            | 298.900      | 284.200    |  |
| VIKRAM MALHOTRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | XXXXXXXXXX1758 | ₹ 13,65,440.00         | 20-07-2026            | 263.500      | 217.700    |  |
| VIKRAM MALHOTRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | XXXXXXXXXX3932 | ₹ 8,90,881.00          | 13-07-2026            | 157.800      | 143.200    |  |
| B.O.: BADARPUR DELHI DL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| ABHAY SINGH                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX2750 | ₹ 4,24,994.00          | 13-07-2026            | 51.070       | 50.020     |  |
| B.O.: BALI NAGAR, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| HARMEET SINGH                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX2516 | ₹ 20,24,687.00         | 13-07-2026            | 197.700      | 186.500    |  |
| MOHAMMAD JAVED                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | XXXXXXXXXX9644 | ₹ 5,97,523.92          | 20-07-2026            | 134.100      | 112.300    |  |
| B.O.: DWARKA, DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| NISHU SHOKEEN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX4365 | ₹ 18,08,841.38         | 07-05-2026            | 377.400      | 358.600    |  |
| POONAM DEVI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX5354 | ₹ 30,36,493.00         | 05-05-2026            | 323.900      | 288.900    |  |
| SHWETA DEWVEDI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | XXXXXXXXXX1897 | ₹ 14,39,156.30         | 13-07-2026            | 149.600      | 144.300    |  |
| B.O.: INDIRAPURAM, GHAZIABAD [UP]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| FLETCHER KAMRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | XXXXXXXXXX9470 | ₹ 110,89,412.92        | 18-04-2026            | 118.300      | 110.900    |  |
| B.O.: JYOTI NAGAR DEL DL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| ANKIT KUMAR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX9439 | ₹ 19,99,000.00         | 20-07-2026            | 207.600      | 191.900    |  |
| IJAZUL HASAN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | XXXXXXXXXX2635 | ₹ 14,75,997.69         | 18-04-2026            | 190.000      | 174.000    |  |
| SATYAPAL SINGH                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | XXXXXXXXXX6919 | ₹ 6,83,500.00          | 20-07-2026            | 81.700       | 74.600     |  |
| SONU                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | XXXXXXXXXX2789 | ₹ 24,71,018.17         | 20-07-2026            | 453.400      | 436.000    |  |
| UPENDER KUMAR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX8611 | ₹ 8,00,100.00          | 20-07-2026            | 81.100       | 79.000     |  |
| B.O.: KALKAJI, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| GHANSHYAM BIDAWT                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | XXXXXXXXXX6909 | ₹ 31,80,456.00         | 18-05-2026            | 324.000      | 306.500    |  |
| MOHD AZIZ                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | XXXXXXXXXX4632 | ₹ 2,45,657.00          | 13-07-2026            | 30.300       | 28.600     |  |
| B.O.: KISHANGANJ OD DL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| DHIRENDER KUMAR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | XXXXXXXXXX9862 | ₹ 1,79,208.00          | 13-07-2026            | 26.690       | 25.750     |  |
| DHIRENDER KUMAR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | XXXXXXXXXX4059 | ₹ 58,040.00            | 13-07-2026            | 26.690       | 25.750     |  |
| B.O.: LAJPAT NAGAR, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| ABDUL HAKEEM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | XXXXXXXXXX5470 | ₹ 1,64,553.17          | 20-07-2026            | 33.200       | 31.600     |  |
| KAVIDA TIWARI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX5477 | ₹ 9,80,001.00          | 20-07-2026            | 110.600      | 105.600    |  |
| B.O.: LAJPATNAGAR II, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| SANJAY CHAWLA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX5130 | ₹ 19,65,479.00         | 20-07-2026            | 344.750      | 337.650    |  |
| B.O.: LOKVIHAR, DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| SHALLEY KAPOOR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | XXXXXXXXXX6153 | ₹ 19,07,044.00         | 13-07-2026            | 200.200      | 192.200    |  |
| B.O.: MALVIYA NAGAR, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| DHARMENDRA .                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | XXXXXXXXXX0229 | ₹ 4,29,870.00          | 20-07-2026            | 50.400       | 47.400     |  |
| PUSHPA JEENA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | XXXXXXXXXX4733 | ₹ 3,48,349.00          | 20-07-2026            | 71.800       | 69.100     |  |
| REKHA SAKSAINA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | XXXXXXXXXX1059 | ₹ 5,14,570.34          | 04-06-2026            | 88.200       | 84.400     |  |
| SUJATA NIRMAL RAJ                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | XXXXXXXXXX5762 | ₹ 19,68,369.00         | 13-07-2026            | 198.200      | 190.500    |  |
| B.O.: NANGLOI DEL DL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| AMIT LAKRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | XXXXXXXXXX3252 | ₹ 5,10,397.00          | 13-07-2026            | 59.200       | 56.600     |  |
| JAI PRAKASH                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX8007 | ₹ 1,65,971.00          | 13-07-2026            | 22.200       | 20.850     |  |
| KAPIL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | XXXXXXXXXX7815 | ₹ 7,88,156.00          | 29-06-2026            | 70.100       | 67.100     |  |
| NISHA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | XXXXXXXXXX6522 | ₹ 11,26,503.00         | 13-07-2026            | 168.900      | 142.400    |  |
| B.O.: NARELA ,NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| DEV CHAUDHARY                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX6853 | ₹ 7,13,780.00          | 20-07-2026            | 75.600       | 71.700     |  |
| RAKESH SAINI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | XXXXXXXXXX9983 | ₹ 3,00,500.00          | 07-05-2026            | 58.000       | 44.400     |  |
| B.O.: NEW FRIENDS COLONY,NEW DELHI [                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| AMIT SAXENA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX1736 | ₹ 1,01,040.00          | 20-07-2026            | 18.000       | 17.000     |  |
| B.O.: PALAM, DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| AKLESH                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | XXXXXXXXXX7871 | ₹ 17,22,784.03         | 20-07-2026            | 207.200      | 188.400    |  |
| SANJAY KUMAR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | XXXXXXXXXX7768 | ₹ 5,78,982.00          | 20-07-2026            | 65.500       | 60.800     |  |
| SATISH KUMAR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | XXXXXXXXXX4868 | ₹ 19,40,760.40         | 18-04-2026            | 202.100      | 186.100    |  |
| URMILA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | XXXXXXXXXX7699 | ₹ 7,22,508.00          | 13-07-2026            | 78.000       | 74.100     |  |
| B.O.: PASCHIMVIHAR, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| NEHA SHARMA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX4675 | ₹ 38,525.25            | 13-07-2026            | 7.600        | 7.400      |  |
| SITARAM YADAV                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX7532 | ₹ 3,20,528.07          | 20-07-2026            | 38.280       | 34.200     |  |
| B.O.: PUSHPVIHAR,DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| GUGGULOTH SONALI RATHOD                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | XXXXXXXXXX9315 | ₹ 60,01,200.00         | 20-07-2026            | 719.400      | 579.400    |  |
| NARESH SEJWAL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX6709 | ₹ 6,46,311.00          | 20-07-2026            | 132.000      | 128.100    |  |
| B.O.: R K MISSION, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| VIJAY KUMAR THAKUR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | XXXXXXXXXX2561 | ₹ 94,345.02            | 13-07-2026            | 15.600       | 14.500     |  |
| B.O.: RAJOURI GARDEN, DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| BIKAR AHMAD                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX1631 | ₹ 30,26,560.00         | 20-07-2026            | 278.900      | 263.100    |  |
| B.O.: ROHINI, DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| AMIT JAIN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | XXXXXXXXXX4200 | ₹ 5,19,783.97          | 13-07-2026            | 100.900      | 80.600     |  |
| AMIT JAIN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | XXXXXXXXXX3021 | ₹ 1,88,448.45          | 20-07-2026            | 100.900      | 80.600     |  |
| DIVYANSHU KASTWAL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | XXXXXXXXXX7901 | ₹ 6,70,933.00          | 13-07-2026            | 92.200       | 72.900     |  |
| SAVITARI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | XXXXXXXXXX8323 | ₹ 21,197.00            | 04-06-2026            | 40.500       | 38.250     |  |
| B.O.: SECTOR-24,ROHINI, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| ARVIND KUMAR MISHRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | XXXXXXXXXX8821 | ₹ 17,72,200.00         | 13-07-2026            | 160.800      | 154.600    |  |
| RAJAN SAINI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX5776 | ₹ 94,293.70            | 13-07-2026            | 24.800       | 23.200     |  |
| SONIA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | XXXXXXXXXX0079 | ₹ 9,83,500.00          | 20-07-2026            | 104.000      | 97.100     |  |
| B.O.: SHAHDARA, DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| ABHISHEK MISHRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | XXXXXXXXXX9043 | ₹ 90,982.00            | 29-06-2026            | 11.600       | 11.000     |  |
| ANIL KUMAR CHAUHAN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | XXXXXXXXXX8258 | ₹ 7,27,752.00          | 13-07-2026            | 100.100      | 83.100     |  |
| KRISHNA SAW                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX9156 | ₹ 8,83,989.00          | 20-07-2026            | 149.500      | 134.200    |  |
| MOHD AALAM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | XXXXXXXXXX3171 | ₹ 7,12,000.00          | 13-07-2026            | 79.200       | 75.150     |  |
| MOHD AALAM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | XXXXXXXXXX6371 | ₹ 6,80,000.00          | 13-07-2026            | 72.900       | 69.600     |  |
| RADHA MOHAN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX3707 | ₹ 3,21,192.50          | 13-07-2026            | 35.000       | 33.800     |  |
| B.O.: SHALIMAR BAGH, DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| SANJAY KHAN                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | XXXXXXXXXX5146 | ₹ 5,41,569.33          | 18-04-2026            | 71.900       | 67.500     |  |
| B.O.: SOUTH PATEL NAGAR DL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| GAGAN GULATI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | XXXXXXXXXX9575 | ₹ 6,30,874.00          | 20-07-2026            | 70.420       | 65.860     |  |
| B.O.: SWASTHYA VIHAR, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| RAVI PAL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | XXXXXXXXXX5142 | ₹ 5,97,163.35          | 13-07-2026            | 81.800       | 75.500     |  |
| SHIVAM MUNJAL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX1455 | ₹ 92,591.00            | 13-07-2026            | 13.500       | 13.100     |  |
| SHIVAM MUNJAL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX7140 | ₹ 87,943.70            | 13-07-2026            | 14.200       | 13.800     |  |
| SHIVAM MUNJAL                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX1183 | ₹ 85,866.00            | 13-07-2026            | 12.100       | 11.700     |  |
| SUJATA KUMARI                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX7662 | ₹ 3,40,118.00          | 13-07-2026            | 40.000       | 38.800     |  |
| B.O.: TILAK NAGAR, DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| NEERU DHINGRA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | XXXXXXXXXX4084 | ₹ 6,29,966.00          | 20-07-2026            | 58.800       | 57.600     |  |
| B.O.: UTTAM NAGAR, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| BHOLE RAM                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | XXXXXXXXXX9403 | ₹ 40,55,526.98         | 13-07-2026            | 402.900      | 381.500    |  |
| DEEPA NSHU TEBAK                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | XXXXXXXXXX1218 | ₹ 4,20,529.77          | 13-07-2026            | 53.700       | 50.200     |  |
| B.O.: VIKASPURI, NEW DELHI [DL]                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                |                        |                       |              |            |  |
| ABHISHEK KUMAR                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | XXXXXXXXXX3429 | ₹ 2,53,078.45          | 15-06-2026            | 24.700       | 22.600     |  |



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## Rain Industries Ltd profit jumps in June quarter



Carbon and advanced materials manufacturer Rain Industries Ltd on Monday said its profit after tax jumped fourfold to ₹341 crore in the April-June quarter, driven by price increases, favourable feedstock costs and improved product mix.

The company had reported a profit after tax of ₹83 crore in the June quarter of 2025 and ₹158 crore in the March quarter of 2026, a company statement said on Monday. Revenue stood at ₹5,167 crore in the June quarter, compared to ₹4,335 crore, registering a growth of 17.4 per cent YoY, ahead of market expectations, it said. "Growth was primarily driven by the Carbon and Advanced Materials segments, while Cement revenue remained relatively subdued," the company said.

Carbon segment revenue increased 17.9 per cent YoY to ₹4,021 crore, supported by stronger realisations and higher calcination volumes. Advanced Materials revenue grew 26.3 per cent YoY to ₹1,198 crore, driven by higher volumes in chemical intermediates and resins and improving customer demand. On outlook, the company stated that it remains cautious in the September quarter amid geopolitical, logistics and commodity market volatility, while its global footprint, flexible supply chains and alternate feedstocks provide resilience. (PTI)

## Waaree Renewable wins 124 MWp solar order



Waaree Renewable Technologies Ltd on Monday said that it has received a letter of award for setting up a 124 MWp DC solar power project.

The project comprises a 124 MWp DC/88 MW AC solar PV plant, along with an associated 132/33 kV Pooling Substation (PSS), a company statement said.

The company will undertake the engineering, procurement, construction, installation, testing and commissioning of the solar PV plant and associated balance-of-system infrastructure. The scope also includes engineering, procurement, civil works, erection, installation, testing and commissioning of the associated pooling substation. (PTI)

## India, SACU may ink trade pact terms on August 12



India and South Africa-led SACU group are likely to sign Terms of References (ToRs) on August 12 for starting negotiations for a preferential trade agreement (PTA), an official said. The five members of SACU (South African Customs Union) are Botswana, Eswatini (formerly Swaziland), Lesotho, Namibia and South Africa.

On the sidelines of the BRICS trade and industry ministers' meeting, Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal met Parks Tau, Minister of Trade, Industry and Competition of South Africa.

"We discussed the signing of ToRs for India-SACU PTA and early conclusion of negotiations, strengthening the India-South Africa trade engagement and explored opportunities for cooperation in the critical minerals, pharmaceuticals and manufacturing sectors," he said in a social media post. (PTI)

## Govt collected ₹10,463 cr from gold, silver duty hike

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The Government has collected ₹10,463 crore as customs duty on gold, silver and platinum between May 13 and August 2, Parliament was informed on Monday.

The import duty on gold and silver had been hiked to 15 per cent, from 6 per cent, and that on platinum to 15.4 per cent from 6.4 per cent, with effect from May 13. Consequential changes were also made to other items, including gold and silver dore, coins, and findings. In a written reply to a



question in the Lok Sabha, Minister of State for Finance Pankaj Chaudhary said the Government has collected ₹10,040 crore as customs duty on gold between May 13 and August 2.



## Government aims for zero road accident fatalities, says Gadkari

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

The Government is working to reduce road fatalities to zero and has also identified 100 districts with high accident rates for urgent intervention, Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari said on Monday.

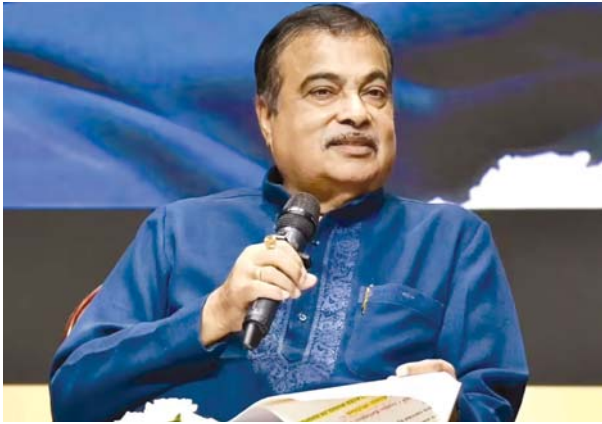
The Government aims to halve the number of road accidents and resultant deaths by 2030.

Addressing an event organised by ICICI Lombard, Gadkari said changing public behaviour and enforcing traffic laws remain the country's biggest challenges in improving road safety.

"We are working to reduce road fatalities to zero. Authorities have also identified 100 districts with high accident rates and are targeting black spots for urgent intervention," the minister said.

The number of road accidents in India rose by 5.3 per cent to more than 5.13 lakh in 2025, with road crashes claiming the lives of 21 people every hour, according to Government data.

On average, 59 road accidents occurred every hour in



the country. "A total of 5,13,563 road accidents have been reported by police departments of states and Union Territories in the country during the calendar year 2025, claiming 1,83,382 lives," Gadkari said.

The minister also said that police departments in states and Union Territories reported a total of 2,85,770 road accidents across the country during the first six months of 2026.

Gadkari said among vehicle categories involved in road accidents, two-wheelers accounted for the highest share in total fatalities during 2025, followed by light vehi-

cles — cars, taxis, vans and other light motor vehicles - and trucks/lorries.

"If two-wheeler users start wearing helmets, then it would help in reducing fatalities and serious injuries due to road accidents," the minister said.

In terms of road-user categories, the share of two-wheeler riders in total fatalities was the highest at 46.2 per cent, followed by pedestrians at 20.6 per cent, those using cars, taxis, vans and LMVs at 12.4 per cent, he added.

Gadkari said road crashes result in economic losses equivalent to roughly 3 per

cent of India's GDP, calling the situation a "basic challenge" for policymakers.

He outlined a strategy focused on road engineering, automobile safety and stricter enforcement for reducing road accidents.

Referring to India's automobile sector, Gadkari pointed out that the quality of vehicles manufactured in India is good and the cost is less, so all top automobile companies are present in the country.

"When I took charge as transport minister, the size of the Indian automobile industry was ₹14 lakh crore. The size of the Indian automobile industry now is ₹22 lakh crore," Gadkari said.

Presently, the size of the US automobile industry is ₹78 lakh crore, followed by China (₹47 lakh crore) and India (₹22 lakh crore).

According to the minister, the automobile industry has created 4.5 crore jobs till now — the highest in the country.

"This is the automobile industry, which is giving maximum revenue as a part of GST to the State Government and Bharat Sarkar," he added.

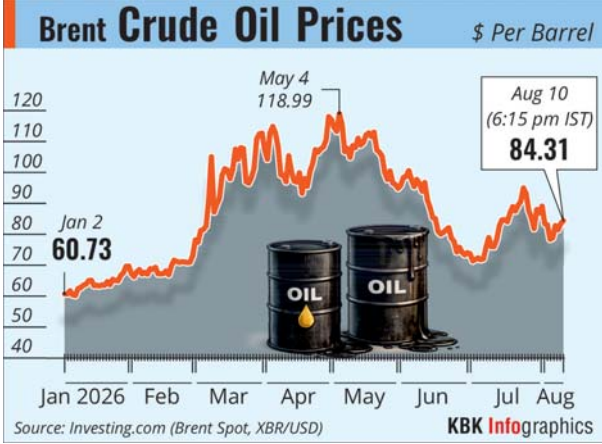
## Stock markets end marginally higher on spike in crude oil prices

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ Mumbai

Market benchmark indices ended marginally higher on Monday, with the Sensex climbing over 43 points and the Nifty ending flat, amid a spike in crude oil prices due to geopolitical uncertainties.

The 30-share BSE Sensex was up 43.27 points, or 0.06 per cent, to settle at 78,542.44. During the day, it hit a high of 78,676.98 and a low of 78,298.92, gyrating 378.06 points.



The 50-share NSE Nifty went up marginally by 13.15 points, or 0.05 per cent, to end at 24,583.80.

From the Sensex pack, Titan, Bajaj Finance, Bajaj Finserv, Tata Steel, Asian Paints, and Infosys were among the laggards.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, jumped 1.10 per cent to \$84.47 per barrel.

"Indian equity markets

## Rupee falls 11 paise to close at 95.28

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ Mumbai

The rupee declined by 11 paise to settle at 95.28 (provisional) against the US dollar on Monday amid a firm greenback and a rise in global crude oil prices.

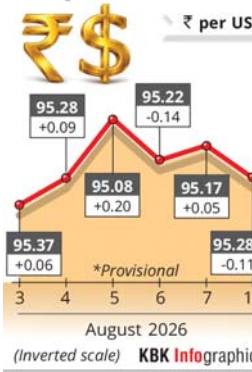
Lack of any breakthrough in talks in West Asia put further pressure on the local unit, while FII inflows provided some support, forex traders said.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 95.18 and traded in a narrow range of 95.18-95.31 during the day. The local unit settled at 95.28 (provisional), down 11 paise from its previous close of 95.17 on Friday.

"Rupee marginally dipped from last Friday's closing of 95.17. The slight weakness was due to the rise in Brent crude above \$84 and the consequent expected impact on trade deficit. However, the FPI inflows, which have turned positive in July and are increasing in August, too, though in small quantities, are providing support to the rupee," V K Vijayakumar, Chief Investment Strategist, Geojit Investments Ltd, said.

"The rupee declined on

Rupee vs Dollar



Monday on uncertainty over a deal between the US and Iran and overnight surge in crude oil prices. US dollar strengthened from lower levels. However, positive domestic markets cushioned the downside," Anuj Choudhary, Research Analyst, Mirae Asset ShareKhan, said.

"Traders may remain cautious ahead of the US inflation data this week. S&P spot price is expected to trade in a range of \$95-95.60," he said.

Meanwhile, the dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was trading at 99.66, up 0.13 per cent.



## Parliament panel seeks ground check of physical check-posts

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE

■ New Delhi

A Parliamentary committee on Monday asked the revenue department to "ascertain the ground reality" by taking up with the concerned State Governments on instances of State police, commercial tax departments and highway authorities continuing to operate physical check-posts, causing avoidable inconvenience to the movement of goods.

The standing committee on Finance's 'Action Taken Report' of the revenue department, tabled in the Lok Sabha, emphasised that unauthorised physical check-posts and routine vehicle interceptions defeat the core premise of Goods and Services Tax (GST) as a seamless, barrier-free national market.

The committee pulled up the revenue department for not "explicitly mentioning" whether follow-up action

was taken to verify these instances with the state governments or whether the matter was brought before the GST Council, as recommended by the committee.

The committee noted that the ministry, in its reply, has merely explained the existing legal provisions under the GST framework and technological tools, rather than addressing the ground reality of unauthorised physical check-posts.

"The committee, therefore, expects the department of revenue to take up the matter with the concerned State Governments to ascertain the ground reality and, if required, bring it to the notice of the GST Council for systemic resolution, and strengthen portal reporting mechanisms to protect transporters from transit delays. The action taken details in this regard may be furnished in the Final Action Taken Statement," the committee said in its report.

### PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE is hereby given that **Jagjeet Kaur** claims to be owner and in possession H. No.5-K/12A, in N.I.T Faridabad, Haryana (hereinafter called the said property) by virtue of Sale Deed dated 16.02.2026 reg vide Doc No. 8775 & said **Jagjeet Kaur** agreed to sell the said Property to **Parmod Kumar** and said **Parmod Kumar** has agreed to create a mortgage the said Property in favour of our clients **IDFC FIRST BANK LTD, Rajendra Place Branch**, any person/s having claim against the said Property, or any part thereof, by way of sale, exchange, mortgage (equitable/registered or otherwise), gift, trust, inheritance, lien or otherwise howsoever, are hereby intimated to notify the same in writing to us with supporting documentary evidence at the address mentioned below within **7days** from the date hereof, failing which the claim or claims, if any, of such person or persons will be considered to have been waived and/or abandoned and our client shall proceed with the disbursement of loan and subsequent creation of mortgage in respect thereof.

**Vishal Diwan (Advocate)**  
Diwan & Company  
Ho.No.2 (LGF), MRI Complex, N.D-19  
Email: [vishalidwan@diwanandcompany.com](mailto:vishalidwan@diwanandcompany.com)

### PUBLIC NOTICE

That the original prior title-chain documents, namely, the Original Sale Deed dated 13.07.2001 executed in favour of **Shalja Bhargav** and the Original Sale Deed dated 15.12.2005 executed in favour of **Raj Kumar Bhutani** and **Ashok Kumar Bhutani**, have been misplaced/lost. In this regard, an Information Report bearing **LR No. 521475/2026 dated 08.08.2026** has been lodged/reported.

Under the circumstances, notice is hereby given to the General Public, Bank/Financial institutions or other person/s, organization/s, company/ies, government authority/ies, having any claim, rights, title, or any interest of any nature whatsoever into or upon the said property, is hereby called upon to make the same known, in writing with documentary evidence by registered AD Post to the undersigned at the address mentioned hereinbelow within 7 days of the publication of this notice and in the event no response having been received to the notice, the title of **Shibani Khosla** to the said property shall be deemed to be clear of any claim, charge or encumbrance of any nature whatsoever and any subsequent claim shall not bind our client in any manner whatsoever.

**Kumar Abhishek**  
Advocate  
Legal Access  
132A, Anarkali Complex, Jhandewalan Ext. New Delhi

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**Kumar Abhishek**  
Advocate  
Legal Access  
132A, Anarkali Complex, Jhandewalan Ext. New Delhi

## The Pioneer Classified

### LOST & FOUND

**I, Rizwan Ahmed Khan S/o.** Abrar Ahmed Khan, R/o. F-17/1, House No.502, Jogabai Extension, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, have actually lost my original degree B.A. (pass), Roll No.97P151, Enrolment No.972690 issued from Jamia Millia Islamia (2020).

### CHANGE OF NAME

I, hitherto known as Amir Ansari W/o Late Rais Khan R/o Noor Jalan Masjid, M-81/1, 20 Futa Road, Batlia House, Jamia Nagar, Okhla, South Delhi, Delhi-110025, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Amir Khan.

**I, Sonu, W/o Pawan Kumar**, aged 43 years, R/o R21 Rail Enclave, Sector 12, Pratap Vihar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh. Hereby declare that I have changed my name from Sonu to Sonu Kumar for all purposes.

**I, Ranjana Chakrabarti W/o** Nirmal Kumar Chakrabarti R/o Flat No-A401, Himalaya Sahkari Awasi Samiti Sector-5 Vasundhara Ghaziabad. Hereby declare that I have changed my name from Ranjana Ray to Ranjana Chakrabarti for all purposes. Henceforth Ranjana Ray and Ranjana Chakrabarti one and the same person. Aditya Ray is my son, and residing at the same address.

**I, Anam Mustafa Khan W/o** Abuzar Hussain Khan R/o D147, Sector-40, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, UP-201301, have changed my name to Anam Mustafa for all future purposes.

**It is for general information** that I, Phoolbadan S/o Suraj Nath R/o Behind, TTI, A - 705, Jhuggi, Block - K, Jahangirpuri Delhi - 110033, declare that the name of mine is wrongly written as Phood Badam in my minor son Nitish Yadav (17 years) in his school certificate. Correct name is Phoolbadan.

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
Notice is hereby given to the General Public that Mrs. Chhavi Rani W/o Mr. Rahul Gupta is the owner of A Basement of Residential Property No. 107, area measuring 151 sq. yd. (126.25 sq. mtr.) Situated at Kasba Lawar Pargana Daurala, Tehsil Sardhana Dist. Meerut (U.P.). Same is Owned by Sale Deed Dated 26.06.2021 Document No.0020 That Chain Document Sale Deed Dated 27.12.2019 Document No. 22116 Executed by Mr. Bhupendra S/o Late Mr. Dhyanam & Mr. Rahul Gupta S/o Mr. Ansh Gupta in favour of Mr. Amit Kumar S/o Mr. Ansh Singh that this documents has been lost Mr. Amit Kumar informed to U.P. Police on dated 04.08.2026 through L.A.R.No. 2026000083214 General Public informed that Mr. Amit & Mrs. Saroj are Mortgaging this property with Graham Housing Finance Ltd. All Persons are hereby informed that if anybody has found this document or Any Person, Corporation, company, financial institution & others has any claim/charge/interest/title in the said property or any kind of dispute kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 7 days of the present.  
**Rohit Kumar Advocate**  
Medhasw Enforcement & Legal Service  
Office No. 329, Third Floor, Aditya Palace, Conch Road, Meerut U.P. Mob no: 7300601626, 9818171626  
Email: [medhaswienforcement@gmail.com](mailto:medhaswienforcement@gmail.com)

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
Notice is hereby given to the public at large that my clients Mr. Akhil Saini and Mr. Sunil Manchanda are the lawful and joint owners of half portion back side of third floor and 1/4th undivided share of terrace facing temple side of property bearing no. 1/L, Valsava Nagar, New Delhi-110017. That one Agreement for Sale/Purchase dated 10.06.2026 was executed between 1. Mr. Akhil Saini S/o Late Sh. Anil Saini 2. Sunil Manchanda S/o Sh. Balvinder Manchanda (First party/Seller) and 1. Mr. Aditya Tiwari S/o Sh. Raj Kumar (Second Party/Purchaser) in respect of sale/purchase of the aforesaid property, is hereby cancelled/ terminated with immediate effect due to failure of purchaser to pay the consideration amount as agreed in the aforesaid agreement. Any person dealing with the second party in respect of the aforesaid property shall do so at their own risk and cost and if anyone has done any kind of transaction/dealing etc. with the above said property of my clients in the past, same shall be treated as null and void and if anyone deals with this property in any manner or hatches conspiracy against the interest of my clients, he/she will be prosecuted as per law.  
**Sameer Khan (Advocate) Ch. No. 623, Dwarka Court, New Delhi - 75, Contact No. 9818151568**

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
**AURIGA BUILDWELLPRIVATE LIMITED**  
Reg. Office: Flat No.230 2ND Floor Vesta Awasi Apartments Sec-18A Dwarka-110075  
CERTIFIED TRUE COPY OF THE RESOLUTIONS PASSED BY THE BOARD OF DIRECTORS OF AURIGA BUILDWELL PRIVATE LIMITED AT THEIR MEETING HELD ON WEDNESDAY, 20TH MAY, 2026 AT ITS REGISTERED OFFICE.  
"RESOLVED THAT in supersession of all board resolutions passed previously by Auriga Buildwell Private Limited, including but not limited to board resolutions passed on 31.01.2024 or any others also if any the authority given to Mr. Teg Bahadur Rai's son of Mr. Lalita Prasad Rai Vide above referred resolutions and otherwise whether express or implied, stands withdrawn with immediate effect.  
"RESOLVED THAT all directors of the Company be and are hereby severally authorized to convey the said withdrawal of authority of Mr. Teg Bahadur Rai to all persons concerned as well as to the statutory authorities, Noida Authority and the public at large by way of publishing notices in newspapers, if need be, in the areas/localities of operations of Auriga Buildwell Private Limited and/or such other means, as they think fit to protect the best interests of the Company.  
For AURIGA BUILDWELLPRIVATE LIMITED  
**VISHAL VERDHAN RAJENDRA SINGH** DIRECTOR  
DIN: 01186364  
**RAJENDRA SINGH** DIRECTOR  
DIN: 03278865

**DMI HOUSING FINANCE PRIVATE LIMITED ("COMPANY")**  
(U65923DL2011PTC216373);  
Registered Office: Express Building, 3rd Floor, 9-10, Bahadur Shah Zafar Marg, New Delhi-110002;  
T: +91 11 41204444; F: +91 11 41204000; email: [dm@dmihousingfinance.in](mailto:dm@dmihousingfinance.in))

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
This is to inform our valued customers and the general public that, due to unavoidable circumstances, our Meerut branch office, currently located at **First Floor, 256/9, Shastri Nagar, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh - 250004**, will be relocated from 14<sup>th</sup> August to the following address: **29/1, 3rd Floor, Mangal Pandey Nagar, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh - 250004**  
We are working to ensure a smooth transition to our new premises and appreciate your patience during this period.  
For any queries or further updates regarding our new operational location, please contact our Customer Support using the mobile number or email address provided below.  
We sincerely apologize for any inconvenience this relocation may cause and thank you for your continued support.  
Thank you,  
**DMI Housing Finance Pvt. Ltd.**  
Contact Person Name: **Shiv Kumar**  
Mob: **9837679555**  
Email: [shiv.kumar1@dmihousingfinance.in](mailto:shiv.kumar1@dmihousingfinance.in)

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
This is to inform the general public that Mr. Ravinder Nath Vishwas is the Possessor of the House No. D-73 built-up portion of plots no. 72 and 73, area measuring 24 Sq. Yds out of Kharsa no. 33/25 situated at Village Khayala in colony known as Chaurampur in Vishwa garden Extn. no.8 in New Delhi. He is in Possession through GPA, ATS dated 01.06.2004 executed by Mrs. Shalinda Devi in favour of Mr. Ravinder Nath Vishwas in respect of House No. D-73 built-up portion of plot no. 72 and 73, area measuring 24 Sq. Yds out of Kharsa no. 33/25 and Regd. WILL dated 12.03.1999 executed by Mrs. Shalinda Devi in favour of Mr. Ravinder Nath Vishwas in respect of house No. D-73 built-up portion of plot no. 72 and 73, area measuring 24 Sq. Yds out of Kharsa no. 33/25 having no 388.  
Mr. Ravinder Nath Vishwas intends to transfer the ownership of above said Plot by way of Sale Deed to Rita Devi and Sall Ram Yadav. Subsequently, Rita Devi and Sall Ram Yadav are in the process of mortgaging the said plot with S&PFI India Home Finance Co. Ltd. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 7 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 7 days period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client.  
If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 7-days period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44/A, Sector-36, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline:- +9102-04499721, e-mail: [complaints@vnorth.in](mailto:complaints@vnorth.in)

Mr. Vibhas Sharma has approached ICICI Bank Ltd., Noida, U.P. (Bank) to avail a loan for purchase of Unit No. D-402, 4th Floor, (1135 sq. fts.), Tower-D, Prateek Laurel, Plot No. GH-01, Sector-120, Noida, Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P. from Mr. B.C. Pande, who has represented that he is the sole & absolute owner of the said property by virtue of Sub Lease Deed dated 30.06.2013 (Doc-7761) and Mutation Letter dated 26.03.2025 issued by Noida issued after the death of his wife Mrs. Alka Pande, the co-owner. If anybody, person, body corporate has any right, lien or claim whatsoever on the said Property by way of inheritance, mortgage, sale or otherwise, then he/she/it may contact the undersigned with documentary proof of claim within 15 days of publication of this notice, otherwise it shall be deemed that either there are no claims or the same have been waived off. No claim or objection shall be entertained thereafter and Bank shall proceed to advance the loan on mortgaging of the said property.  
**Amit Kumar, Advocate**  
**Narang & Associates**  
D-28, Jangpura Extension, New Delhi-110014.

**PUBLIC NOTICE**  
Notice is hereby given that my client Saddam in process to avail LAP against Plot of land area measuring 105.70 Sq. Yards, i.e. 88.40 Sq. Mtrs., out of Kharsa No. 6/75, Situated at Jewar Banger (Bahar Nagar Panchayat Chhatrala), Tehsil Jewar Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P. which is in the name of Fakrudin (availing loan from Saraswat Co-op Bank Ltd), having acquired the said property vide Sale Deed dated 08.05.2024 executed by Mrs. Radhika Garg (Doc no. 5818), whereas he has lost following documents pertaining to the said property, viz. FIF, which are already been lodged for that on dated 3/8/26  
a. Original Sale Deed dated 20.11.2020 executed by Mrs. Munshi in favour of Mrs. Anita Goyal (Doc no. 7581).  
b. Original Sale Deed dated 14.02.2024 executed by Mrs. Anita Goyal in favour of Mrs. Radhika Garg (Doc no. 2172).  
All persons having any claim against or in respect of the said Property, or any part thereof, by way of sale, exchange, mortgage (equitable/registered or otherwise), gift, trust, inheritance, family arrangement, maintenance, bequest, partnership, possession, lease, sublease, tenancy, license, lien, charge, pledge, easement or otherwise howsoever, are hereby requested to notify the same in writing to us with supporting documentary evidence at the address mentioned below within 7 days from the date hereof, failing which the claim or claims, if any, of such person or persons will be considered to have been waived and/or abandoned.  
**Kamal Kant Gupta (Advocate)**  
Unit No. FF-2, First Floor, Mahalaxmi Metro Tower Sec-4, Vaisali, Gzb, U.P., Mob. 98110083351



PROSPECT

A Demographic potpourri



PRIYANKA SHRIVASTAVA

Demographic profiling has never been so interesting as it is now. The cohorts like the 'boomers', gen x', 'gen z' dominating our social lingo. They mirror the zeitgeist perfectly and they wear it like an honour badge, especially the late entrants in the debate, the gen z and the alphas. Boomers are quintessentially the generation of our father's, the septagenarian

and the octogenarian, the zealous lot, who climbed the ladder with the dint of hardwork .

Steeped in idealism and proponents of greatest work ethics. Gen x or the quadraeranian and quiquagenarian are literally the backbone, a generation of cusp; saw the technical boom and the world changing from analog to digital. They are diligent and often chisel their skills to reinvent and upgrade. They were last cohort to see a normal childhood.

Minnenials are the tricenarian and the quadraeranian amongst us. They are the most educated, well groomed and tech savvy. They got a tyrst with a smart phone first and a watershed moment of clicking a selfie .

They are the largest cohort on any social app.Full of zest and brimming with ideas armed with unique perspective, lend a great value to any project. Gens z are the teens and the tricenarian .

They are known for their guts , chutzpah and intelligence They got a traction with the recent protests The social vocabulary is brimming with their new slangs unheard before. Alphas are a sweet lot, waiting in the wings . It's a potpourri of sorts, but shared values add structure and cohesiveness.

The writer is a freelance writer and columnist with specialisation in cultural, social and lifestyle issues

Army opens 43 internship projects on AICTE portal

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA  
■ New Delhi

The Indian Army has for the first time opened its establishments to student interns through the Indian Army Internship Programme hosted on the AICTE National Internship Portal.

The programme offers 43 specialised projects with a stipend of up to ₹75,000 and up to 15 AICTE credits. It has already received over 77,000 applications since its launch, and the last date to apply is set as August 15, 2026.

The internships cover Artificial Intelligence, cyber-security, robotics, drones and counter-drone systems, hospital information systems, wargaming and simulation, and strategic communication.

Selected interns will work directly with Indian Army establishments for 75 days, comprising 60 days on-site and 15 days work-from-home, under the mentorship of Army officers and subject-matter experts.

Of the 43 projects listed, around 18 remain open for application.



The most applied-for project so far is an AI and Machine Learning internship focused on upgrading and fine-tuning AI and large language models at the Directorate General of Information Systems, which has received 11,848 applications.

A Data Analyst internship at the Army Design Bureau has drawn 7,419 applications, followed by a DevSecOps Engineer role

with 5,530 applications and a Full Stack Software Developer role with 5,488 applications. Establishments offering projects include DGIS, Army Design Bureau, EME Directorate, DG Signals, Directorate General of Medical Services, Directorate General of Army Air Defence, Infantry Directorate, WARDEC, and others.

Students from AICTE-approved technical and professional courses across the

country can apply to multiple projects but may accept only one offer letter. No application fee is charged.

AICTE CEO Dr Buddha Chandrasekhar said the programme brings India's brightest young minds into the heart of the nation's defence and technology ecosystem.

Students must apply at [internship.aicte-india.org](https://internship.aicte-india.org) before August 15. Eligibility, location, and deadlines vary by project.

Hindustan Copper Q1 net profit zooms to ₹352 crore

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

State-owned Hindustan Copper Ltd on Monday reported a 162.4 per cent surge in consolidated net profit at ₹352.37 crore for the quarter ended June 30, 2026, on the back of higher revenues.

The company had posted a consolidated net profit of ₹134.25 crore in the year-ago period, Hindustan Copper said in a filing to the BSE.

The revenue from operations during April-June quarter rose 81.3 per cent to ₹936.50 crore over ₹516.37 crore in the year-ago period, the filing said.

The total expenses during the first quarter increased to ₹481.83 crore over ₹347.29 crore in the corresponding quarter of the previous fiscal, the filing said.

Hindustan Copper Limited (HCL), is a Mini-Ratna Central Public Sector Enterprise under the mines ministry. It is the only company in India which is engaged in copper ore mining and holds all the operating mining leases for copper ore in the country.

The company's current focus lies on exploration, mining, and beneficiation of copper ore to produce and sell copper concentrate. HCL



operates copper mines in Malanjkhand in Madhya Pradesh, Khetri in Rajasthan and Ghatsila in Jharkhand. It has a primary smelter and refinery at Ghatsila, secondary smelter and refining facilities in Jhagadia, Gujarat, and a continuous cast copper wire rod plant at Taloja, Maharashtra.

The PSU has planned a capital expenditure of ₹7,188.90 crore over the next five years to expand mining operations.

The company is planning a capex of ₹450.51 crore in the current year, followed by ₹1,421.73 crore in 2027, and ₹1,993.70 crore in 2028. It plans to spend ₹2,227.18 crore in 2029 and ₹1,095.48 crore in 2030.

The company is also targeting to increase its production capacity, with total ore production projected to rise from 4.21 million tonnes per annum (MTPA) in 2025-26 to 12.20 MTPA by 2029-30.

HWWA celebrates Hariyali Teej

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

The Himveer Wives Welfare Association (HWWA), the welfare organisation dedicated to the families of Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) personnel, celebrated Hariyali Teej with great enthusiasm and traditional fervour on Monday. The vibrant event was hosted by the 22nd Battalion, ITBP, at Tigri Camp, New Delhi.

The celebration featured a range of colourful cultural performances, traditional games, Mehendi, the Teej queen competition, and other festive activities. Traditional swings (*jhoolas*) and folk songs added to the festive atmosphere, reflecting the richness of India's cultural heritage.

Addressing the gathering, Bharti Kapur, chairperson, HWWA, extended her greetings on the occasion and



highlighted the significance of the festival.

She said, "Hariyali Teej is an integral part of India's rich cultural heritage. It symbolises love, devotion and trust, while inspiring us to preserve our traditions and pass them on to future generations. Such festivals strengthen family bonds and keep our cultural values alive." She also encouraged HWWA

members to take pride in India's traditions and continue to uphold the country's rich cultural heritage.

The cultural performances by HWWA members and the Teej queen competition were among the major highlights of the event and were warmly appreciated by all present. Senior members of HWWA also graced the occasion.

Central Sanskrit University hosts seminar, felicitation

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ New Delhi

Central Sanskrit University (CSU), New Delhi, through its Research and Development Cell, organised a National Seminar, book release and the inauguration of a special lecture series on August 8 and 9, focusing on the philosophical richness of the Vedanta tradition and its contemporary relevance.

The National Seminar was held on August 8 at the Veda-Vedanta Study and Research Institute (VVSRI), Vasant Kunj, New Delhi, where the volume Vedantadarsanasangraha was formally released.

The programme was graced by His Holiness Sri Sri Vishwaprasanna Tirtha Swamiji of Pejawar Adhokshaja Matha, Udipi, and Mahamahopadhyaya Sadhu Bhadreshdas Swamiji of the BAPS Swaminarayan Research Institute. Professor



Srinivasa Varakhedi, Vice-Chancellor, Central Sanskrit University, presided over the programme.

On this occasion, Vice-Chancellor Professor Varakhedi stated that Akshar-Purushottam Darshan is the seventh Vedic

philosophical school (darshan) in India's Vedic philosophical tradition, and it has been given a place in the mainstream in the book Vedantadarsanasangraha published by the university.

Continuing the series, on 9th August, from 5 to 7 pm, a

special lecture series was also launched at Swaminarayan Akshardham, New Delhi, in the presence of distinguished scholars from across India. His Holiness Sri Sri Vishwaprasannatirtha Swamiji Maharaj of the Pejawar Adhokshaja Matha,

Udipi, inaugurated the lecture series by delivering the first lecture.

On this occasion, Central Sanskrit University specially felicitated His Holiness Sadhu Bhadreshdas Swamiji and conferred upon him the honorary title "Vedanta Vidya Visvaguru", in recognition of his distinguished contributions to Vedanta scholarship, Sanskrit literature and the Indian Knowledge Tradition. Swamiji dedicated this honor at the feet of His Holiness Mahant Swami Maharaj.

The programme was also attended by eminent scholars and Vedanta experts from across the country, including Professor Sukanta Kumar Senapati, Vice-Chancellor, Somnath Sanskrit University, and various others Vice-Chancellors and Professors.

Professor Ganesh T Pandit served as the coordinator of the programme.

Galgotias University launches future-ready BTech and BBA programs with Accenture Learn Vantage

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE  
■ Greater Noida

Galgotias University has entered into a strategic industry-academia collaboration with Accenture Learn Vantage to launch a portfolio of industry-integrated undergraduate programs designed to equip students with the technology, business and professional skills needed to succeed in the age of AI. The collaboration brings together Galgotias University's academic foundation and vibrant campus ecosystem with Accenture LearnVantage's industry-led learning expertise to help bridge the gap between classroom learning and evolving workforce requirements.

Galgotias University has entered into a strategic indus-



try-academia collaboration with Accenture Learn Vantage to launch a portfolio of industry-integrated undergraduate programs.

As organisations increasingly adopt artificial intelligence, cloud, data and digital technologies, employers are seeking graduates who can combine strong foundational knowledge with practical, indus-

try-relevant capabilities. To address this need, the collaboration will introduce specialised BTech and BBA degrees and establish an Accenture Centre of Advanced Studies on campus to support these industry-integrated programs.

The program portfolio includes four BTech specialisations — Cloud and AI, Full Stack Development with AI, Data Science, AI and Machine Learning, and Design Engineering — and two BBA specialisations: AI-Integrated General Management and AI-Powered Sales and Marketing.

Students will benefit from a structured blend of academic learning, industry-led content, hands-on projects, virtual labs, interactions with industry

experts, assessments and certifications alongside the degree from Galgotias University on successful completion of the program. The curriculum is designed to help students connect classroom concepts with real-world applications while developing capabilities aligned to the needs of modern enterprises.

Dr Dhruv Galgotia, CEO, Galgotias University, said, "The future belongs to students who can adapt, innovate and apply knowledge in real-world contexts. Our collaboration with Accenture LearnVantage represents an important step in reimaging undergraduate education by integrating academic rigor with industry relevance. Through these future-ready programs, students will gain access to contemporary learning experiences, emerging technologies and professional development opportunities that will help them build successful and meaningful careers."

Anurag Bansal, Managing Director, Accenture Learn Vantage, Asia Oceania, said, "AI is transforming every industry, increasing the demand for graduates who combine domain expertise with AI fluency.

**VTDS signs landmark strategic technology partnership with DEUS Automation a.s., a sister company of the STV Group, Czech Republic, to Advance Indigenous Small-Calibre Ammunition Manufacturing in India**  
**New Delhi:** Vijayan Trishul Defence Solutions (VTDS), licensed by the Ministry of Home Affairs, Government of India, for manufacture and proof-testing of small arms and ammunition, has entered into a strategic technology partnership with DEUS Automation a.s., a sister company of the STV Group, Czech Republic. The collaboration marks a significant milestone in India-Czech defence industrial cooperation and one of the first major technology-transfer collaborations in small-calibre ammunition.

Founded by Sahil Luthra and Prikansha Luthra, VTDS will gain advanced manufacturing technology and expertise from DEUS Automation to establish world-class small-calibre ammunition production capabilities in India. The partnership aligns with Atmanirbhar Bharat and Make in India, supporting reduced import dependence, indigenous manufacturing, supply-chain resilience and long-term defence preparedness, while establishing a framework for sustained technology exchange, industrial development and innovation between Indian and Czech defence industries.

DAILY SUDOKU

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 4 | 2 | 8 | 7 | 1 |   |   |   |   |
|   |   | 3 |   |   |   |   |   | 6 |
|   | 9 |   | 4 |   |   | 7 |   |   |
| 7 | 3 | 1 |   |   | 8 |   | 9 | 8 |
|   |   |   |   | 9 |   |   |   | 2 |
|   |   | 7 |   |   | 4 |   | 9 |   |
| 5 |   |   |   |   | 4 |   |   |   |
|   |   |   | 7 | 9 | 2 | 5 | 6 |   |

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9×9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3×3 box, using elimination and logical deduction—no maths involved.

SOLUTION (10.8.26)

|   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |   |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | 5 | 2 | 8 | 1 | 6 | 4 | 7 | 9 |
| 7 | 8 | 9 | 5 | 4 | 2 | 6 | 1 | 3 |
| 1 | 4 | 6 | 9 | 3 | 7 | 2 | 5 | 8 |
| 4 | 9 | 7 | 6 | 2 | 1 | 8 | 3 | 5 |
| 8 | 3 | 5 | 4 | 7 | 9 | 1 | 2 | 6 |
| 6 | 2 | 1 | 3 | 5 | 8 | 7 | 9 | 4 |
| 9 | 7 | 8 | 1 | 6 | 5 | 3 | 4 | 2 |
| 2 | 6 | 4 | 7 | 9 | 3 | 5 | 8 | 1 |
| 5 | 1 | 3 | 2 | 8 | 4 | 9 | 6 | 7 |

DOUBLE CROSSWORD  
TUESDAY | AUGUST 11, 2026

|    |    |    |    |   |    |    |    |
|----|----|----|----|---|----|----|----|
| 1  | 2  | 3  | 4  | 5 | 6  | 7  | 8  |
|    |    |    |    |   |    |    |    |
| 10 |    |    | 9  |   |    |    |    |
|    |    |    |    |   |    |    |    |
| 13 |    | 14 |    |   |    | 15 | 16 |
| 17 |    |    |    |   |    | 18 |    |
|    |    |    | 19 |   |    |    |    |
| 20 | 21 |    |    |   |    | 22 | 23 |
| 24 |    |    |    |   | 25 |    |    |
|    |    |    | 26 |   |    |    |    |
| 27 |    |    |    |   |    | 28 |    |
|    |    |    | 29 |   |    |    |    |
| 30 |    |    |    |   |    |    | 31 |

ACROSS

1 A quiet game (5)  
6 Fruitful explorer? (5)  
9 Won that new piece of furniture (7)  
10 Bread or dough (5)  
11 Make fun of the fare (5)  
12 Out to produce froth (5)  
13 Highly regarded, though always in the red (7)  
15 Give mistaken evidence of humanity (3)  
17 A one-man club (4)  
18 A long way to go for a hat (6)  
19 It comfortably supports many a Russian (5)  
20 Manoeuvred crookedly and got nailed

DOWN

2 Is both nosy and noisy (6)  
3 We occupy obscure dens in the country (4)  
4 Your thorny exterior (3)  
5 Was an upright representative (5)  
6 Being a deliverer is not a job for a boy (7)  
7 Draw some sketches (4)  
8 Change a character of former dishonesty (5)  
12 Smelly new diet at the welfare centre (3)  
13 Possibly first evidence of disagreement (5)  
14 Speak of love in sin (5)  
15 Consume tea, perhaps, and a bit of supper (3,2)  
16 Expressed great displeasure at what the storm did (5)  
18 Coat available in various colours (5)  
19 A wanted woman (7)  
21 A month of majesty (6)  
22 Thin spears can break (6)  
23 Reigned soundly, albeit under restriction (6)  
25 Expel out of a hotel to a humbler place (5)  
26 Populous centre of Acton, now rebuilt (5)  
28 Only a minority have noisy ways (3)

SOLUTION (10.8.26)

|             |             |              |               |
|-------------|-------------|--------------|---------------|
| ACROSS      | 24. Braille | DOWN         | 17. Study     |
| 3. Chest    | 26. Ski-Ves | 1. Bac-on    | 19. Ar-rival  |
| 8. Latin    | 29. Vi-e    | 21. Mild-red | 20. Chas-in   |
| 10. Cello   | 31. Miser   | 4. Heat      | 21. Pa-Ris    |
| 11. Col     | 32. Dailton | 5. S-cat-ty  | 23. Blessed   |
| 12. Japan   | 34. N-avel  | 6. Tenor     | 24. Be-rate   |
| 13. Woodcut | 35. Sad     | 7. Blues     | 25. Lil (rev) |
| 15. Tomes   | 36. Stout   | 9. To-O      | 27. Kitty     |
| 18. Rum     | 37. Rebe-l  | 12. Jumpers  | 28. Devus     |
| 19. At rest | 38. Serve   | 14. Cup      | 30. Mode-L    |
| 21. Peppery |             | 16. Melee    | 32. Venn      |
| 22. Head    |             |              | 33. Tab       |
| 23. Be-ad   |             |              |               |



## BRIEFLY

### Rayhan Thomas finishes 71st on Korn Ferry Tour



Indian golfer Rayhan Thomas endured a tough week as he finished Tied-71st at the Pinnacle Bank Championship on the Korn Ferry Tour in Omaha (USA). Thomas had modest rounds of 68-71-72-72 for a 1-under total.

Rookie Mahanth Chirravuri closed the week with rounds of 65-68-71-68 for a 12-under total and was Tied-19th. It was the 22-year-old Indian-American's best finish in eight starts on the Korn Ferry Tour.

Frankie Harris, who made an 18-foot birdie putt on the final hole for a 12-under 59, won the title with a par on the second playoff hole for his first Korn Ferry Tour title in only his sixth start this year. Harris shot 27 on the back nine of The Club at Indian Creek. (PTI)

### Jeev closes well on weekend to finish T-7th at PGA seniors



Indian golf legend Jeev Milkha Singh finished a creditable tied 7th at the 2026 Staysure PGA Seniors Championship after carding two-under 70 in the final round here.

The 54-year-old, who won a title last season at the IGPL Colombo against players half his age and some even less, shot rounds of 76-71-69-70 to finish 2-under for the week.

South African Darren Fichardt, who lost in the play-off last year, put behind that setback to win the 2026 PGA Seniors by five shots at Trump International Golf Links, Aberdeen.

Earlier in the week Jyoti Randhawa missed the cut with rounds of 74-79.

Jeev has been playing on multiple circuits, including the IGPL in India, Asian Tour, European Senior and the Japan Senior Tour. (PTI)

### Paris Saint-Germain strengthens defense by signing Lucas Digne



Champions League winner Paris Saint-Germain has strengthened its defense by signing left back Lucas Digne from Aston Villa on a three-year contract.

PSG announced the deal on Sunday evening without giving financial details. Sports daily L'Equipe said it paid the Premier League club 10 million euros (\$11.6 million).

The 33-year-old Digne was born in the Paris suburbs and previously played for PSG after joining from Lille in 2013. He then represented Roma and Barcelona before spending eight years in the Premier League with Everton and Villa.

An energetic defender with accurate passing, the left-footed Digne became a France regular in recent years under former coach Didier Deschamps. He played at the recent World Cup, where Les Bleus reached the semifinals, and has 64 caps. (AP)

## Manas Dhamne gets maiden Davis Cup call-up

AMANPREET SINGH ■ New Delhi

Manas Dhamne on Monday earned his first call-up to India's main Davis Cup squad, while team management has retained the core that produced win over the Netherlands for the crucial Qualifiers Round 2 tie against South Korea in Seoul on September 18-19.

World number 362 and country's number two singles player Dhamne has been knocking on doors of the senior team. He joins India's singles group comprising seasoned campaigner Sumit Nagal (ranked 235) and Dhakshinewar Suresh (Ranked 393), the breakout star of the previous tie in Bengaluru. Yuki Bhambhani (Ranked 28) and N



Sriram Balaji (Ranked 57) form the doubles combination. Sidharth Rawat (536) and promising youngster Arnav Paparkar, who has

been competing in junior GGrand Slams, have been named as the two reserves.

"Most players selected themselves. Manas was not available for the previous tie, this time he was. While he is in the main squad, the captain will decide if he suits the conditions or the other singles players. Arnav is in side as we need to groom the future generation," a selection committee member told PTL.

The selection reflects continuity after India's remarkable 3-2 victory over the Netherlands in Bengaluru in February, which took the country into the second round of the Qualifiers for the first time since the Davis Cup format was revamped in 2019. (PTI)

## Women's hockey WC: India's journey from 1974-2022

MONA PARTHSARATHI ■ New Delhi

Indian hockey's rich legacy is largely associated with the eight-time Olympic champion men's team, but the women's side has had a far more arduous journey, marked by inconsistent participation at the World Cup. From finishing fourth at the inaugural edition in France in 1974 to ending ninth in 2022, the India women have featured in only eight of the 15 editions of the tournament so far.

Here is a look at Indian women's WC journey:

**1974, France:** Led by Ajinder Kaur, India made a memorable debut, defeating eventual champions the Netherlands in the group stage. Wins over Mexico and Spain helped India top their pool despite a defeat against Belgium. India lost to Argentina in semifinals before going down to West Germany in bronze medal match.

**1976, Berlin:** India were unable to participate in the second edition because of



financial difficulties, inadequate institutional sponsorship and lack of funds with the Indian Women's Hockey Association.

**1978, Madrid:** Led by Rupa Saini, India returned to the World Cup and finished seventh among 10 teams. They beat Czechoslovakia and drew 1-1 with Canada but lost to the Netherlands and Argentina in Pool A.

**1981, Buenos Aires:** Despite finishing fourth at the 1980 Moscow Olympics, India failed to qualify for the World Cup in Argentina. Financial and

administrative problems affecting the national federation restricted the team's participation largely to regional and invitational events. West Germany won the title.

**1983, Kuala Lumpur:** India returned after winning gold at the 1982 Asian Games. Led by Salma D'Silva, the team, however, finished at the bottom of its group after four defeats and a draw against Wales.

**1986, Amstelveen:** India failed to qualify after finishing fifth in the 1985 World Cup qualifiers in Buenos Aires. The

team did, however, win a bronze medal at the 1986 Asian Games in Seoul. The Netherlands defeated West Germany to claim their fourth title, while Canada came third.

**1990, Sydney:** India's World Cup hopes ended in the qualifiers. The 1989 Intercontinental Cup qualifier was held at the Major Dhyan Chand National Stadium in New Delhi, with the top four teams from the 12-team competition advancing. India won two and lost three of their five matches, scoring 15 goals and conceding nine, and finished fourth in Pool B to miss out on qualification.

**1994, Dublin:** India narrowly missed qualification again. In the 1993 qualifiers in Philadelphia, the top five of the 12 participating teams qualified, but India finished sixth.

**1998, Utrecht:** Captained by Pritam Rani Siwach, India returned to the World Cup after failing to qualify three successive times. They lost all five Pool A matches and finished 12th and last.

**2002, Perth:** India failed to qualify after losing to the United States in a tough qualifying contest in June. A few weeks later, however, the team produced a landmark performance by winning gold at Manchester Common wealth Games. That triumph would later inspire the Bollywood film Chak De! India.

**2006, Madrid:** India finished 11th among 12 teams after ending last in Pool A, with four defeats and a draw.

Surinder Kaur was among the tournament's leading scorers, finishing joint second with the Netherlands' Kim Lammers on five goals. Dutch player Sylvia Karres topped the scoring charts with six.

**2010, Rosario:** The World Cup marked the emergence of a young Rani Rampal, who announced herself on the international stage with seven goals. India registered their only pool stage win against Japan, while losing their other four matches to finish fifth in their group.

India later defeated South

Africa 4-3 in the classification match to finish ninth overall.

**2014, The Hague:** India entered the 2013 Asian Cup in Kuala Lumpur with a World Cup qualification spot at stake. However, they lost to South Korea in semifinals and had to settle for third place after defeating China. Japan secured berth through continental qualification route.

**2018, London:** Led by Rani Rampal, India reached the quarterfinals. The team finished third in Pool B after drawing against hosts England and the United States and losing to Ireland. In the crossover match, India beat Italy. They, however, bowed out in the quarters after losing to Ireland in penalty shootout.

**2022, Amstelveen and Terrassa, Spain:** Savita Punia led India to a draw against England and China in pool matches but lost to New Zealand. In the crossover, India beat Canada 3-2 in penalty shootout before beating Japan 3-1 to finish ninth. (PTI)

## From NCC shooting to Asian Games, Vidarsa overcomes financial hurdles

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Asian Games-bound rifle shooter Vidarsa K Vinod has turned setbacks and self-doubt into motivation, transforming an NCC introduction to shooting in 2018 into a place in Indian squad for Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games, with her sights set on becoming the world No. 1. The 27-year-old from Kozhikode, initially picked up a rifle through the NCC simply to experience the sport and perhaps secure a government job, but eight years later she is headed to the Asian Games, where she will compete in the women's 10m air rifle and 50m rifle 3-positions events, targeting her first individual international medal.

"My biggest dream is to become World No. 1. I want to discover my full potential and keep improving every time I step onto the range,"



said Vidarsa.

Born into a family where her father works as a contractor and her mother is a homemaker, Vidarsa often found her dream of competing at the highest level difficult to pursue due to financial constraints. "I just wanted to experience shooting. I never imagined it would become

my profession. When I became the aggregate champion at the Kerala State Championship despite training with borrowed equipment, I realised this was the sport I wanted to pursue," she said.

## Bodhana, Shreyas Royal make British chess history

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ London,

Indian-origin chess prodigies 11-year-old Bodhana Sivanandan and 17-year-old Shreyas Royal made chess history over the weekend, winning the 2026 British Chess Championships.

Bodhana became Britain's youngest-ever Women's chess champion at the games which concluded in Coventry on Sunday. Cheered on as "Godhana" during the



rounds, she clinched her title in a tense rapid-chess playoff with Ireland's 14-

year-old Trisha Kanyamarala, a promising talent in her own right.

"Unreal! Bodhana has won. She is unbelievable, a generational talent," said Grandmaster Danny Gormally, as he wrapped his commentary for the English Chess Federation (ECF). Bodhana famously first picked up chess during the COVID pandemic lockdown when her father's friend was going back to India and gave her a few bags, which included a chess board.

"I was interested in the pieces, so I started playing," she said at the

time. Since then, the north-west London schoolgirl has been topping records as one of the youngest players on circuit. In the faster formats of the game, Bodhana is already the UK Open Women's Blitz Champion and joint British Women's Rapid Champion. Her latest win at classical format event makes it an impressive hat-trick for the 11-year-old, her only loss at the championship this weekend being to Shreyas Royal in round six.

### Theegala slips to end T- 49th as Brennan wins Wyndham title



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Greensboro (USA)

Indian-American golfer Sahith Theegala, who began the Wyndham Championship in spectacular fashion with an eight-under 62, returned his worst card of the week — a four-over 74 — in the final round to sign off tied 49th here.

Theegala carded rounds of 62-69-74 for a six-under 274 total, but his place in the FedExCup Playoffs was never in danger. Theegala ended the regular season at No. 44 in the FedExCup standings and will now head into the three-event post-season.

Theegala's qualification is particularly significant after an injury-hit 2025 season. He has gradually rebuilt his form this year and produced several strong finishes, including a tied eighth at the American Express and a tied seventh at the Farmers Insurance Open.

Aaron Rai, the other Indian-origin player in the field, finished tied 29th after a steady week.

The PGA Championship winner shot rounds of 67-69-69-67 to finish at eight-under 272. Rai's performance left him No.35 in the final regular-season standings, giving him a comfortable place in the Playoffs.

The top 70 players in the FedExCup standings advance to the post-season, which begins next week with the FedEx St. Jude Championship at TPC Southwind in Memphis, Tennessee.

Michael Brennan produced a remarkable closing stretch, making five consecutive birdies from the fourth hole before closing with a six-under 64 to win the Wyndham Championship and secure his place in the lucrative FedExCup Playoffs.

## UEFA, CONCACAF and AFC accuse FIFA of deception over WC plans

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Washington

UEFA, CONCACAF and the AFC believe that FIFA president Gianni Infantino's recent plan to sell an interest in the World Cup was a "fundamental breach of trust" with the institutions world soccer's governing body serves.

In an "open letter to the football family" revealed on Monday, UEFA, CONCACAF and the AFC also said that "when trust is broken through deception, when an individual places himself above the collective that entrusted him with authority, that duty



has been abandoned." UEFA runs soccer in Europe, CONCACAF does the same for North, Central America and the Caribbean, while AFC governs sport in Asia.

The letter was co-signed by UEFA president Aleksander Ceferin, AFC president Salman Bin Ibrahim Al-Khalifa, CONCACAF president Victor Montagliani and three general secretaries.

"Football is the world's greatest shared passion. It belongs to no individual and no institution. It belongs to the players, the fans, the clubs, the member associations and every institution entrusted with safeguarding

its future," the open letter said. "It is in that spirit, as confederations representing its members, that we speak collectively today."

Infantino is facing a revolt after his failed plan to sell stakes in the World Cup to private equity investors.

"It is not the conduct of a custodian of the game, but of one who believes the game is answerable to him," the letter said. "These are not the qualities football deserves in its leadership. That is why we have taken this stance: not lightly and not alone, but together, and out of duty to the game we serve."

UEFA previously issued a threat to boycott the World Cup and other FIFA competitions despite the governing body abandoning and apologizing for its failed plan.

Norway's soccer federation called for Infantino to step down, while the English Football Association has also withdrawn its support for Infantino's re-election next March.

"Football's strength has always been its unity. We call for that unity to be honoured now," the letter said. "For leadership that serves football, not seeks to command it."



# PM Modi hosts CWG medallists, lauds Lovlina

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

Boxer Lovlina Borgohain got appreciation for objecting to a distorted Indian flag, weightlifter Mirabai Chanu opened up about the “turmoil” of her last four years while some other Commonwealth Games medallists took the opportunity to share jokes with Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who hosted them for an interaction here.

The PM heard from the medallists about their experiences building up to the Commonwealth Games and during their stay in Glasgow during a meeting at his residence on Sunday. It was also attended by Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya, Minister of State for Sports Raksha Khadse and Indian Olympic Association (IOA) President P T Usha. “*Kya hua wo restaurant waale se jhagda kar rahi thi?*” (What happened, you were fighting with that restaurant guy?)” Modi asked Lovlina, who won the 75kg category silver, in the little over 10-minute video of the interaction shared by his office on Monday.

The Assam boxer laughed and replied, “We had such a good performance and it was the last day of the Games. It was a happy occasion sir, we were celebrating and I didn’t like it when I saw the distorted flag. I politely told them and they have made the changes also.”

The PM, while applauding her, said it was a thoughtful gesture at a time when she was just out to celebrate her triumph. India won 39 medals in the truncated Games to finish fourth. The tally included 13 gold medals, seven of them coming in boxing.

“To be able to recognise the significance of that map at a time when you were celebrating and the Games were over, I can tell you truthfully, that video was not ordinary. It will be remembered by



people for a very long time,” he told the Tokyo Olympics bronze-winner.

In his one-on-one chat with Mirabai, who won the 48kg category gold in Glasgow with a Games record lift of 190kg, the PM asked about her breakdown

on the podium. He also fed her a laddu during the interaction. Mirabai said it was a moment of letting go emotions that she had been holding on for the past four years.

“*Itne aansu tapak rahe the* (So many tears were rolling down),” Modi remarked.

A clearly overwhelmed but smiling Mirabai responded, “I was very happy and emotional in that moment. I was crying because I missed a medal in Paris Olympics by one kilogram. I had faced a lot in these last four years. I was battling injuries and some family problems too.

“There were lot of things. So, these four years were very tough for me. And when I

stood on the podium, our flag went up and the anthem played, it was hard to stop myself,” she said without getting into specifics of her issues apart from injuries.



# Lighter by 17kg, Sarfaraz Khan ready for Sri Lanka challenge

KUSHAN SARKAR ■ New Delhi

A few days before he was recalled to India’s Test squad, Sarfaraz Khan had declared on social media that, “I may not fit in, but I’ll fight with everything I’ve got.” It was a message of resolve but one that was acutely aware of the probabilities at that point. But as luck would have it, his resolve won. An injury to Sai Sudharsan opened up window of opportunity which Sarfaraz had been waiting for past two years. He was included for the two-match away Test series against Sri Lanka beginning on August 15.

The recall could not have come at a more opportune time for the Mumbaier, having done all that he could to “fit in”, including shedding 17kg in the past year and a half. For someone, who has fought the perception of being a bit more burly for international cricket despite scoring a marathon triple hundred in Ranji Trophy, Sarfaraz now sports a sharper look, something that has certainly elevated his T20 game. Add to it, hours and hours spent at the Sher-e-Kashmir Stadium in Kashmir to sharpen his skills because seasonal rains made it impossible to have regular training in Mumbai.

The comeback, therefore, is one to savour as being dropped after



four failures against New Zealand, back in 2024, was hard to process. It was a series in which everyone failed but the axe fell only on the 28-year-old. He then went to England and scored 92 for India A in an unofficial Test’ against England Lions apart from a century in an intra-squad game (India vs India A) at Beckenham. (PTI)

# India wins 17 medals at U-23 Commonwealth Fencing Championship

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ New Delhi

India secured 17 medals, including four gold at U-23 Commonwealth Fencing Championship, dominating both the men’s and women’s individual events currently underway in Lagos, Nigeria. Team India captured four gold, four silver, and nine bronze medals after the opening day of event which began on Sunday and run till August 14.

The national squad displayed absolute dominance across every discipline, ensuring at least one Indian fencer reached the podium in all six individual events spanning Sabre, Foil, and Epee categories, stated a release from the Fencing Association of India.

In the men’s Sabre competition, Team India was led by Nikhil Wagh, who secured the gold medal. Lakshay Badser took the silver, while Ashwini Arya and Laishram Moramba shared the Bronze medals to complete a four-way victory.

In the men’s Foil, Tejas Patil captured silver and Hemash Sanasam



took bronze. In men’s Epee, Lokesh Vemani brought home a silver, with Shaurya Ashwini and Godwin Anbkess earning bronze medals. India’s women athletes were equally dominant, securing top honours in two out of three categories.

Joys Ashita won gold in women’s Foil ahead of teammate Kanaglakshmi, who earned silver. In women’s Epee, Prachi Lohan clinched the gold medal, supported by Nivedhya Nair and Anupriya who both took bronze.

In women’s Sabre, Jeferlin claimed gold and Aakhari earned silver, while Shreya Gupta added a bronze medal to round out the women’s medal count.

Commending contingent on their stellar performance, Rajeev Mehta, Secretary General of the Fencing Association of India, stated, “I extend my heartiest congratulations to all our medal winners, coaches, support staff, and families for their relentless dedication and contribution to India’s remarkable performance.”

# Durand Cup: Mohun Bagan storms into quarter-finals

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Kolkata

Mohun Bagan Super Giant sealed top spot in Group A and booked their place in the quarter-finals of the 135th IndianOil Durand Cup with a commanding 6-0 victory over CISF Protectors at the Kishore Bharati Krirangan on Monday. Sahal Abdul Samad stole the limelight with a scintillating first-half hat-trick, while Manvir Singh, Jamie Maclaren and Tekcham Abhishek Singh also found the scoresheet as the Mariners completed a perfect group-stage campaign with three wins from three matches.

Already on six points from their opening two matches, Panagiotis Dilimperi’s side entered the contest with a quarter-final spot confirmed, while CISF Protectors were looking to end their campaign on a positive note after back-to-back defeats.

Early in the contest, the CISF defence, marshalled by captain Mohammad Khalid, stood firm against wave after wave of Mohun Bagan attacks.

Subhasish Bose tested the goalkeeper with a low long-range



effort in the ninth minute, but the Mariners’ relentless pressure eventually paid dividends in the 17th minute. Dejan Dračić produced a superb defence-splitting pass from inside his own half to release Tekcham Abhishek Singh on the right. His shot took a deflection into the path of Liston Colaco, who unselfishly squared the ball for Sahal Abdul Samad to apply the finishing touch.

Two minutes later, the Mariners doubled their lead with another slick attacking move. This time Manvir Singh threaded a delightful pass into the path of Dejan on the right, and the Serbian calmly

squared the ball across for Sahal to tap home his second goal in as many minutes.

Mohun Bagan continued to carve open the CISF defence, with Manvir first firing straight at the goalkeeper before making amends in the 24th minute. Tekcham Abhishek Singh whipped in an inviting cross from the right and the striker controlled brilliantly before finishing confidently to make it 3-0.

The Mariners almost added another when Manvir capitalised on a misplaced pass and burst into the penalty area, only for Muneesh Kumar to produce a vital touch that prevented an

almost certain own goal.

Sahal then completed a memorable first-half hat-trick in spectacular fashion in the 37th minute. Picking up possession near the halfway line, the midfielder surged forward, glided past defenders with sublime skill and calmly slotted a right-footed finish beyond the goalkeeper to crown an outstanding individual performance. Subhasish Bose nearly created a fifth moments later with a teasing cross that brushed the hair of Manvir Singh before drifting wide, while Mehtab Singh produced an important defensive intervention to halt a rare CISF counter-attack.

The Mariners headed into the interval with a commanding 4-0 advantage after dominating possession with 75 per cent of the ball, while the Protectors managed just one off-target effort during the opening 45 minutes.

Dilimperi made four changes at half-time, introducing Ashish Rai, Alex Saji, Kiyan Nassiri Giri and Abhishek Dhananjay Suryavanshi to freshen up the side, resulting in an all-Indian line-up for the second half.

# India end World Athletics U20 Championships with 3 medals



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA  
■ Eugene (USA)

National senior record holder high jumper Pooja Singh failed to live up to the expectations, finishing seventh in the final, as India ended their World Athletics U20 Championships campaign with three medals here.

The 19-year-old Pooja could only clear 1.84m, way below her national senior record height of 1.93m. She failed to sail over 1.87m in three attempts. Izobelle Louison-Roe of Australia won the gold with 1.92m, while Lilianna Batori (1.90m) of Hungary and Aitana Alonso (1.90m) of Spain bagged the silver and bronze respectively. In May, Pooja had won gold in the Asian U20 Athletics Championships with the senior national record height of 1.93m. She is also the reigning gold medalist at the Senior Asian Athletics Championships.

The Indian women’s 4x400m

relay team, meanwhile, finished ninth and last in the final, clocking 3 minute 45.28 seconds. The team comprised Bhoomika Nehate, Tahura Khatun, Tanu Chaudhary and Thiya Arumugam. USA won the gold with a time of 3:29.15s, while Australia (3:31.39s) and Great Britain (3:32.08s) took the silver and bronze respectively.

With two silver and one bronze here, India equalled the medal haul of the 2021 and 2022 editions. Ashish Yadav had opened India’s medal account with a silver in the men’s javelin throw. Basant Kumar Meghwal and Shahnavaz Khan added a silver and bronze respectively in the men’s high jump and long jump.

From 2002 to 2018, India won just four medals in the World Athletics U20 Championships, including a gold each from Neeraj Chopra (men’s javelin throw in 2016) and Hima Das (women’s 400m race in 2018).

# Brennan wins Wyndham Championship and Joaquin Niemann gets 9th LIV Golf win

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
■ Greensboro (North Carolina)

Michael Brennan made five straight birdies to pull away from Beau Hossler and close with a 6-under 64 to win the Wyndham Championship and reach the PGA Tour’s lucrative post-season.

Brennan came into the final tournament of the regular season at No. 105 in the FedEx Cup. Now his season gets extended by at least one week after his second PGA Tour title in two years. The FedEx Cup playoffs start Thursday with the FedEx St. Jude Championship at the TPC Southwind in Memphis, Tennessee. Only the top 70 players advance, and Brennan shot up to No. 47. Jackson Koivun, who left Auburn in June and won the 3M Open in only his third start, narrowly hung on to 70th spot and goes from college to the post-



season in only two months.

Brennan made birdie on the final hole to finish at 22-under 258, matching the tournament record at Sedgefield shot three other times,

most recently last year by Wake Forest grad Cameron Young. Ben James, the No. 1 player from the PGA Tour University ranking who has a card already secure for 2027, fell out of contention on Saturday but roared back with 61 to finish third.

LIV Golf League: Joaquin Niemann closed with a 2-under 69 Sunday for a three-shot victory in LIV Golf New York, extending his record with his ninth career victory in the last three years.

Jon Rahm shot 76 and tied for 41st, but that still was enough to win the season points title for the third straight time since the two-time major champion joined LIV Golf.



# Rivera rallies to capture second straight US women’s gymnastics title

WILL GRAVES ■ Phoenix

Hezly Rivera is leaning into her role as leader of the next wave of US women’s gymnasts. The 18-year-old Olympic gold medalist won her second straight national title on Sunday, rallying from fourth during final day of competition with four poised and professional routines.

Her two-day total of 111.950 was more than a point clear of runner-up Claire Pease, making Rivera the first American woman



not named Simone Biles to go back-to-back since former world and Olympic champion Jordyn

Wieber did it in 2010 and 2011. Rivera was the self-described “underdog” in Paris two years ago, when she joined an experienced group that helped the Americans win their third team gold in four Games. While some of her Olympic teammates - Biles and Suni Lee chief among them - have been on an extended break, Rivera has pressed on. She edged Leanne Wong in New Orleans last year, but Rivera’s chances for a repeat seemed to be in trouble after she fell face-first into the mat after

missing a release on uneven bars on Thursday. No matter, Rivera began Sunday on bars and put together a gritty set in which she fought through a mini-stall near the end and gave coach Valeri Liukin a “what are you gonna do?” shrug after a dismount that included a small step.

The judges awarded Rivera with a solid if not spectacular 13.850, and her momentum continued to build as she made her way across the competition floor at Matchup Mortgage Arena. Her

black-and-white bedazzled leotard glittering under the lights, Rivera put on a performance that made her look every bit the experienced veteran she has become.

Pease and fellow first-day co-leader Skye Blakely couldn’t quite keep up. Pease led with two rotations to go, but her floor routine included one tumbling pass that ended with her stepping out of bounds and another in which she opted to keep her right foot hovering above the floor rather than set it down for a penalty.



# Harris shoots 59 and wins in a playoff on Korn Ferry Tour

ASSOCIATED PRESS  
■ Omaha (Nebraska)

Frankie Harris made an 18-foot birdie putt on the final hole for a 12-under 59 and won the Pinnacle Bank Championship on Sunday with a par on second playoff hole for his first Korn Ferry Tour title in only his sixth start this year.

Harris shot 27 on the back nine of The Club at Indian Creek by making just over 153 feet of putts. “The thought of a 59 never even crossed my mind. Honestly, like 100% honesty, I did not know I shot a 59 when I made that putt on 18,” Harris said.

“I knew I was playing well, but I was just trying to keep the pedal on the gas and finish strong.”

Alistair Docherty was coming off a birdie on the 15th when Harris posted at 22-under 262. He birdied the last three holes, starting with a 53-foot putt on the 16th, the last one giving him 64 to force the playoff.